

A.A. Takes Its Inventory

The Thirty-First Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

1981

Final Report

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April 26 - May 2**

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Mail address: Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York, NY 10163



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Regional Map Of U.S. and Canada

A.A. Regional Forums: See presentation/discussion, page 21; trustee committee and staff reports, page 38.

Regional trustees: See talks by retiring trustees, pages 8-9; report of trustees' Nominating Committee, page 40; Advisory Action 49, page 49; brief biographies, pages 58-59.

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Conferences Are a Fellowship Fourth Step

Opening day

In a week filled with hard work and spirited discussions, the 31st General Service Conference, meeting April 26 - May 2, 1981, lived up to the theme "A.A. Takes Its Inventory." Committee and general sessions brought to life in a striking way the workings of an informed group conscience.

An informal Sunday-afternoon sharing session began the week, highlighted by the showing of a 1946 "March of Time" film on problem drinkers, with a segment about A.A. Then, the question "How does it feel to be a Conference member?" was answered briefly by several, with varying service experience: Jerry Danzig (general service trustee, who also introduced the film), Jackie Jones (Panel 30, Kentucky, delegate chairperson), Irv Poissant (Panel 30, Arizona, alternate chairperson), Jim Estelle (nonalcoholic trustee), Fernand Ippersiel (regional trustee, Eastern Canada), Mary Phelps (Grapevine director), June Russell (G.S.O. staff), Pete Peters (Panel 30, Northern Illinois), and Dottie Rapp (Panel 31, Virginia).

Sunday's preliminary events were topped off by the opening dinner, where Conference members, spouses or friends, and other guests enjoyed London broil and—the "main course"—an inspiring A.A. meeting. Ken Williams (nonalcoholic trustee) introduced speakers Joanne McCartin (Panel 30, Western New York), Perry Rodreick (Panel 30, Montana), Jack Braybrook (Panel 30, Alberta/Northwest Territories), Tom Neary (Grapevine staff), and Betty Liddle (G.S.O. staff).

Monday morning, everyone settled down to business at the opening session in the Terrace Room of New York's Hotel Roosevelt. Opening remarks by Milton Maxwell, General Service Board chairperson, were followed by roll call by Bob Pearson (G.S.O. general manager), welcome and introduction of Conference committee chairpersons by Jackie Jones, and an outstanding keynote address, given by trustee-at-large/U.S. Ruth Hartshorn.

The formal agenda was opened by the General Service Board report, given by Milton Maxwell, and continued through an exciting week to Saturday morning's closing brunch and A.A. meeting. Reports, presentations, an Ask-It Basket session, workshops, and—most vital of all—committee meetings made up the program for an often-hectic week. Conference members took their job seriously—in fact, a last-minute agenda reshuffling was needed to allow ample time for full consideration of all committee reports and recommendations.

Thursday afternoon, a "What's on Your Mind?" session opened the floor for matters not on the official agenda. Discussion ranged over such questions as the role of the General Service Office, a suggestion that the long form of the Traditions be used whenever possible, and inquiries about material for deaf alcoholics. Canadian delegates had questions about the new literature distribution warehouse and (from the Northeastern Ontario delegate) about "The A.A. Service Manual," in which the Ontario general service structure is not presently covered.

Moments of strong disagreement scattered throughout the week served to underline the seriousness with which the Conference took its own inventory, and to enhance the spirit of goodwill and unity that eventually seems to pervade all who experience a General Service Conference.

What to wear in Montreal?

When Denis Longtin (Panel 30, Southwestern Quebec) presented Montreal's bid for the 1985 International Convention, one of the Site Committee members (probably remembering the heat in New Orleans) asked, "What's the temperature in Quebec Fourth of July weekend?" Without missing a beat, Denny shot back: "Do you want it in Celsius or Fahrenheit?"

Keynote

Taking inventory can be a spiritual endeavor

Good morning and a good Conference 1981 for all of us and for Alcoholics Anonymous, because what we say and learn here affects A.A. around the world. Upon being asked to give the keynote address, I was a little shook-up. My concern abated somewhat when I looked up previous keynote speeches and discovered they are filed under "Miscellaneous."

This year's theme, "A.A. Takes Its Inventory," is really what all A.A. Conferences are about. In all Conferences, the aim is to get to know ourselves a little bit better as a fellowship. We ask ourselves what we do well, in which areas we are weak, and what we could do better. Most of all, we have personal communication here, not just words-on-paper correspondence.



Recent Conferences were camera-shy, but 1981 members agreed to this anonymity-preserving photo. At the rostrum is Milton Maxwell, board chairperson.

We do have a business inventory. Through two corporations, A.A. owns books, magazines, other literature, and office equipment. But those are not the things that, it seems to me, should be our greatest concern this week or any week. This is a spiritual fellowship. Our job here (as I see it) is working within the essential spiritual quality of our Fellowship to ensure our primary purpose—that of staying sober and helping other alcoholics to achieve sobriety.

So long as we remember well the lessons of the past as expressed through the Traditions, we have nothing to fear as we talk, argue, listen, and share. Some of us have been to several Conferences; some, to only one; some are experiencing this fantastic happening for the first time. Those of you who are new here may have some misgivings about the rest of us. You may even have been “instructed” to straighten us out on certain matters. Before my first Conference, in 1973, certain old-timers in Southeastern New York had a few things they told me they wanted “taken care of.” Well, the Conference has a way of seeing to things like that.

One question we’ll be considering is whether we have too much literature—too many different types of pamphlets. I don’t have the answer, but we’re going to work out an answer that expresses the group conscience of this Conference.

We’re going to talk about public information. It really doesn’t matter how spiritual A.A. is, or how high a percentage of alcoholics who come to A.A. stay sober, if alcoholics in general don’t know about us; 70% of zero is zero. It surprised me to hear a well-informed lady in this big city say recently that she does not consciously remember hearing about A.A. until shortly before she joined us, about ten years ago.

Those are just two of the topics we’ll discuss this week. Everyone’s ideas and comments are important, however different they may be—*especially* if they are different. If everyone came here with the same feelings and opinions, we wouldn’t need a Conference. We could just send out rubber stamps to you all. Some people say that happens! If it does, it’s because we let it and don’t speak up.

I have doubts about the staff and Conference time and money that go into International Conventions. Could the time and money be used in a better way to implement our primary purpose? Whether my concern is somewhat off the wall is not important. What is important is that I voice it, because it is sincere. Your concerns should be voiced also. My questions may never be discussed, and yours may have to wait for another Conference. But if we have concerns about our Fellowship, we should at least mention them. This is part of our inventory-taking.

My personal feeling is to trust the process in which we are engaged. No matter that we disagree vehemently at times, or that some of our character defects come bubbling up during our service work here or during the year, the cumulative power of the greater whole that we feel and see working at the group level is also at work here. Even if a particular decision proves less than desirable, it can be rectified through the Conference process.

An inventory of what A.A. as a fellowship is comes before the inventory of how we implement our service arms and committees. The psychology of “If one drink is good, another one is

going to make me feel better” seems not to go away—“If A.A. is good for staying sober, it’s going to do everything else I need done.” Well, that may be partly true, but not because that is the aim of A.A. Many good things may happen, but only if we do “First Things First” and stay sober. If we dilute our primary purpose, there will be no A.A., no one to cooperate with community groups, no place for our helping non-A.A. friends to send alcoholics.

“Love,” a minister once said, “is the deepest possible concern for another human being.” If we can begin this Conference believing that we are all here with the best of motives and deepest possible concern for all alcoholics everywhere, and can let ourselves be open to the limitless energy of the universe that is available to us, no problem will be too difficult. My love to you all.

Ruth Hartshorn, trustee-at-large/U.S.

The sound system at the Roosevelt wasn’t quite up to par this year, but that didn’t stop anyone—the microphones had a real workout! Friday afternoon ended with a good laugh when Conference co-chairperson Bob Pearson called on the delegate scheduled to close the session. Bob explained that one of the reasons for asking delegates to open and close meetings was to make sure even shy, quiet people got a chance to be at the mike. As one of the more loquacious delegates stepped forward, Bob said, “And so, to lead us in the Lord’s Prayer, here is—” He was drowned out by laughter from everyone, including the talkative delegate!

Welcome

‘A vision-stretching process’

I am a delegate out of the hat, and I came here last year thinking maybe the other fella should have been chosen. With more than a little apprehension, I walked into the reception Sunday afternoon. Within a matter of minutes, I felt as though I was in an A.A. meeting and began meeting new friends.

Monday morning, I listened to the roll call, and waves of gratitude and a sense of responsibility swept over me. I listened to staff reports and learned how much I didn’t know. My name had been drawn to serve on the Agenda Committee, and our area had a lot of questions concerning the agenda. At my first committee meeting, our chairperson suddenly said, “Any questions?” Automatically, I began telling them our problem. Everyone joined in the discussion, and I had a reasonable solution to take home. I grew a little.

When the floor discussion began, I took one look at the mikes and thought, “I’ll just sit down here and listen and learn. I’m new.” Eventually, someone said something that I couldn’t agree with, and I found myself standing at the mike being recognized by the chairperson. I expressed my thoughts about the issue that affected my area, and when I finished, I listened while others stood and expressed like thoughts. And I grew a little.

Too soon, the week ended, and I went home and gave the best delegate’s report I knew how, and I saw interest and enthusiasm in the faces of some of our D.C.M.’s and G.S.R.’s. They

asked questions and offered suggestions, and we shared my experience, and I grew a little.

Standing here sharing these thoughts with you as delegate chairperson is a responsibility that has made me grow a little. As each day passes, I know that my name didn't come out of that hat by accident. With each responsibility, there has been the opportunity to grow. Each and every one of us will have another opportunity to grow a little more this week as the responsibilities of the Conference unfold.

I know each one of you feels the electricity in this room. As the week progresses, we will experience what Bill Wilson so aptly described as the effect of a General Service Conference, "a vision-stretching process." We Panel 30 delegates are fortunate to be here again this year with all of you Panel 31 delegates. I believe every panel has felt the same awareness. Recently, I heard Tom P., a Panel 1 delegate, relate some of his experiences at his first Conference, almost 30 years ago. The names were unfamiliar to me; the problems differed; but the feelings were the same; the enthusiasm was high.

There is no prestige or power or authority among us in these meeting rooms. But I believe there is One, whom I choose to call God, who is ever-present in any A.A. meeting, who lovingly protects and guides this Fellowship and its members to further our primary purpose—to help the still-suffering alcoholic. It is with this knowledge that we begin this week "a vision-stretching process."

Jackie Jones (Kentucky), delegate chairperson

Trusted servants

The trustees' dinner Tuesday night was held in the Wine Room of Giambelli's Restaurant. The room lived up to its name; it was lined with wine bottles, displayed in racks on the walls.

Delegates meeting

Suggestion: Salute A.A.'s birthday annually

The informal delegates meeting took place Tuesday night, April 28; over a good dinner, Panels 30 and 31 had an opportunity to renew old friendships and enjoy new ones.

Lively discussion—later continued when the meeting report was given to the full Conference on Thursday morning—took place over a self-inventory question: What topics are appropriate for presentation at the delegates meeting? (In the past, delegates have generally excluded items on the formal agenda, since other Conference members are not present and will not have the benefit of the discussion.)

Delegates passed a resolution (suggested by Joe Phelan, Panel 30, Georgia) that June 10, 1935, be recognized as A.A.'s birthday and that each delegate make groups in the area aware of this date and of the desirability of observing it in each group. Delegates also affirmed their faith in the committee system and shared experience on area newsletters.

Stash Brys (Panel 31, Northern New Jersey) was elected dele-

gate chairperson, to take office immediately upon the close of the Conference meeting; Jack Whitehouse (Panel 31, Central Michigan), alternate chairperson.



In closing remarks on Friday, John L. Norris, M.D., chairperson emeritus of the General Service Board, paid tribute to A.A. pioneers. For his 31st Conference, "Dr. Jack" was given an anniversary-style cake.

Closing brunch

'A great week of communication'

The icing on the cake at every General Service Conference is the closing brunch on Saturday morning, when rotating trustees give their farewell talks. It's a time not only for endings but for rededication, as all Conference members benefit from the insight and experience of those who are going on to other kinds of service.

Milton Maxwell presided and led the meeting. He began by introducing Jackie Jones (Kentucky), delegate chairperson, who put into a few words what many were thinking: "I grew a lot this year. I thought I grew last year, but I reached inside and grabbed out a lot more of the program I had learned back home." Stash Brys (Northern New Jersey), incoming delegate chairperson, read "How It Works."

Bob Pearson, after a few personal reflections on the Conference, introduced some of the behind-the-scenes workers without whom it wouldn't work at all. He named especially Dennis Manders (G.S.O. controller, who this year is attending his 31st General Service Conference), Ed Gordon, Adeline

Wilmot, Elizabeth Garcia, Tony Osnato, Louis D'Amelio, and —“with much love”—Conference coordinator Sarah Price.

A note of combined sadness and faith permeated the talks, as all five speakers mentioned LaVelle Clifford, Southwest regional trustee, who could not be present because she was in the hospital with a serious illness.

Milton Maxwell summed up in closing the meeting: “There are no problems that we can’t handle if we trust each other and are trustworthy, and if we communicate. And this has been a great week of communication.” With his last comment, he generated a final round of loving laughter: “I’m one of those who feel that this holding of hands ought not to become a ritual in A.A.—but it is rather appropriate for important occasions.” And so Conference week ended with all holding hands for the Lord’s Prayer.

The talks of the five rotating trustees are excerpted here.

‘Don’t tighten up all the nuts and bolts’

Jerry Danzig, general service trustee, based part of his talk on notes he made many years ago for his first A.A. talk—which he never got to make! And he went on to say:

“There are a lot of things in my story that I don’t talk about anymore, because my values have changed. They are infinitely more spiritual, more geared to appreciation. I no longer think it’s necessary to share every horror detail.

“One of the most interesting conversations I heard at this Conference dealt with change, and I want to talk about that. We have stayed constant to our principles and to our ideas. But many things are changing over which we don’t have much control, but which will affect A.A.—dual addiction, more young people, more women, referrals from courts and treatment centers, more professionals.

“There are going to be some interesting problems to face; we’re facing them now, and you’ll face them next year, and our successors will face them. I’m not really concerned about the love and care that have been exhibited in abundance at this Conference. But I do have a little concern—that we might smother the Fellowship to death with our love, by tidying up, by being sure of everything. One of the things we say to each other is: ‘We’re alcoholics; we can make mistakes.’ And I hope that we don’t ever tighten up all the nuts and bolts and become so rigid that we can’t go ahead and make a few really topflight mistakes!”

A.A.W.S. director Virginia Turner reflected on her first Conference: “When I come back from conferences of some of the professional organizations I belong to, I’m tired, cranky, and hard to get along with. I came back from this Conference refreshed and happy—wanting to share more than my family really wanted to hear!”

‘My love affair with service’

Virginia Hallman, East Central regional trustee, centered her farewell on the love and acceptance we find in A.A. “I have so

much love and admiration and respect and concern for the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. I’m one of those people who need a lot of love. When I was growing up, everything I thought was love was false, and it made me vulnerable to being used by others.

“As I was getting ready this morning, I asked God for the strength I knew I was going to need. And I knew somehow that I had come to the place where I could be accepted just for me. I can recall meeting the secretary of the central office in Detroit and thinking it must be a marvelous thing to be able to work in service. And I thought: If somehow, someday, they’ll just let me make coffee in my group . . . After all these years of sobriety, I have been fired from just one job—the job of making coffee!

“Never in my wildest imagination did I think that my love affair with service would end up where I’m standing now. These four years on the board have done something for me that I needed badly; I needed reassurance of being accepted for me. I had been a trustee once before—for 13 years in prison. The trusteeship we serve here is a lot different! There was no love there. I wanted to rotate off the first day, but they didn’t allow that.

“I ask that we go back and reaffirm our commitment to ourselves that we always do what’s best for A.A., not just what’s best for ourselves. Thank you, and I love you for giving me the most magnificent life anybody could ever have.”

Groups and members — spring 1981

	Groups	Members
United States	22,169	414,434
Canada	3,624	61,531
Overseas	14,016 ¹	362,772 ¹
Treatment facilities	1,182 ²	24,822 ²
Correctional facilities	1,114 ²	42,920 ²
Lone Members		508
Internationalists		588
	42,105	907,575 ³

1 As reported January 1, 1980; later figures not yet available.

2 U.S. and Canada only.

3 Including nonreported members, it is estimated that there are more than 1,000,000 members worldwide, in 110 countries.

From the headwaters to the mainstream

Ruth Hartshorn, trustee at large/U.S., began by talking about her great enthusiasm for carrying the message to *everyone* when she first came into the program (including a drunk on the street, who finally told her, “Go away, lady, and leave me alone!”).

Now, she said, “I think of A.A. as a stream that begins up in the mountains. A little bit of water comes into a little ravine, then a little more from another place, and there’s a larger tributary. And then you have a real brook, strong, with a lot of current. And it finally comes to something larger, like a river in the valley, and empties into that river, and finally becomes part of one of the Great Lakes.

“I feel strongly about rotation—it’s good for me, and it’s good



for you. I am traveling down that stream and being emptied into the river of A.A. again, and somewhere up on the mountain-top, some little tributary is growing—some new G.S.R. or D.C.M.—and that person is going to come and join you. So we're all generated into the mainstream of A.A. Then, we're pushed into an even bigger stream.

"A.A. is for me the greatest learning experience of my life, and I'm going out with a lot more knowledge than I had before."

'Politics is nothing . . . it's faith'

Martin Le Boutillier, general service trustee, spoke movingly of the supporting love he received during his eight years as A.A.W.S. director and then as trustee. "The love I have received has been incredible, and saying it is the only way I could see to tell you how much I love you."

Martin shared several personal experiences, including the death of a beloved daughter and the loss of a prestigious job, and went on to express gratitude for the way friends in service sustained him through a serious illness.

"I don't think I would have gotten well—I don't think I would have made the effort to get well—without the dynamics of that love. I say that because I think it's important to know that, as we remember LaVelle in our prayers, we can be the difference—an important difference—in how one of our beloved friends and members faces a physical problem.

"We get here often by a political process, and often act in political ways as we represent our areas or our groups. It's important to remember that politics is nothing in this program. It's faith. I wouldn't be sober today without the faith that you gave me because you were sober. None of us would be here without that faith. Our program works, and it works beautifully. We don't have to change it; we just have to have faith in it as it is. We need to have faith in the group conscience, because, given time, the group conscience *always* works. It is, in my opinion, the Higher Power, talking through us in many voices, to re-affirm or redirect or direct us in the proper path."

'You're sending me home again'

Sam Smith, Southeast regional trustee, said that "they shouldn't call this rotation. They should call it separation, because it's really separation from a family that you've become united with.

"Almost 16 years ago, I was in a shack with three skid-row bums, and they threw me out. And as a result, they sent me home—to my home group. Here, almost 16 years later, you're sending me home again. But what a difference!

"In every service job I ever had, I looked to the person who had the job before me for guidance. When I came here as a delegate, I was so impressed with the trustees. And then when I became a trustee, I found the same thing I had found in every other service job: The alcoholic trustees are just a bunch of ex-drunks like me. The ones I'm really in awe of are the non-alcoholic trustees. I don't understand how they can give so much dedication to something they're not afflicted with, and I can only think that after they come, they get infected with the love we have, and can't get away from it.

"I have a few concerns about A.A.—for anonymity, for our singleness of purpose, and for our collective humility. I'm concerned that A.A., now that the world has beaten a path to our door, might feel that we have accomplished a lot, when, in fact, we have accomplished nothing. God has accomplished it all. We as individuals have only carried the message, and I hope we won't become impressed with the success of A.A."

Several New York City meetings were enlivened by the presence of delegates taking a "night off." The secretary of one local group was pleasantly surprised when her weekly question "Are there any out-of-town visitors tonight?" was answered by a show of about 15 hands instead of the usual two or three. . . . Even more startled were a few local speakers whose opening words, "My name is —, and I'm an alcoholic," were greeted by a hearty "Hi, —!" (not a widespread custom in the city). . . . June Boranian, delegate from Hawaii, made an after-Conference date with an old friend who, she thought, had a drinking problem and might be ready to try a meeting. It was so. The friend later remarked to an A.A. sitting beside her at a morning meeting in New York's Greenwich Village, "It seems mystical that June should have come just at this time."

Conference sidelights

While delegates deliberated, their spouses saw New York City, from the elegance of the Metropolitan Opera House to the picturesque haunts of the Lower East Side Soho district. The Hospitality Committee, a volunteer group of local A.A.'s and Al-Anons, chaired by Dale Carlson, had planned a stimulating week. A Sunday-afternoon reception at the Roosevelt gave spouses and committee members a chance to get acquainted and to register for some, or all, of the week's events. Monday's feature was a trip around Manhattan Island on the famous Circle Line boat; then came Radio City Music Hall, a tour of Lincoln Center, a museum and gallery tour, and an afternoon in Soho topped off by a visit to an artist's loft studio. Lots of time for shopping, afternoon tea at committee members' homes, and walking, walking, walking kept spouses just as busy as their delegate wives and husbands. . . . A summary of delegate statistics shows what a good cross section of the Fellowship areas sent to the 1981 Conference. The delegates' length of sobriety in A.A. ranged from 6 years to 30, averaging 12-3/4; ages, from 40 to 71, averaging 54½; years of involvement in A.A. service work, from 5 to 27, averaging 9-3/4.

Thorough Stocktaking Essayed in Floor and Workshop Discussions

"Our leaders are but trusted servants; they do not govern"

Appropriate to the inventory-taking theme, the first 1981 presentation/discussion, on Monday morning, surveyed applications of Tradition Two in present-day A.A. Before introducing the speakers, the moderator had some prefatory words to contribute:

Our primary purpose, at all levels of service, is to carry the message of recovery to all who still suffer.

Good personal leadership at all Conference levels is a primary necessity, and we might define good leadership as well-informed leadership. By looking back at Conference actions, we can use the experiences of the past in making decisions for the future.

We must continue to dedicate ourselves to insuring that there never, ever be any government in Alcoholics Anonymous. The only way we can really "govern" is by our own example.

Ern Manzano (Western Michigan)

'The responsibility is ours'

Probably, no other organization has encapsulated its purpose and structure as we have ours, clearly stated in the Steps and the Traditions. Somebody outside A.A. may find it hard to understand that it has all been done without a set of rules and with a minimum of organization. Our first members (many of them still alive and with us) had rare talents for just the perfect contribution, and this is yet another proof of God's providence to us. They have served us well, in responsibility and in humility. The fact that we do not pick them out for honors is no reason for us to be unappreciative, and we ought to study their experiences.

The service and thoughtfulness that go into the smooth running of our groups are not always known and appreciated. A.A.'s easygoing style and lack of rules can mislead the casual observer into thinking that it all happens for the best in some miraculous way. This is not so. But when we elect to office members who are themselves under that illusion, it sometimes does work out well for the members in question: They learn to be more responsible and rise to the opportunity. We all have the opportunity to benefit from having tasks put upon us.

If we are not always as well served as we might be, the responsibility is ours—to elect the right persons and to support them in the jobs. But let's hope we are not electing them to become authorities or all-knowing experts. The growing trend in the Fellowship for members to look to the delegate, area committee, or General Service Office for the decisive yes or no, acceptance or rejection, is, we feel, a dangerous path.

Suppose a member of a group and its G.S.R. have a difference of opinion or interpretation on a Tradition. Immediately, the delegate is called upon to render a "supreme court" ruling. The spirit of the Tradition is ignored in favor of the letter of the law. Or an area committee is asked to prepare a guide for the groups on how to hold an A.A. meeting, so that everything will be done properly. In our opinion, that is dangerously close to ritual. A local A.A. entity suggests that the sale of other than Conference-approved literature be discontinued in our groups—and somebody writes, telephones, or goes to G.S.O.

brandishing the Fourth Tradition and seeking the general manager's and staff members' approval for the continued sale of such books.

Could it be that consulting the enormous amount of shared experience in our service literature requires too much effort? Could it be that it is easier to ask for a ruling than to share and arrive at an informed group conscience?

As long as our members can accept as our sole authority "a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience," we shall continue to work things out together. If we can change the attitude that there is just one way to do things, our leaders will remain "trusted servants," and the work will get done.

God may have truly provided the message and inspired our program, but it is we who must work it under His blessing.

Denis Longtin (Southwestern Quebec)

No orders from headquarters

When G.S.O. is asked in correspondence for an "official" opinion, we reply that G.S.O. does not have an "official" opinion on any subject. We are not a legislative office, but a service office for A.A. groups and members. We make every effort to carry out the policies and decisions made by the General Service Conference and Board, and in turn, share these with groups and members worldwide.

Over the years, we have amassed voluminous files on all manner of subjects from A.A. members and groups all over the world. We make this information available to people who write for sharing on specific subjects. Many times, there are different solutions for similar problems. We offer these to the writer along with a suggestion that, in keeping with our Tradition of local autonomy, it's up to the A.A. members in the specific A.A. community to arrive at an informed group-conscience decision based on the information we are able to share and on local need.

As Bill said in our pamphlet "A.A. Tradition—How It Developed," "It is most clearly apparent that even here at the very center of A.A., there can only exist a center of service—custodians, editors, secretaries, and the like—each, to be sure, with a special vital function, but none of them with any authority to govern Alcoholics Anonymous."

Recent correspondence indicates that a large number of A.A. groups and members are concerned about the "health" of our Fellowship. Many seem to feel that A.A. is being taken away from the alcoholic by drug abusers, those who are dually addicted, court referrals, etc. Others feel that there should be more rigid observance of our Traditions as they relate to cooperation with outside agencies, anonymity, attraction versus promotion, etc. These feelings have led, in some instances, to growing rigidity within the Fellowship, as noted at a recent General Sharing Session. [See page 36.]

The following is a brief summary of staff sharing on two of the foregoing concerns.

Drug abuse—Our Preamble states that we share experience,

strength, and hope with each other to solve our "common problem and help others to recover from alcoholism." The fifth chapter of "Alcoholics Anonymous" states that "we deal with alcohol—cunning, baffling, powerful!" Our first duty as a fellowship is to insure our own survival. Therefore, we have to avoid distractions and multipurpose activity. We cannot give membership to nonalcoholic addicts; however, they are welcome to attend open A.A. meetings, provided, of course, that the groups are willing.

Dual addictions—A large number of people presently in A.A. are dually addicted—that is, addicted to alcohol and to pills or other mood-changing substances. Most A.A. groups do not encourage giving equal time to the discussion of addictions other than alcohol at A.A. meetings, but suggest this subject be discussed with a sponsor. Dually addicted people frequently get together and form a separate "meeting" to give equal time to discussion of drug problems and alcohol problems.

I am sober today because several yesterdays ago A.A. members—trusted servants—were concerned about fulfilling our primary purpose. How fortunate I am to be able to contribute daily to the services that make this possible.

Phyllis Masback, G.S.O. staff

A.A. 'authorities'—or the group conscience?

The concepts of individual freedom, group autonomy, and the absence of a leadership providing orders and instructions are among our most cherished principles. Since A.A.'s early years, it has been clearly understood by most members and groups that A.A. is not run from the top down in any human sense, but rather by the authority of "a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience" at every level of A.A. activity.

It has recently been suggested that some A.A. groups are beginning to yield their responsibility for autonomy and to look for specific direction from the service structure. For example: (1) Recent Conferences have been asked to approve requests to produce *guides* to working the Twelve Steps, to taking a Fourth Step inventory, and for daily meditation; (2) as a regional trustee, I'm sometimes asked the "official" or "New York" position; (3) at area assemblies and other service meetings, our Guidelines are waved about as if they were directives, rather than simply cumulative shared experience; (4) some delegates arrive at a Conference looking for answers to, or rulings on, questions that should be resolved by the local group conscience.

Are those of us involved in service contributing unintentionally to the feeling that A.A. has rules and regulations? Perhaps we could be a little less free with direct advice. Almost from the day the Alcoholic Foundation office (forerunner of G.S.O.) opened, groups writing for advice on an intended course of action would receive a reply to this effect: "We don't know. Why don't you try it? And please let us know how it works out." Today, letters from G.S.O. still reflect this spirit. When first active in service, I did a lot of reading and was ready with answers, often before the questions were asked. With some effort, it is becoming easier to say, "Why don't you just keep the group conscience working on it? And I'd sure like to know how it comes out."

A recent Regional Forum report, while noting that the Forum was just for sharing, stated that the Conference was the "decision- and policy-making body for A.A." Is this statement a little strong to describe a service structure clearly warranted *not* to act as a government for A.A.? Last year, we reported 72 Conference Advisory Actions. Many were for guidance of trustees, directors, and staff and can properly be called actions. Others dealt with routine Conference operations and hardly seem worth describing as such. Still others dealt with matters affecting members or groups on which we Conference members tried to share our experience and feelings. I think this sort of sharing can be of great help to the Fellowship; but perhaps we should report it, not as a Conference "action" or even "recommendation," but merely as Conference sharing or feeling.

In an effort to be helpful, we print Ask-It Basket questions and answers. The answers obviously cannot always reflect a well-considered group conscience, but are frequently cited as evidence of Conference thought. Year after year, we add to this stack of "authority" to be pored over by those of us anxious to furnish answers or find support for already-arrived-at points of view. I honestly feel it would be better to forgo publishing the Ask-It Basket than to use it in that way.

Finding a true group conscience requires a willingness to work and great patience. It can be painful. Simply arriving at a decision does not always mean that we have found a group conscience. To me, it seems important that: (1) the group should be willing to obtain information and to listen, so as to be *informed*; (2) care should be taken that all points of view are heard—a silent *minority* should be encouraged to express its view; (3) the group should be wary of the dominant personality or powerful advocate; (4) if an issue is sensitive, we should work slowly, discouraging formal motions until the group has a fairly clear sense of how it feels; (5) we should strive for near unanimity—with everyone comfortable with the outcome, even if not in full agreement. It is usually better to postpone a decision than to adjourn with a very unhappy minority.

I really have great faith that A.A. will not lose its spirit of autonomy and freedom. In my personal recovery, while there is plenty of help available, I have to make my own decisions and accept responsibility for the results. I believe that A.A. will continue to apply this principle to our group life as well. Our future as a fellowship depends on the willingness of our groups to accept responsibility for running their own affairs.

George Dorsey, Pacific U.S. regional trustee

Advisory Actions related to topics touched on in foregoing presentations: 27 (p. 47), 30-32 (pp. 47-48)

Staff sharing

Everyone who has received sharing letters from the G.S.O. staff can appreciate this one. One morning, a delegate stepped into the elevator and, by way of making conversation, remarked, "Hey, I've been so busy. I don't even know what day this is!" Vinnie McCarthy replied, "Experience indicates that it is Tuesday." . . . Then there was the morning later in the week when one of the more vocal Conference members asked Conference coordinator Sarah Price, "What can I do for you today?" The reply: "Stay away from the mike!"

Let's review our committee system

Monday afternoon, the first committee meetings, in which trustee committees met jointly with their Conference counterparts, were followed logically by this presentation/discussion. Virginia Hallman, East Central regional trustee, moderated.

Committees as vital communication links

The committee system, around which our service structure revolves, did not win easy approval by the Fellowship, and indeed, not by Bill Wilson, either. Bill points out in "A.A. Comes of Age" that for a long while, he wanted to "run" A.A. from New York but found through experience and growth that he couldn't do it. He had to have the help of committees.

The Alcoholic Foundation that Bill set up was, in effect, a committee of sorts at first, and the General Service Board, when it replaced the foundation, began by trying to operate as a single committee, discussing in depth all A.A. business. When that proved impossible, the committee system, as we now know it, began to evolve. A full discussion of its importance is set forth in the chapter on Concept Eleven.

At the time Bill presented the Conference structure for approval, there were few committees throughout the country, except local intergroups. The trustees met from time to time in New York, and our staff at the office tried to serve the groups; but there were no area, district, or Conference committees. Our only lines of communication went between the groups and intergroups and the office in New York. The amount of sharing among different parts of the country was small indeed compared to 1981. Only through our service structure, functioning through our committees, have these lines of communication grown to what we now know.

Trust is written into each segment of our service life, especially in our committees. The selection of people to fill the trustee committee assignments requires careful thought. If we have no part in the selection of a committee member, we trust those who made the selection, and after the committee meets, we trust the group conscience of that committee in its proceedings, although we may not always ratify its work.

The district committee members at home are generally chosen because of their dedication to A.A. and their experience as general service representatives. Their committee work is of a nature different from that of the Conference and trustee committees. D.C.M.'s deal with local problems. Knowing many A.A.'s in their districts and consulting with G.S.R.'s, they have the benefit of grass-roots input in their deliberations.

We try to share as much of our experience as possible in our Conference committee deliberations, but most Conference committee members know only a few A.A. members from other areas. So we rely upon our fellow committee members, just as our A.A. members at home trust us. Staff members, who are a part of the Conference and share with us their experiences at G.S.O., give each committee additional input in coming to a decision.

During the year, the Conference members receive each issue of the *Quarterly Report* on the meetings of the board of trustees, which take place three times between Conferences. We, as trustees, have input from nontrustee members of our commit-

tees, who are chosen because we need their help in arriving at decisions about publishing, public relations, finance, treatment facilities, correctional institutions, and other specialized fields. And how could we function without the help of our non-A.A. trustees, who are so dedicated? They have been indispensable members of our board committees.

Is our committee system performing well? I think so! Many times, I find fault with it and wish to change it, but that is usually when I don't get my own way. When I stop and truly reflect on this, I always come to the conclusion that a Master Planner has guided A.A. from its very beginning.

Sam Smith, Southeast U.S. regional trustee

As a Conference committee sees it

Although practically all my business life over the past 32 years (sober one day at a time) has been spent in the areas of management, sales, and finance, there are important differences in the relationship of people, principles, management, and money in A.A. The basic difference is in the Concepts, a God-given set of principles for the participative management of our Fellowship. Under them, all elements of A.A. make their individual contributions to decision-making, and the Conference Finance Committee thus has its place in the overall process.

I was a member of the Conference Finance Committee in 1980 and serve as its chairperson this year. It is composed of eight delegates (half Panel 30, half 31). During this Conference, its first meeting was a joint meeting with the trustees' Finance Committee and the outside auditor. Our other two meetings generally include only members of the Conference committee and its secretary, Dennis Manders, who has served A.A. over 30 years and so provides for us tremendous background and experience in the self-support principle of Alcoholics Anonymous. Out of our meetings is developed an agenda to present to the entire Conference. This agenda began as a result of communication after the last Conference among the secretary, chairperson, and other committee members. In its final form, it represents the group conscience of the committee and its contribution to A.A. for 1981.

At times, Floor Actions have been taken relating to Finance Committee concerns but outside the committee's agenda. For example, a 1979 Floor Action recommended "that simultaneous translation services (depending on foreign registration) be provided free of charge at the 1980 International Convention." This action was made on a more or less emotional basis. Total cost for the service was in excess of \$12,000. Handled under the committee system, the recommendation would have been referred to the Conference Finance Committee for review and evaluation as to propriety and cost. A 1980 Floor Action recommended that "when G.S.O. and Grapevine offices are expanded, the offices be modernized and the appearance of the reception area and office as a whole be vastly improved." That was and is an excellent idea; but even with the exercise of prudence, that part of the budget complying with the action will run in excess of \$100,000,¹ and with such a *carte blanche* from the Conference, the General Service Board could have spent hundreds of thousands more. If the proposal had been studied by the responsible committee, that minimum amount no doubt would have been approved. I feel, however, that some parameters would have been established as guidance; at

least, the Conference would have been aware of the cost involved before and not after the fact.

Late in the Conference, the committee chairperson reports the committee's recommendations to the entire Conference. Generally, there is discussion on the floor, motions, and votes. After all this give-and-take, actions are voted up or down, and the committee's work is history. The freedom of communication in the committee system is typical of our own freedom as members of A.A. The basic contribution of the committee system is its unique ability to give us all a sense of direction and, at the same time, allow for change and differences based on principles. The Conference Finance Committee, since 1951, has recommended to various Conferences ideas that boil down to a plea to go back to our areas, districts, and groups and encourage all to be totally involved in the principle of self-support. I think we continue to need this effort.

*Joe Phelan (Georgia), chairperson,
Conference Finance Committee*

1 For estimated total of all costs, see presentation on pp. 15-16

2 Advisory Actions related to topics touched on in foregoing presentation: 4 (p. 46), 13 (p. 46), 16 (p. 46)

How a trustee committee handles literature

The trustees' Literature Committee was established in 1951 at the request of the first General Service Conference. In 1952, the Conference established its own Literature Committee.

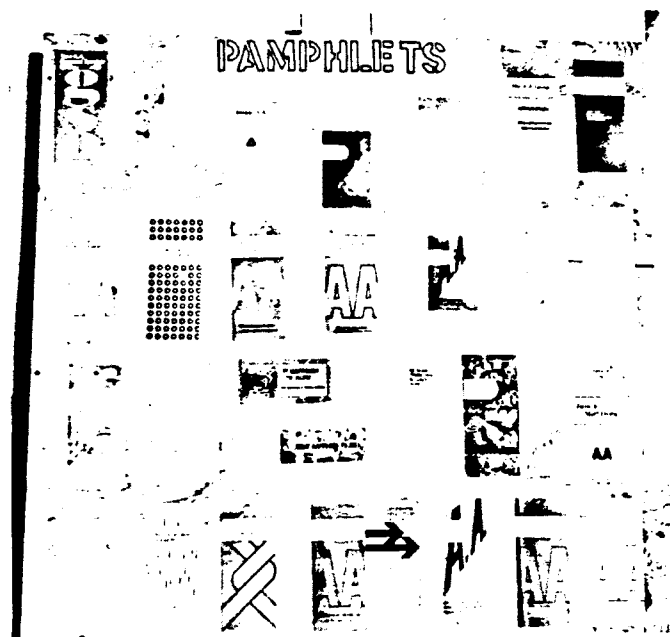
The board committee was expected to (1) suggest policies for A.A. publications, (2) anticipate functions of A.A. literature, (3) assess the effectiveness of current literature, and (4) respond to the needs and requests for various types of publications as expressed by A.A. groups and their representatives.

The following checkpoints were suggested: A.A. literature should (1) meet clearly established needs, indicated by its Conference approval, (2) be revised as needed to reflect the spiritual and physical growth of the Fellowship, (3) follow generally accepted editorial principles and practices, and (4) be reasonably standardized in format and design for maximum efficiency in printing, distribution, and use.

Over the years, the need for specialized literature has been clearly demonstrated. Since the organization of the trustees' Committees on Public Information, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Institutions and the two committees replacing the last (Correctional Facilities and Treatment Facilities), literature concerning those areas has been the province of those committees.

I have always been astounded by the way A.A. works. When I began my A.A. life, I was told that there were no bosses and A.A. was not organized. I expected chaos. And yet everything seemed to run smoothly and efficiently. At first, I thought that the literature was present by some act of divine providence. If A.A. was not organized, then how could there be all of these books and pamphlets? But more than that, each piece I read told me more about myself and reinforced what had been shared by you.

As I grew in sobriety, I learned how things got done at the



group level, and since I came to work at G.S.O., I have seen how things get done on a worldwide level. I am still astounded! A.A. works—and works better than many other organizations I have been involved with.

At times, the process may seem slow. An example could be our pamphlet "Time to Start Living." A suggestion to develop a piece for the older alcoholic was first submitted to the Literature Committee in 1956 and approved by the 1957 Conference. Delegates were asked to obtain case histories and ideas, but there were only 12 replies, and the suggestion was tabled. Over the years, the need for such a pamphlet was demonstrated, and in 1977, the process of developing it began—21 years later! The process could have been faster if, in 1956, some chief or boss had given the order, and if A.A. had an authoritarian structure. But would the result have been more beneficial to all of us, both present members and those yet to come? One answer may be found in a story told by a speaker at a convention I recently attended:

"If all of us in this room went on a journey to a star about 7,000,000 light-years away, and if we went 100,000 miles per hour, the round trip would take 600 years. When we started, we would all know who we were, where we had come from, where we were going, and why. But if that information wasn't carefully passed on, generation to generation, unchanged and intact, you could end up in 150 years with a ship full of people literally lost in space. I hope we pass on the message in our A.A. literature unchanged and unadulterated, so that years from now, when someone comes wandering into a meeting room, they won't find it full of people who don't know who they are, where they have come from, where they are going, or why."

Helen Turnquest, G.S.O. staff

Advisory Actions related to topic of foregoing presentation: 23-27 (p. 47), plus 19 others based on recommendations of Conference committees other than Literature

Workshop on same topic as this presentation/discussion: p. 22

Underground delegates

It was a rainy afternoon Tuesday of Conference week, when delegates were scheduled to visit the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices, and a good many wanted to go via subway and stay dry. A few staff members organized a group to walk underground from the Roosevelt Hotel, through Grand Central Station, to the famous New York City subway. Fortunately, it wasn't rush hour, but it took about 25 minutes for 15 people to buy tokens, figure out how to get through the turnstile (much laughter), and find their way down the stairs to wait for the train (one stop from the hotel to G.S.O.). One delegate exclaimed, "This is more exciting than the Conference!"

Should clubs receive the A.A. literature discount?

Bob Pearson, G.S.O. general manager, served as moderator of the brief but spirited discussion that followed this presentation, Monday evening.

'Abide by the Traditions'

Not long after A.A. came into being, some members felt they needed a place to be together. Since that time, clubs seem to have come as a result of A.A. growth, in big and small cities. Some abide by the Traditions; others, by their own house rules. I believe we will always have clubs; though some members do not need them, others do.

There always has been some misunderstanding as to the relationship of clubs to A.A. groups. One of the rules in the club I come from is that you have to be an A.A. member to belong. But a person does not have to be a club member to belong to A.A. As a result of those misunderstandings, it became evident that it was advisable to remove the name of A.A. from all clubhouses.

G.S.O. does not take contributions from clubs but does accept them from A.A. groups that meet in clubhouses, because they are A.A. If G.S.O. has given the A.A. discount on bulk orders to clubs in the past, then this is not in keeping with Tradition Six: "An A.A. group ought never endorse, finance, or lend the A.A. name to any related facility or outside enterprise, lest problems of money, property, and prestige divert us from our primary purpose." Granting clubs the A.A. discount on bulk orders may cause problems for the district librarian and the intergroup services—there would be competition.

A.A. members are complaining to the district and G.S.O. over the difference in prices. It is not in keeping with our policy as set down in our Literature Order Form. In some areas, we found a price difference of \$2 per copy of the Big Book between the A.A. groups and clubs. The A.A. groups had to comply with our price guide. The club was making a profit, which is its right, as the A.A. name was taken down from the club.

The A.A. member is entitled to Conference-approved books at A.A. prices. If A.A. groups, district committee members, and librarians are not carrying out their responsibilities by having those books on hand for distribution within our Fellowship, then they fail to carry the message.

On the other hand, our policy of cooperation without affilia-

tion to the clubs seems to call for selling A.A. Conference-approved literature to them at quantity discount prices for non-A.A. purchase, as set down on page 8 of our Literature Order Form. I feel that clubs should fall under that bracket. The matter has to be settled at this Conference. If we feel that we have to give the A.A. discount to everybody, then we have to change Tradition Six and the Preamble. I have a responsibility to A.A., as you have, to abide by the Traditions.

Bernard (Skip) Murphy (Northeastern Ontario)

Floor Action related to topic of foregoing presentation: 1 (p. 46)

Communication within the service structure

Monday evening wound up with a workshop for which Conference members divided into ten sections, each with a moderator and a reporter. Panel 30 delegates, trustees, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors may serve in those capacities.

Workshop produces ample improvement ideas

1 "To what extent should we expect the groups to be aware of and interested in the work and thought of our annual General Service Conference meeting? Is this important for A.A. unity?"

It was generally felt that groups should be greatly interested in the work of our Conference, since they are the keepers of the Fellowship. Following are some of the suggestions made: (a) attractive delegate reports, sharing enthusiasm for the Conference; (b) sponsorship into service; (c) G.S.R. "schools" and pre-Conference workshops to better inform members of current issues and of the workings of the Conference as a whole, because the groups' awareness is vitally important.

2 "How effective is our communication? How can it be improved?"

Comment from one workshop indicated that communication within the service structure can be improved by dissemination of information through: attendance at Regional Forums, service workshops, newsletters, sponsorship into service, showing of filmstrips from G.S.O., and personal service stories and experience.

a At the Conference level: (1) Most felt communications were excellent; (2) one workshop said that the *Final Report* of the Conference should be available earlier and that the delegate should give more reports.

b At the area level: (1) Communication was seen as generally good; (2) it was suggested that it can be improved through (a) encouraging more people to participate, (b) using service tools, e.g., literature, films, newsletters, (c) observing rotation, to get more people involved, (d) having area post office box for G.S.R. to mail communications to area secretary, (e) having active D.C.M.'s communicate at area level, (f) presenting more talks about our service structure, (g) explaining committee system as described in "Twelve Concepts."

c At the district level: (1) Workshop responses varied from "good" to "poor"; (2) suggestions for improvement included

(a) more committee meetings, (b) better communications with G.S.O. (some D.C.M.'s are not on the G.S.O. mailing list), (c) workshops on the functions of a D.C.M., (d) district meetings that provide G.S.R.'s with information on the service structure, (e) presentations on the Concepts (one area has such presentations and says they stimulate a great deal of interest).

Advisory Actions related to topic of workshop: 5 (p. 46), 17 (p. 46), 20 (p. 47)



World Service Meeting

The report on the 1980 World Service Meeting, given Tuesday morning, turned out to be more than a routine report. The "freshman" U.S./Canada delegate was as impressed by his first Meeting as Panel 31 was by its first Conference.

'A great gift of love'

By a chance of timing only—the date of my election as a trustee—I was chosen as a World Service Meeting [W.S.M.] delegate. Although I had heard of the Meeting, read the reports, and talked with past W.S.M. delegates, I was not prepared for the emotional effect I would experience.

I suppose we all imagine, as we walk in our worlds of make-believe, that we may one day visit A.A. in other lands. Before that could happen to me, members of A.A. from other lands visited us. Most of the delegates spoke English; some, better than others; all, with varying degrees of accent, often difficult to understand. However, I had a feeling that I pray each and every member of the Fellowship will one day experience. That feeling is often expressed in Alcoholics Anonymous as "the language of the heart."

Anne O'Connor, delegate from Australia, set the tone for the Meeting in her keynote address, in which she said: "The theme of our Sixth World Service Meeting is 'Service—the Heart of A.A.', and I feel that no other universal symbol could be more appropriate for this aspect of our Fellowship than the heart." Whatever the word in each of our mother languages, the heart is used to signify these three ideas: It is the embodiment of love; it is the very core around which all else is built; and it is the vital organ upon which life depends. And do not all of those concepts apply to our great Third Legacy of Service?

As I sat and listened to the sharing, participating when I felt the need, I often remembered a tape of a talk by Dr. Bob, in which he suggested that those among us who fail to acquire the spirit of service may have missed the single most important

principle in our Fellowship. There was at this W.S.M. a spirit of service among people from throughout the world who had dedicated themselves to A.A. and had made it a life purpose to serve God by serving their fellows.

The delegates accepted their several tasks and undertook to try to smooth the way for the still-suffering alcoholic in all lands. Actions were handled in a manner similar to the means adopted for this Conference. All delegates enthusiastically visited Stepping Stones, where Lois [Wilson, widow of A.A. co-founder Bill] was our gracious hostess for the afternoon. That visit, the delegates said, made the whole of the A.A. story real for them.

The Meeting adjourned; the delegates packed their bags and bade their farewells, with friendly embraces and handshakes and often with tears. Then we were off to the International Convention in New Orleans. The International Committee had recommended that an international booth be available there. However, the idea seemed to have gotten lost in the momentum of the busy year. I received a call asking about the booth, and I said, "Well, let's leave it in the hands of God. We'll try and work it out." As we all know, things do work out in A.A. The problem was presented to the W.S.M. delegates, who, in true A.A. style, volunteered to serve at the booth. These rotating volunteers made a significant contribution, acting as interpreters and troubleshooters for Convention-goers from their own countries, and certainly making a host of new friends.

I look forward to Mexico in 1982. At our board meeting in July, we will elect a new W.S.M. delegate [succeeding Virginia Hallman], for a four-year term. He or she will receive a great gift of love, a gift that I had never thought possible.

In the closing remarks for the W.S.M., Tomas Tomasson of Iceland said: "Not far from here, on the island of Manhattan, towering on the bank of the East River, is the building of the United Nations. The U.N. could learn much from a worldwide fellowship of alcoholic people who have quietly done so much to create friendship and understanding among people of different nations, regardless of race, color, and diverse background."

The World Service Meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous has become the cornerstone of international cooperation and relations within the Fellowship.

Stan Cameron, W.S.M. delegate (U.S./Canada)

A.A. World Services

Tuesday afternoon, aspects of A.A. W.S. operations were studied in a presentation/discussion moderated by one of that corporation's directors, Virginia Turner.

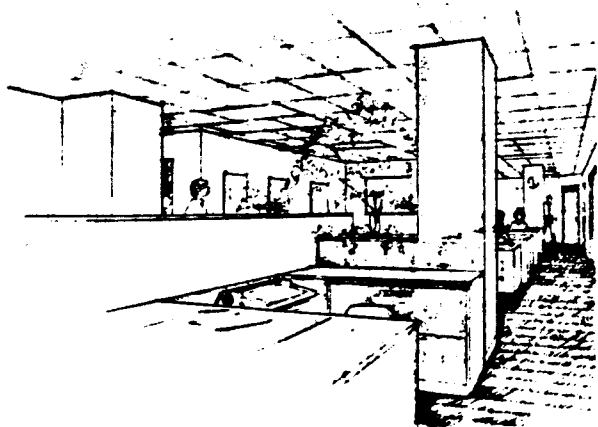
Office redesigned for better service

The G.S.O. and Grapevine offices have been at 468 Park Avenue South since 1970 under a ten-year lease. Because of the growth of A.A. and the expansion of services rendered, it has been apparent for several years that additional space would be required at the expiration of the lease—either at 468 Park or elsewhere. The overcrowding, inefficient layout, and Spartan furnishings must have been obvious to most visitors.

The 1977 and 1978 Conferences thoroughly considered the possibility of relocating G.S.O. and the Grapevine in another city, and each Conference recommended that it was not in the best interests of A.A. to do so at this time.

In 1979, the General Service Board authorized entering into a new lease, including badly needed additional space. After investigating alternate locations, it was decided to negotiate a new lease at 468 Park and 470 Park, which is connected to it. Though our lease was not due to expire until December 31, 1980, a new ten-year lease, including additional space, was obtained at 1979 market prices, with the proviso that the old rental would continue until January 1, 1981, and with other favorable provisions.

In addition to standard office buildings, New York City has many "loft type" buildings, where empty floor space is rented and the tenant is responsible for *all* improvements. The base rent in such buildings is relatively low, but improvements and services must be figured into total rental costs. Both 468 and 470 Park Avenue South are loft-type buildings. G.S.O. and the Grapevine occupied three-plus floors (about 22,000 square feet) at a base rent of \$5.20 per square foot per year. The new lease covers four full floors (about 27,500 square feet) for \$6.70 per square foot—remarkable when compared with average rentals of \$25 per square foot for "improved" office space in Manhattan and \$15 (and up) in most other cities and towns in the U.S. and Canada. Even comparable loft space in Manhattan rents today for nearly double the new lease figure. The



The complete clearing of "loft" space left designers free to plan G.S.O. quarters, with stenographers' desks just outside staff members' offices.

cost of the proposed reconstruction, plus recommended refurbishing, refurbishing, and moving expense, will add \$2.77 per square foot per year, bringing the overall renting cost to \$9.47 per square foot—still a remarkable bargain.

The initial outlay for reconstruction, etc. (based on \$2.77 per square foot per year) amounts to \$761,762, to be funded out of operating income and, to the extent needed, from the General Service Board Reserve Fund. When this budget figure was submitted to the trustees' Finance Committee and to the board, one trustee pointed out that increased working room and improved working environment would result in \$76,000 per year worth of increased efficiency, and would make it easier to continue to hire high-quality office help. None of that initial outlay comes from group contributions; G.S.O.'s cost of group services exceeds total group contributions, so unusual and nonrecurring budget items such as this must be paid from publishing income, which also supplies the Reserve Fund.

Every function, except the Grapevine's, will move—some into temporary space first and then into permanent space. The Grapevine offices, remaining in the same area, will be enlarged, rearranged, and refurbished. When construction and moving are completed, G.S.O. and the Grapevine will have more attractive workplaces, with more elbow room, new air conditioning and phone systems, carpeting where functions permit, better rest rooms, employees' lounges on every floor (larger, too), conference rooms on every floor, more plants, fresh paint, and better lighting.

The completion date is now targeted for November 1981, because a tenant in part of the additional space, scheduled to move out in January, could not leave until the end of March. As the new rent was contingent on delivery of that space, the delay did not increase the rent.

Martin Le Boutillier, A.A.W.S. director

How A.A. publishing benefits the groups

Sometime next year, A.A. will publish the three millionth Big Book—and about 7,000,000 other books and pamphlets. We own and operate a publishing business that would gross about \$20,000,000 at retail if we sold our literature at typical commercial prices.

We didn't originally intend to get into the publishing business and make such a success of it—simply to carry the message more widely and effectively than word of mouth alone could. In 1938, A.A.'s briefly thought of having Harper's publish the Big Book, and it had agreed to do so. Where we would be today if our literature were subject to the editorial, promotional, and financial policies of a commercial, profit-making organization, no one can guess.

We have created and controlled our own literature from the beginning, under the guidance of this Conference. That seems to me an essential part of our Seventh Tradition ability to manage our own affairs. In fact, the success of the publishing operation is one reason we are self-supporting. G.S.O. is supported primarily by money from two sources—group contributions and publications. If group contributions increased to the point that they covered G.S.O. expenses on behalf of the groups or went even further, our literature could be sold at

cost or even less. We haven't come anywhere near that point, although there have been recent price reductions.

In 1970, the number of books published was about 100,000; in 1980, it was 700,000, a rate of increase of 21% per year. The total number of items (books and pamphlets) published has risen from 2,100,000 to 6,300,000. The gross revenue from those sales has risen from \$525,000 to \$3,800,000, or 22% per year.

In the past decade, the cost of the average hardcover book has risen from \$11.66 to about \$24; the price of our Big Book, from \$4 to \$4.65. It is remarkable that we can operate at such a low pricing level and still generate net income to help support G.S.O. and intergroup/central office activities. A.A.W.S. employees have accomplished this near miracle, coordinating the activities of about 20 outside firms that supply the materials and do the printing of our books and pamphlets. Distribution costs are held down and responsiveness is increased by the warehouses established to serve the U.S. and Canada. Because we want to be able to respond on short notice to orders of any size and for any of the hundred-odd items we carry, as much as \$1,000,000 of A.A. money may be tied up in inventory.

The Big Book, with its distribution averaging 1,000 copies a day, goes on a lot of Twelfth Step calls!

John Bragg, A.A.W.S. director

Advisory Actions related to topic of foregoing presentation: 1 (p. 46), 16 (p. 46)

G.S.O. 'stands ready to serve'

In "As Bill Sees It," Bill wrote, "The A.A. General Service Office is by far the largest single carrier of the A.A. message. It has well related A.A. to the troubled world in which we live . . . and stands ready to serve the special needs of any group or isolated individual, no matter the distance or language." The service side of G.S.O. is in the able hands of 11 trusted servants—staff members who all belong to A.A. Each has four areas of responsibility:

Staff responsibility #1 is the functional assignment given to each member. For example, Susan Daly is charged with public information; Lois Fisher, with cooperation with the professional community; Helen Turnquest, with literature coordination; and so on.

Staff responsibility #2 is to serve as secretary to the trustee committee of the General Service Board that relates to her or his functional assignment, and also to the corresponding Conference committee. For example, Sarah Price, who has been bombarding you with mail in recent months, is secretary to the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and the Conference Agenda Committee. (Sarah just happens to be co-secretary to the trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, because she will rotate into the Convention assignment in 1984. Talk about "not projecting"!)

Staff responsibility #3. Most staff members handle all the group correspondence for a specified region of the U.S. or Canada. No matter what the question, concern, or problem, all

the groups in that region have a specific staff member to turn to. For example, Vinnie McCarthy handles Eastern Canada, while June Russell handles the Pacific Region of the U.S. Beth Kuhlmann doesn't have a region; she has the whole rest of the world, handling correspondence from overseas and Spanish-speaking countries.

Staff responsibility #4 is covered on our staff-assignments chart by the catchall word "other," which covers a multitude of difficult tasks. For example, Lyla Bonney edits my own personal favorite among our regular publications, the *Loners-Internationalists Meeting* by mail. Meanwhile, Curtis Monahan is doing yeoman service with the *Institutions Bulletin*; Betty Liddle edits *Box 4-5-9*; and so on. A lot of loving work to help the still-suffering alcoholic.

Obviously, someone has to see that everything runs smoothly—and that falls on the shoulders of our staff coordinator, Phyllis Masback. That's her functional assignment. You name it—and Phyllis does it. She is responsible for coordinating the quarterly meetings of the General Service Board.

Now, there is one thing absolutely unique about the staff members: Every other year, they change jobs within G.S.O.! Assignments are rotated; so are the regions they correspond with—and even their offices! At regular intervals, fresh thinking is brought to each area of concern; no one can become a "bleeding deacon" about his or her favorite job.

At each A.A.W.S. board meeting, examples of interesting mail received since our last meeting may be read by staff, breathing life into our work and encapsulating the nature of the staff's mission. For example, Beth recently shared this letter from a nonalcoholic nurse who is carrying our message in a Mennonite Christian hospital in Taiwan:

"Two days ago, I was in a village and asked the pastor how the A.A. program was doing. They are doing it their own way, but are getting results. They have divided the whole village into eight groups. Each meets one night a week. Drinking has decreased markedly. This applies to both men and women. In the past, it was mostly men, but now more and more women are getting involved, which affects the family and the care of children even more than it did in the past."

I think we are all lucky to have the kind of service office we do have to help carry our message wherever it is needed.

Lou Kraus, A.A.W.S. director

A.A. Grapevine

Moderated by Don Daly, chairperson of the Grapevine Corporate Board, this Wednesday-morning presentation/discussion comprised varying outlooks on our A.A. magazine.

Where Grapevines go in the U.S. and Canada

For the Conference each year, the Grapevine staff prepares a chart showing a geographical breakdown of circulation. Last April, I was looking over the chart affectionately. Touching likenesses—little Delaware with as many subscribers as huge Alaska; New Brunswick plus Prince Edward Island nodding to

Mississippi with their equal 700. Mammoth phenomena like California with 10,000, or Ontario with 7,000. I wondered: Is there a pattern to it? If the differences in population density and proportion of A.A. members could be neutralized, would one see most Grapevines going where a meeting in print would be most needed—where groups are fewer and harder to get to?

I arranged U.S. and Canadian census figures with our 1980 tabulation, so that A.A. regions, and the states and provinces within them, can be compared—roughly, because the comparisons depend on groups' membership estimates, thought to be low in general, but not uniformly so. Then, too, there's the difficulty of interpretation. If X has more A.A. members per 10,000 population, is it because X had more drunks, or did its A.A.'s work harder? If X's subscription rate is low, is it a lack of money, or of awareness of the Grapevine, or of a reading habit? The figures will be of more interest for raising than for answering questions.

The first large difference to appear is that Canada is very active, averaging 19 A.A. members per 10,000 population, 50 Grapevine subscribers per 100 reported members (reported, that is, in A.A. directories), and so 10 Grapevines per 10,000 people. For the U.S., it comes out 16 A.A. members per 10,000 population, 29 subscribers among 100 members, and so 5 Grapevines among 10,000 people. Not that ordinary citizens are expected to want Grapevines, but the figure suggests two factors affecting Grapevine circulation: size of membership; response of members to their magazine.

With the most inclusive gauge—magazines per 10,000 population—five of the U.S. regions are average or but little less, and there are three high regions: Western Canada (12), West Central U.S. (10), and Eastern Canada (8).

A.A. members per 10,000 population: (a) *low regions*—Southwest, from Kansas (16, average) to Oklahoma (8) and Arkansas (9), and Southeast, from Florida (14) and Virginia (12) to several states with 5 or 6; (b) *average regions*—Central, from Illinois (19) to Indiana (11), and Northeast, from Connecticut (33) to Pennsylvania (11); (c) *high regions*—Pacific, from California (33) and Alaska (25) down to Oregon and Utah (both 10), and West Central, from Minnesota (50) to Wyoming (15, about average).

Grapevine subscribers per 100 members: (a) *Pacific Region*—appears low, but take out California's large A.A. population, and the figure for the region changes from 19 to 38 (higher figures for Washington, Oregon, Idaho, and Nevada); (b) *West Central*—Minnesota has about two-thirds of the region's membership and a percentage of subscribers below the U.S. average, but the other six states average 41, with very high figures for North Dakota, Wyoming, and Montana (58, 54, 49); (c) *East Central*—from Wisconsin (39) down to Illinois (21); (d) *North-east*—from Maine, Vermont, and Rhode Island (45, 53, 49) through New York, New Jersey, and Pennsylvania (close to 29, about average), down to Connecticut (19); (e) *Southwest*—from Colorado (36) up to Oklahoma (73), with Texas about average; (f) *Southeast*—from Florida (37) to Alabama (55), South Carolina (64), West Virginia (63), and Mississippi (63).

Wherever membership may be underreported, the true subscriber percentage might be lower. But the foregoing figures do suggest that the Grapevine does tend to go oftener to the more sparsely populated areas—certain states and much of Canada.

States and provinces above average in both factors (A.A. members per 10,000 people and Grapevine subscribers among members) are Alaska, British Columbia with Yukon and Northwest Territories, Saskatchewan, Manitoba, both Dakotas, and Nebraska.

But do the more crowded and urbanized areas really have a lesser need for our excellent "meeting in print"? The more I talk with people who use the magazine eagerly, the more I realize how much help it gives for one's growth in sobriety and in quality of message-carrying. The foregoing figures mainly ask us: Where may we be forgetting to go with our gift of sobriety? In the latest circulation breakdown [see inside back cover of this report], you may find new questions—or perhaps even answers—that will help us extend the reach of our Grapevine.

Mary Phelps, Grapevine director

'A labor of love'

When I came to the staff of the Grapevine two years ago. I was not unfamiliar with the process of getting our magazine to the printer each month. I had done free-lance work for the Grapevine before that. What I did not know then was the incredible feeling of elation to see a product of labor and A.A. love come into being each month. None of my prior experience ever gave me the satisfaction of knowing I was producing something that might be helpful to others. For this, and many other reasons, I can say I love my job!

My job is associate editor of the Grapevine, and I am chiefly concerned with the graphics, art, and layout of the magazine. We at the Grapevine have a strong feeling that if we can make each issue more attractive and pleasing to the eye, it will invite more and more readership. The Grapevine is limited to two colors. Actually, the second color is used only on the front and back covers. For the front cover, we start with a thumbnail sketch that is used for evaluation of the idea by our "group conscience" in the office. If we like the idea, it is then drawn to actual size, and the printer is consulted as to its feasibility within our limit of two colors. With tints, overprints, and various combinations of printing and overprinting, it is possible to achieve a more realistic effect—as if at least four colors had been used.

Then there is the regular process of doing the layout of the entire issue. Believe me, involved as it may seem, it is one of the most fun parts of the whole procedure—partly, I suspect, because it gives you an excuse to make an ungodly mess of cut paper and scraps all over the floor. A symptom of rebellion carried over from childhood, maybe?

The selection of artists to do the illustrations is exciting, because you are always quite sure the regular contributing artists will be busy, on vacation, or not available for other reasons. But somehow, they always come through. Grapevine illustrations and articles are done by members of the Fellowship, who are not paid for the contributions that make up our "meeting in print."

One of the chief joys of being a member of the Grapevine staff is the almost constant flow of visitors to our office. Meeting people from all over the world almost daily is gratifying and

uplifting. Although we come from many cultures and have varying customs, we are all one in our Fellowship—where else in the world can you find that?

My involvement with the Grapevine is really a labor of love, rather than a job.

Tom Neary, Grapevine staff

Inflation versus Tradition Seven

The Grapevine's circulation is close to 126,000, an impressive figure. But if we have over 1,000,000 members in A.A., what are the others reading? We hope they're reading other A.A. literature, but why not also the Grapevine?

We're often asked through correspondence and personal contact: Why is it that only 10% of our members read the Grapevine? We really don't know the answer, but it would seem to be a communications problem. In the past four years, about 20% of the A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada have chosen to get involved with the GvR project. About 4% of our increase in circulation over the last three years can be credited to this activity. We believe there is a direct correlation between this activity and the use of the Grapevine within the group, with more awareness of the magazine as a valuable sobriety tool.

We believe that there is a true *need* for the product, so we have a responsibility to offer the best product we can. But there is another important aspect: the cost of getting the magazine to its readers. Inflation has been hard on us. In October 1979, an analysis showed that, over a three-year period, income from the magazine had increased 32% while the cost of *printing and mailing* (salaries excluded) had increased 77%! Circulation increased 10.8% and 11.3% during two of those years—the effect of the GvR program. At the same time, miscellaneous-item sales increased to the extent that those profits offset the loss taken on the magazine.

The Grapevine Corporate Board has been reluctant to increase prices except when facing a clear necessity. From 1944 to 1946, the price per issue was 15¢; 1946-57, 25¢; 1957-74, 35¢; 1974-80, 50¢. In light of the October 1979 analysis, an increase was once again inevitable; in July 1980, the price was raised to 60¢.

Nevertheless, the Grapevine has had a loss from operations for two years in a row, though much effort has been made to reduce costs. The audited report of the Grapevine's 1980 financial statement shows that operating income increased 10%, while expenses were higher by 19.6%, resulting in a net operating loss of \$113,000. Expenses had increased 20% in 1980, 23% in 1979, and 16% in each of the three years before that.

Earned subscription income in 1980 was higher by \$48,700, of which \$10,000 can be attributed to the increase in subscription rates; the balance, to increased circulation. Calendar sales were not as anticipated in the budget, but did bring in an income of \$70,000, of which \$20,000 was realized as a profit.

Cash flow was a problem in 1980. In July, \$40,000 was advanced to the Grapevine from the General Service Board; the Grapevine returned it in December. Our cash position at the end of the year was \$33,246. However, with the application of



“How can the Grapevine keep in touch with your group if you don't have a GvR?”*

***Grapevine Representative**

On this new poster, the Grapevine's familiar Victor E. makes a tearful plea for more groups to establish connections with our magazine.

\$48,000 interest on Grapevine investment with the Reserve Fund, we were able to start 1981 with about \$75,000 of operating cash.

Our 1981 budget, already tight, will have to be adjusted because of postal increases. Even before that, an operating loss had been projected. We hope that as our 1980 price increase catches hold, it will be sufficient to cover increased costs, and perhaps our deficit will be lower than projected.

If our experience does not improve during 1981, it will certainly be necessary to consider another price increase. (The Finance Committee has encouraged us to think in terms of small increases when they do become necessary.) It is important for us to remember that we are self-supporting through our own contributions and that, to the extent possible, each entity within the Fellowship should probably adhere to that maxim.

This problem is not new for the Grapevine. During the years 1947-51, an advance from the General Service Board was necessary to assist the Grapevine in financing operating deficits. In 1963, the final payment on that advance was made; since that time, the Grapevine has contributed more than \$116,000 to the board.

John Ryall, Grapevine director

The Grapevine in the A.A. community

My first contact with the Grapevine was during my initial “30 meetings in 30 days” whirlwind tour of A.A. meetings. At one of these meetings, fate (or a cunning sponsor) allowed me to win a one-year subscription to the A.A. Grapevine in a free drawing. Shortly thereafter, old John Barleycorn and I were again on close terms. Each month for the year of hell that followed, my Grapevine arrived, to remind me of another way of life. These unsolicited Twelfth Step calls eventually helped me to return to the meetings. Through this experience, I have come to believe that the Grapevine is one of our most valuable tools in Twelfth Step work. It was my lifeline to A.A.

As daily meetings became a pleasure rather than a penance, the Grapevine began to provide a means of growth to me. One

meeting I attended used the Grapevine as source for the topic of each week's discussion. Hearing opinions of "elder statesmen" on current Grapevine articles allowed me to assimilate different views and form an *informed* opinion. I soon began to look forward eagerly to each new Grapevine.

The Grapevine has also been a valuable tool in sponsorship of new people. If I use the December indexes, almost any question a newcomer asks can be answered with at least four or five different opinions, rather than only mine (often biased). With these views for a base, the newcomer can search his conscience for his own answers. When I point out to those I sponsor the value of service in sobriety, Grapevine articles help in my attempt to get them involved.

We in Idaho are trying to make the Grapevine more accessible to the A.A. community. A full day's workshop or mini-conference was held in one of our districts, with the Grapevine as the major theme for the day. The area Grapevine chairperson discussed the magazine's history and listed ways in which the Grapevine can become a community tool: All school libraries in the district receive a complimentary Grapevine each month, thanks to contributions; many individual groups sponsor subscriptions for prison groups; as a result of liaison between the area Grapevine chairperson and members of the "alumni" association of a local treatment center, the Grapevine is being purchased for newly discharged patients; the "Lose a Grapevine" suggestion in a recent *Box 4-5-9* is being followed.

Perhaps I could have gotten sober without the Grapevine, but having it has sure made sobriety a lot more enjoyable.

*Pat Enright (Idaho), chairperson,
Conference Grapevine Committee*

George Dorsey (regional trustee, Pacific U.S.) was seen on the Conference floor late in the week wearing a T-shirt that displayed a conspicuous lack of humility. But it wasn't *his* idea. At his regional luncheon on Thursday, delegates wearing red T-shirts had given George a blue one bearing the legend "The Ultimate Authority." . . . Delegate chairperson Jackie Jones (Panel 30, Kentucky) received a different kind of recognition when she stepped to the podium at the delegates meeting: a vase of red roses from the Quebec areas.

A business office produces an 'A.A. meeting'

The Grapevine office is a business office, so it faces the problems that any business must deal with. Intermingled with these, because we are a different type of organization, are A.A. love and the guidance of our Traditions. I remember a past editor saying, "The Traditions are our bosses." Actually, as managing editor, I report to the Grapevine Corporate Board, but our directors also look to the Traditions for guidance.

Because A.A. is such a special organization, our "meeting in print" is not a standard business product. Each completed Grapevine represents a joint effort of all Grapevine employees and the members of the Fellowship who share the A.A. experience published in the magazine. We try to select contributions that give an accurate cross section of A.A. thinking, though the Grapevine does not speak for A.A. as a whole—that's spelled out on the first inside page each month. Unfortunately,

it seems some of our readers don't read the fine print; they take Grapevine articles as "gospel," quoting from an article as if it was the definitive word, instead of just one member's opinion. Then, too, A.A. members don't always agree with one another. Bill called the magazine "a forum for debate." Sometimes, there is a very fine line between debate within the Fellowship and a public controversy. When the editors are concerned about a piece that seems too close to the line, we seek a broader group conscience by sharing with our Editorial Board.

The Editorial Department, while major in importance, is just one part of the overall operation. Once the articles have been selected, they have to be set in type, proofread, arranged on the pages, and printed. Consideration has to be given to the quality of printing, and to obtaining the best quality at the lowest price. We work on three issues at a time, in varying stages of production.

Next, we have to get the Grapevine to its readers. Our mailing is done by a computerized mailing house over on Long Island, and we're busy talking to that computer every day. Our Circulation Department processes orders and tells the computer about each one in terms it will understand. Yes, it's pretty complicated—but when the finished issue reaches Long Island each month, the computer can tell the mailing house where on earth to send about 126,000 magazines.

Our Circulation and Bookkeeping Departments work closely together. At certain times—after our spring all-groups mailing or when Christmas gift subscriptions start coming in—it seems impossible to cope with the thousands of orders. However, we always make it.

In addition, an enormous amount of correspondence is required. Apparently, many of our subscribers don't look closely at the subscription form, with its reminder that six to eight weeks may go by before they receive their first magazine. The reason for that time lapse? Each month, there is a cutoff date—once it's past, we can't get the information to the computer until the following month. Also, there are problems with changes of address, as the post office will not forward second class mail. When a magazine is returned to us (and we pay postage for that return), we have to hold up that subscription until we get a new address. A.A.'s seem to move around a lot, and not all of them remember to notify us of their moves. Again, there is a cutoff date on the changes of address that we feed to the computer.

Orders for all our miscellaneous items, as well as subscriptions, are processed in and mailed from the Grapevine office.

A special project is the GvR program. We now have one full drawer of correspondence with area Grapevine chairpersons alone. In addition, our secretary communicates regularly with GvRs as they write to us. We also do a mailing of our "High-lights" (previews of the upcoming issue) to all of our GvRs. The GvR is to our office what the G.S.R. is to G.S.O.—our communications link with the A.A. group.

Grapevine staff members sit in on the G.S.O. staff meetings every week. One of our staff attends each A.A.W.S. board meeting; one of the G.S.O. staff, each of the Grapevine's Editorial and Corporate Board meetings. Separate corporations, yes—but one Fellowship.

If you should ask what is most important in the Grapevine operation, I would not be able to tell you. You might think it is the magazine itself, and I'm inclined to think that, too—except that the magazine wouldn't be very important if finished issues never reached any readers. Every phase of the Grapevine operation is important.

Retha Gresham, Grapevine staff

Advisory Actions involving the Grapevine: 18-22 (pp. 46-47)

Regional Forums—how well are they working?

Milton Maxwell, chairperson of the General Service Board, was a natural choice to moderate this presentation/discussion, on Thursday afternoon. He has been deeply interested in Regional Forums since their inception (on a trial basis) in late 1975 and early 1976.

'A good service foundation'

How well do you think these Forums are working? I can express only my experience—how they affect me and my area.

At the request of my sponsor, I had the privilege of attending the first Regional Forum held in South Dakota. He did not know what we were going to experience, and I did not realize just how important it was—and still is—to inform A.A.'s fully about our fabulous program.

Before that first Forum, I had no idea how dedicated the G.S.O. staff, the trustees, and the delegates were. The average A.A. in our community does not have the privilege of seeing our service structure in action. Regional Forums also remind many A.A. members that they themselves—not G.S.O. or its trusted servants—hold the key to the welfare of A.A. Forums bring out A.A. principles, as well as the intent of its service structure.

At Regional Forums, many A.A. members may ask questions from the floor or through the Ask-It Basket about matters that really concern them. Questions are answered in the light of what seems best for A.A. as a whole. This, I think, is vital to keeping our Fellowship healthy.

The membership of A.A. is growing by leaps and bounds as a result of good cooperation with our friends in the many public and private agencies that are referring people to our Fellowship. Our groups need a good service foundation so they can keep our program intact, and I can think of no better way than Regional Forums to let groups' new trusted servants get service information.

Forum agendas, provided by G.S.O. in cooperation with delegates in the host region, spark genuine interest in the minds of our local trusted servants and potential trusted servants. All A.A. members, young or old, already interested or indifferent, can actually see the awesome responsibility that we all have to protect our way of life. Through this type of service, we honestly communicate, face-to-face.

The next service that I believe is very important is more mini-forums in areas too remote for lots of members to participate. It's not that A.A.'s in such areas are not interested in attending

Regional Forums; it's totally a matter of the time and money needed to travel long distances. I sincerely believe that we owe this service to areas like that until they can build larger membership and greater local strength. The mini-forum idea has been conceived; when it is born, it will surely be a great asset to our Fellowship.

Doug Beck (South Dakota)



'Just fine'—but with room for improvement

My first thought was: How can we "fix" Regional Forums? Thank goodness, I discussed the subject with a few others who had attended Forums.

Only two people from my area went to the first Pacific Regional Forum. For the second, our area sponsored (and partially paid for) the bus transportation of anyone interested in attending. For 21 people, it was their first Forum, and they all agreed that the experience was rewarding. All left with a better understanding and appreciation of G.S.O., the Grapevine, and their staffs. No one can carry the message of service better than those who perform the service, and personal delivery is the best means to carry the message. It may be some time before we can see real results from our experience; but having 21 better-informed members, to help correct misunderstandings and encourage participation individually and financially, leads me to feel that Regional Forums are doing just fine.

I would like, however, to present some suggestions. The first is that we have a thorough but brief orientation at the very beginning of a Forum. Many new people I talked with—especially those who had not studied "The A.A. Service Manual"—were confused about the distinction between sharing and getting opinions for policy-making purposes.

Second, quite a number of people were unable to attend be-

cause of the travel and housing expense involved. Smaller forums covering one or two areas would make the forum experience available to a larger number. The added expense to the General Service Board might be partially offset by a small registration fee and/or the reduction of the number of trustees and staff that attend. (Nine attended the September 1980 Pacific Forum.) Recent mini-forums seem to be heading in this direction.

Third, the meeting format might be revised somewhat to encourage additional sharing. (I tend to use the old microphone often—maybe delegates should try not to share at these Forums.) A little more time spent on workshops and *small* sharing-type groups might encourage greater participation.

Last (a personal opinion). Ask-It Baskets consume a great deal of time, asking many people to listen to an answer for one person. And it appears that, at times, people ask a question to create an opportunity to speak on their pet subject or issue.

Regional Forums are a somewhat expensive (about \$8,000 each) method of communicating with the Fellowship. We need to keep looking for new and better ways. But Regional Forums are *alive* and *well*.

Gary Ulrici (San Diego)

Let's review our committee system

The 1981 Advisory Actions—most rising out of Conference committee reports—had been voted upon by Friday afternoon, when this workshop took place. So all members of the Conference had just seen its committee system in full operation.

Inventorying a key element of Conferences

1 “How well does our committee system work? Do we use our committees in reaching decisions or sometimes tend to bypass them?”

a Most workshops reported that the committee system works well; half, that some committees needed to send out more background material prior to committee meetings, for a more informed vote. The necessity of studying background material was stressed.

b One workshop suggested that Conference amendment of Conference committee recommendations might be bypassing the committee system, but it was generally felt this was not the case.

2 “Do committees, in their desire to be of service, tend to overproduce Conference Advisory Actions? (Note increasing number of actions each year.)”

There were mixed responses. One workshop pointed out that as A.A. grows, so will the number of Advisory Actions. Several workshops felt that the number of actions would be reduced if more specific information was given to the committee regarding the difference between a Conference committee recommendation and a Conference committee suggestion. Many felt there should be a thorough explanation of the terms.

It was further felt that “suggestions” should not be discussed

on the Conference floor or written up the same as “recommendations.” Suggestions should be included in the delegate's report when he or she returns home.

The following ideas were offered to clarify committee responsibilities, suggesting that:

a On Sunday, trustees explain the committee system and how it works. (Better understanding and background on the trustees' committees would also be helpful.)

b Second-year delegates take more initiative in informing first-year delegates, who need more orientation.

c It is desirable to have all joint trustee and Conference committee meetings before Conference committees meet.

d It is important that the staff secretary and Conference committee chairperson get together prior to a committee meeting.

e The importance of Conference members' attending all of their committee meetings be stressed.

3 “Are our existing committees meeting our current A.A. needs?”

It was generally felt that current committees do meet our needs.

a “Do some committees have too much work, while others haven't enough?”

Most replied that committee work loads balanced out from year to year.

b “Are some committees no longer really needed?—i.e., do some committees have overlapping responsibilities? Have some committees' responsibilities become obsolete?”

It was felt that present committees are just fine. Where there is an overlap of responsibility, it is a good idea to have a liaison between the committees concerned.

c “Are there new areas of A.A. activity for which there might be a need for a new committee?”

No new committees were suggested.

Advisory Action related to topic touched on in this workshop: 32 (p. 48)

Presentation/discussion on same topic as this workshop: p. 12

Somehow, many Conference members find the time—and energy—after all-day sessions to go out for ice cream. This year, in addition to the old standby Howard Johnson's on 42nd Street, the new and elegant Grand Hyatt enjoyed A.A. patronage, as did the Trattoria in the Pan Am Building and the Peppermint Park as far away as 66th Street and First Avenue. . . . To top it off, a few people even got up early to go jogging; Ken Williams (Class A trustee), Curtis Monahan (G.S.O. staff), and Bob Pearson (general manager) could be seen, properly suited, among the New Yorkers in Central Park.

A comment from the mike on the last day of the Conference: "Well, this year I believe we've stayed within the theme of the Conference; we've taken our own inventory—and some others' as well." . . . And in Hawaii, we understand, an inventory is called a "loving appraisal."

"Principles before personalities"

In the final working session of the 1981 Conference, members' thoughts were focused on the Traditions, which guide all A.A. service. The presentation/discussion followed this brief comment by its moderator:

The "principles before personalities" portion of Tradition Twelve, as I understand it, intends the fundamental truth to be more prominent than any one of us. When a torch is being carried to lighten a dark pathway, the torch is intended to light the way, not the bearer—but none who holds the light can escape a measure of light reflecting on himself. Is this not the risk we take to expose our program of recovery? Do we not also risk the accusing finger of those who do not understand and believe that we are lighting up our own image? "Our primary purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety." Can we carry our message without carrying the torch? I think not! We can get so specific with the letter of the "law," hanging on to each and every word, that we totally miss the intent and spirit of our principles and Traditions.

Sunny Nisewaner (Maryland)

'Personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity'

I have known 30 years of unbelievable happiness in our Society. I have felt the pure joy of meeting our co-founder Bill, of sharing an A.A. platform with his sponsor, Ebby, and of being in close personal contact with thousands of beautiful people, members of this Fellowship called Alcoholics Anonymous.

The members who shared their experience, strength, and hope with me were the first indications of the importance of unity of purpose within the Fellowship—unity of purpose within a group, unity of groups within a district, unity of districts within an area, unity of all the 91 areas in cooperating with G.S.O.—to attain harmony within the Fellowship, but also to safeguard the privilege of carrying out our primary purpose.

Personal recovery is the very lifeblood of our Fellowship. We have all experienced that feeling of fear of the unknown as we approached our first A.A. meeting. We found people who gave us love and compassion, wanting to share with us what had so freely been given to them. After a while, as our activity in A.A. grows, more and more we remember the Responsibility Declaration made at Toronto in 1965. When that cry for help comes, we want the hand of A.A. to be there, and for that, we are responsible.

Unity of purpose is essential to our personal recovery, as well as to the recovery of the legions of alcoholics still to come. Our chances of personal recovery depend on our ability to cope with sobriety, by putting our Twelve Steps into action. The end result is not only our own recovery, but an ever-growing desire to share this miracle of sobriety with another alcoholic.

I thank God for my sobriety and you people for showing me

how to cope with living sober. And if you have feelings similar to these, tell Him tonight how grateful you are. I'm going to.

Larry Trager (Kansas)

'The only requirement for membership'

Although other events of my first A.A. meeting are quite hazy, I clearly remember the words of the smiling man who met me as I stood in the doorway of the meeting room: "Hi! My name is Leroy. I think you've found the place you've been looking for. Come on in and have a cup of coffee."

No secret password, no membership card required, no questions regarding my marital status, occupation, age, political affiliation, or religious beliefs, if any. Nor, since this was an open meeting, was I asked if I had a desire to stop drinking. The warm welcome and the lack of embarrassing questions convinced me that, indeed, I had found the place that I had been looking for.

In my opinion, the key sentence in our Preamble is: "The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking." As many of us are aware, the original phrasing was "an honest desire to stop drinking." I believe that when they removed the word "honest," they had people like me in mind! As a newcomer to A.A., I was incapable of being honest about anything. However, I was also unable to face the consequences of my drinking any longer. It was for that reason, and that reason only, that I sought A.A.

What I found was membership in a fellowship with no strings attached: no dues to pay; no evaluation of my progress by fellow members; no one telling me I *had* to do *anything*; no one recording attendance at meetings; no one researching my background to see if I was fit to be a member, or following me around to see if I was still drinking. And no one told me that I *had* to stop drinking; all that was needed was the *desire* to stop. There were no rules and no regulations—what kind of an outfit is this, anyway?

The purpose of the membership requirement, I believe, can be summed up in the biblical quotation "Judge not, lest ye be judged."

There are two sides to this coin, however. Now let's take a look at the other side. Inherent in the freedom and simplicity of our Third Tradition is the fact that there is one requirement—to become a member of A.A., a person *must* have a problem with alcohol. While attendance at open A.A. meetings is available to anyone who is interested, A.A. membership is available only to those persons with a desire to stop drinking alcohol.

In my area, there have been isolated incidents of nonalcoholics' seeking admittance to closed A.A. meetings. Fortunately, some healthy controversy arose within the Fellowship, and members had to take a good look at our membership requirement. Bill Wilson, in the pamphlet "Problems Other Than Alcohol," dealt with just such issues when he stated, "*There is no possible way to make nonalcoholics into A.A. members. . . . If we don't stick to these principles, we shall almost surely collapse. And if we collapse, we cannot help anyone.*"

I believe that groups could avoid problems for themselves and

embarrassment to others by carefully explaining this requirement before the start of closed meetings. The chairperson should then ask anyone who does not feel that he or she is alcoholic to please leave. Unnecessary problems have arisen in groups in my area that have failed to do this.

A.A. has many members who are dually addicted. Can they find help in our Fellowship? Of course they can, provided they remember that "our primary purpose is to recover from alcoholism and help others to achieve sobriety."

As I see it, our briefest Tradition embodies our strength and our salvation. A.A. membership is open to anyone desiring to stop drinking—that is the only requirement. But it is a requirement! By continuing to observe it, we are indeed placing "principles before personalities." And we are keeping it simple, as Dr. Bob advised.

Ralph Richards (Southern Indiana)

The spiritual meaning of anonymity

The first sentence of the chapter on the Twelfth Tradition says, "The spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice." The placing of principles before my personality is the sacrifice I believe I am asked to make.

When I attended my first A.A. meeting, no one asked me where I lived, what I did for a living—or even my last name. I had been told all of my young life to choose friends carefully, and yet these people showed concern for me, loved me without knowing anything about me except that I had a big drinking problem. They were friends. I didn't choose them carefully—they just were. I was anonymous and so were they. That spontaneous gift of love given freely is something I hope I never forget.

Later, when gratitude for being sober put aside fear of stigma, opportunities came along to explain what had been happening to me in A.A. That was good. But if microphones or cameras had been handy when I was a relative newcomer, I'm not too sure I wouldn't have used them. Being the center of attention gave me a nice warm feeling (reminding me of something else I had formerly used to feel warm). About this time, the Traditions were pointed out to me.

Those two familiar experiences are to me the basic, simple reasons for anonymity, its "spiritual substance": giving without thinking of return; getting off center stage for the welfare of others. All of our Traditions ask us to sacrifice our personal desires and ambitions for the benefit of A.A. as a whole. Each of us, as an individual, is asked to do this—not a committee or G.S.O. or the Conference.

We are asked to give up fear, pride, and anger—avoid controversies—so we can work together more effectively; to let others express their opinions and to realize that these opinions are worthy of consideration; not to judge others; to trust one another—mind our own business; let *others* tell us if we are doing something worthwhile. For me, all that takes a lot of self-discipline but may help me cultivate some humility. If this is painful (it took painful experiences to show our pioneers the need for principles to guide us toward unity), the reward is worth it. The reward is our continued ability to carry the message.

If it seems necessary for me to tell how many times I have been asked to speak recently, how many people I sponsor, or how "successful" my sponsorship is; if I do not put enough trust in someone else's ability to take over my service responsibility; if I point out that a successful service project was my idea, no matter who accomplished it—then I am not placing principles before my personality. I am in the way of real unity. I am hindering my own growth, my group's growth, and thus A.A.'s growth. If something I say is helpful to someone, the important thing is the help—not that I said it. If the job is accomplished, that's important—not that I did it.

None of the thoughts I have presented are new; I have just expressed them in my own way. However, I believe the words "ever reminding us" in the Twelfth Tradition are there for our good.

In "Why Alcoholics Anonymous Is Anonymous," Bill Wilson said, "We take these attitudes not at all because we claim special virtue or wisdom; we do these things because hard experience has told us that we must—if A.A. is to survive in the distraught world of today. We also give up rights and make sacrifices because we ought to—and, better yet, because we want to. A.A. is a power greater than any of us; it must go on living or else uncounted thousands of our kind will surely die."

The word sacrifice sounds somewhat unpleasant when I first see or hear it, but the reward it brings in this case is really joyous if each of us who love our Fellowship gains more spiritual maturity.

Debbie Harrington (Delaware)

Advisory Action related to topic of this presentation/discussion: 27 (p. 47)



Unsigned Questions Taken From the Basket to Be Answered on the Spot

Ask-It Basket

Areas

Q If a district has one D.C.M. and one alternate, is there any reason it cannot have one more D.C.M. for a remote area?

A This is an area decision, which should be settled in your own area committee.

Q Could we have, by a show of hands, how many areas allow vote by proxy?

A No hands were raised.

Q Where area boundaries are determined by county lines or by state lines, how do groups close by the boundaries resolve their wish to belong to the area just across an arbitrary boundary?—particularly groups that have close ties to groups in the other area and, in many cases, are active in its intergroup functions.

A In situations like this, it would be good practice to ask the area committee or intergroup in the area in which the group wishes to belong for its permission to do so, and the area committee or intergroup would vote to accept or reject the request.

Conferences and Conventions

Q Should an A.A. conference or convention offer an economic inducement to A.A.'s whose children belong to Alateen (i.e., free or discount registration for Alateen members)? What about A.A.'s who live in areas where there is no Alateen?

A It would be up to the conference or convention committee to decide how it would want to handle this matter.

Finance

Q The expenses of the D.C.M. (to area assemblies, etc.) are presently borne by the district. "The A.A. Service Manual" addresses the G.S.R. expenses to such functions but does not address the D.C.M.'s expenses. Is there a reason for this? If not, could this be included in the service manual?

A The service manual addresses itself to area committee membership, which would include the D.C.M. and anybody else who serves on committees. It is up to the individual area to decide whether these expenses of area committee people should be borne by the area, if possible.

General Service Conference

Q Have we waited too long for this inventory? [This was evidently a reference to the Conference theme, "A.A. Takes Its Inventory."]

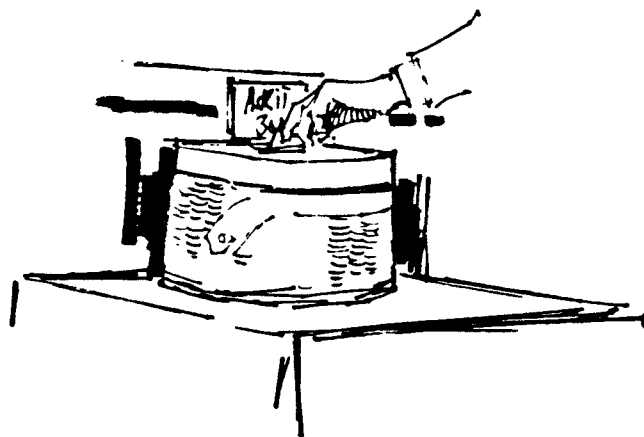
A How long is too long? When you decide to take an inventory, you sit down and take it.

Group Affairs

Q If an A.A. member, new or old, takes a mind-altering drug other than alcohol, does this constitute a slip? (Our group conscience was evenly divided.)

A It is up to the individual A.A. member to decide whether or not he or she has had a slip in this instance.

Q How do we treat the teenage alcoholic? (Some are just 12 or 13 years old.)



A We treat them just as we treat any other alcoholic. We ask them to stay away from one drink for one day at a time and go to a lot of meetings. Some of us are 12 or 13 years old going on 50!

Q Many A.A. groups are now holding 50/50 raffles before the A.A. meeting to help pay the ever-increasing rental costs of meeting rooms. What is the feeling of the delegates on this matter?

A This is strictly up to the group conscience.

Q Our group was inundated with people from a treatment center—some still high on drugs and pilfering from the church where we met. We voted to discontinue the meeting. The director says he is going to write to New York to have the group "disciplined." Could we speak to this in some way in print, so the delegate would have credibility?

A "New York" cannot censure anyone. There is no censuring in A.A. Any members can close up a meeting for any reason they choose.

Q The practice of hand-holding is now widespread and is affecting A.A. as a whole. Does this help us to carry the message better? Is the practice coercive?

A No one in A.A. is coerced into doing anything, and we should accept it as members' personal choices if they do not wish to hold hands. (It was noted that the group conscience of one group felt the practice did not help to carry the message, so it was discontinued.)

Q There is more and more pressure to have special-purpose groups for addicts and alcoholics. Will G.S.O. publish guidelines to deal with this?

A The guidelines for groups and special-interest meetings are listed in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet. Regarding guidelines on how to run a meeting, it was felt that this should be up to group autonomy and the issuance of guidelines on the subject would be too rigid.

Q What is the difference between a group and a meeting?

A A group is open to *all* A.A. members. A meeting can be for a special-interest group of members of A.A.

Q Semi-closed meetings are springing up—for instance, closed meetings for A.A.'s and Al-Anons at roundups, etc. These events are listed as A.A. events in the Grapevine and use our directories for mailings. Should the Guidelines on Conferences and Conventions restate our principle of *open* or *closed* meetings?

A After much discussion, the feeling was that a "semi-closed meeting" (a meeting closed except to members of A.A. and Al-Anon) was not an A.A. meeting and shouldn't be referred to as such; and that there are only two types of A.A. meetings—open, which A.A.'s as well as non-A.A.'s attend, and closed, for A.A. members only. One delegate commented that semi-closed A.A. meetings must be for semi-alcoholics.

Literature

Q Would it be possible to have a filmstrip on the group structure based on the pamphlet "The A.A. Group"? How do we go about getting something like this started?

A This would be possible. It was suggested that the request be made to the General Service Office, and the matter would then be taken up with the trustees' Literature Committee.

Q Are we getting too much literature?

A As this matter will be brought up on the floor of the Conference, it was felt that it would not be necessary to address the question at this time.

Q Would it be possible to have a Spanish-language Big Book with all the recovery stories and not just Bill's and Bob's?

A Mexico is planning to reprint the Big Book in Spanish with all the recovery stories. It is hoped that this will soon be available.

Public Information

Q On the day before our area banquet, there is a public information dinner to which the professional community is invited. It is called an A.A. public information meeting. Is it

proper to also have an Al-Anon speaker, as we do?

A Since public information meetings are not A.A. meetings in the usual sense, it would be all right to have an Al-Anon speaker; the public would most likely want to know about Al-Anon, as well as A.A. (One dissenter felt that calling it an A.A. public information meeting meant that no one but A.A. members could be speakers.)

Miscellaneous

Q How could A.A. cooperate with Narcotics Anonymous in bridging the gap at the treatment level?

A Our policy is cooperation, not affiliation. In areas where there is a Narcotics Anonymous chapter, we should refer addicts to N.A.

Fishing for answers

Ever wonder about the fisherman's creel that has been used as the Ask-It Basket for decades? Dennis Manders (controller) recalls that when the term was invented in the 1950's (by Ralph Bugli, who wrote some of the early pamphlets), Herb Morse, then G.S.O.'s general manager, sent Dennis out to shop for a basket with a slot in the top. He scurried about to shops and department stores all over town, without success. Lots of baskets, but none with a hole in the top. Finally, he happened into Abercrombie & Fitch, the fashionable sports-equipment store (now defunct) located directly across from the Roosevelt Hotel. Lo and behold, the fishing creel was exactly what the doctor ordered. Sturdily built, top quality, leather-trimmed, it cost \$25—a lot of money in those days. Herb gave Dennis a stiff lecture for spending so much. But look how it's lasted!

Reports on Area Service Highlights

Alabama/Northwestern Florida: We strive to create more interest in our Three Legacies by holding workshops. We started a school for general service representatives, and it was received with great enthusiasm. We hope to make G.S.R. work more attractive through a better understanding of what being a G.S.R. means and how important it is to get group-conscience feelings to our Conference. One concern is the influx of people from treatment centers who seem to miss the fundamentals of Unity and Service; practically all emphasis is placed on Recovery. So we encourage groups to discuss the Legacies.—*Art Ludwig Sr.*

Arkansas: We wanted to increase the number of G.S.R.'s attending the assembly and also interest more members in becoming G.S.R.'s. For area workshops, we put together flip charts starting with group, district, area, and regional structure, going on to the three legal entities—General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., and A.A. Grapevine, Inc.—and ending with the Conference. At the next assembly meeting following each of three such workshops in 1980, we noticed G.S.R.'s and other A.A.'s who had never attended the assembly before.—*Charlie Parmley*

British Columbia/Yukon: Mini-assemblies are held monthly in several districts. The Inside-Outside Roundup, put on by inmates and by sponsors of some 20 institutions groups, has been repeated successfully this year. We are setting up a referral system for Vancouver family courts, whereby A.A.'s will meet with the social worker and the alcoholic. Contact has also been made with the head of family practice on the University of B.C. medical faculty. A new district, comprising six new groups, has been formed on the Queen Charlotte Islands, south of Alaska. It is exciting to watch them get involved in the area service structure. In addition to screening "Markings on the Journey" and collecting memorabilia, our Archives Committee has unearthed a 1947 film depicting the recovery of one alcoholic.—*Webb Johnson*

California (Northern Coastal): We have 19 districts, with 1,444 groups, and there were 249 voters at our fall election assembly. Contributions continue to climb, using the 60-30-10 Plan. District meetings, attended by visiting area officers, provide excellent G.S.R. activities and forums for groups to discuss local problems and Tradition questions. Particular emphasis is placed

on the pre-Conference assembly; many districts prep with sharing sessions and mini-conferences to discuss agenda topics. Our post-Conference assembly, a two-day affair, includes workshops, service presentations, and the delegate's Conference report.

—*Sam Eddy*

California (Southern): To attend a general service workshop each year, members travel as much as 300 miles. We use the Conference agenda as a base for discussions and also include items that apply directly to our area. We have many large A.A. conventions; at each, there are general service meetings. In fact, members of these convention committees started the Marathon in New Orleans last year—a custom that will be continued. We have our own 16 mm. projector and a cassette slide projector. For young people in particular, we find the A.A. films and filmstrips wonderful tools.—*Jim Ockerman*

Colorado: With our mountain barrier and a traditional distrust between eastern and western slopes, we have in the past had problems communicating. This year, sharing among groups statewide has increased; support for the area committee went from 40% of groups to 46%. More groups are active in P.I., treatment facilities, and correctional facilities work, although participation in the last is still weak. At an assembly, I was thrilled as G.S.R. after G.S.R. began comments with "My group says . . ." instead of "I think . . ." Grapevine subscriptions are up more than 1,000 this year, thanks to our GV chairperson's work and the increase in GvRs.—*Don Pritts*

Connecticut: Our problem is one of population density, not geography; we have about 700 groups and another 100 meetings. An *ad hoc* committee was formed to evaluate area structure and come up with suggestions for improving its effectiveness. It was recommended that we free D.C.M.'s of any other responsibilities, such as chairing committees. Now, they can be full-time D.C.M.'s. It was also recommended that each district subdivide into three sections, with each electing a D.C.M. and alternate, to help cover the groups. We are already getting G.S.R.'s where there were none before. The *ad hoc* committee also recommended adding area and district committees on the Grapevine and on our area newsletter.—*Cynthia Fifield*

District of Columbia: We credit much of our increase in assembly participation and attendance to complete redistricting. The new setup has 32 districts instead of 14. The many new committee members bring fresh interest and more energetic participation. With smaller districts, communication is better. We endeavor to give G.S.R.'s more information, with bulletins and newsy letters, to have an assembly informed in advance on subjects to be discussed. We also send early announcements on mini-conference workshop subjects, so groups can discuss them beforehand.—*Jack Atwell*

Florida (Northern): Our four assemblies a year keep the lines of communication open to all 17 districts, serving about 230 groups. We are attempting to form an Archives Committee, co-operating with those already operating at the intergroup level in four districts. The Handicap Committee is urging the election of a representative from each group to see that transportation to meetings is provided when necessary. At the year's first assembly, the G.S.R. workshop was planned to accommodate incoming G.S.R.'s, using the "G.S.R." pamphlet and "The A.A. Service Manual."—*Tom Lepinskie*

Florida (Southern): We have 12 districts and over 600 groups

(most with listed G.S.R.'s). One of our district mini-forums recently was held in cooperation with the district's intergroup committee, opening additional lines of communication between the two service entities. The growing interest in general service is a direct result of the forums. Money—or lack of it—tends to influence participation in service; so our area gives *anyone* the opportunity to become a delegate, by funding its delegate's expenses to area quarterlies and assemblies, the state convention, the Southeastern Conference, Regional Forums, and the delegates' get-together, which the alternate delegate also attends at area expense; we emphasize the role of the alternate at all levels.—*Lenore Tate*

Hawaii: We have 150 groups and 2,000 members. Since our districts were formed in 1975, we've held 17 area assemblies, the most recent in Honolulu. Maui now sends a D.C.M. to monthly area meetings, and we hope the other islands will soon be represented. Our Panel 25 delegate initiated Hawaii's service structure and inspired us to put "The A.A. Service Manual" into action. This has been slow going—our personalities sometimes impede our principles! But in the end, we have pushed our egos over in favor of A.A. unity. Our Correctional Facilities Committee is carrying the message to inmates and seeing that they manage the difficult transition back into society and "outside" A.A. meetings.—*June Boranian*

Illinois (Chicago): Our area has more than 1,600 meetings per week and a group membership of more than 35,000. Each district committee has the same responsibility to its district as the Chicago Area Service Committee has to our area. We have three permanent standing committees—Finance, Public Information, and Hospital and Institution—and are now planning a fourth, to handle state and regional conventions, plus our All Chicago Area Big Open Meeting, held for the celebration of our anniversary. We have grown from one meeting in Evanston, some 41 years ago.—*Dolores Colford*



Illinois (Southern): With ten districts and more than 200 groups, we have area assemblies quarterly at locations rotating among districts. The assemblies include business meetings and a workshop on Sunday, but a lot of people come Saturday night for an A.A. meeting and an evening of fine fellowship. With the help of our Institutions Committee and the groups, we are getting Big Books into prisons. Some districts have monthly G.S.R. meetings; my own also has workshops after meetings. Many groups have monthly newsletters. All these things help the new and old get involved in service work, as I did about 15½ years ago, because someone thought enough of me to give me a push.—*Bob French*

Indiana (Northern): Our state committee approved a plan redistricting the state (Areas 22 and 23), increasing the number of districts from 18 to 35. The size of the old districts was horrendous, both geographically and in relation to the number of

groups within districts. In our area, there are 12 new D.C.M.'s, and newer members' enthusiasm complements older members' stability when both are brought together on district matters. The Institution Committee of our central service office is instrumental in holding two meetings per week in the county jail and three in a local hospital. Meetings are also held weekly at a state prison and a rehab center; groups nearby rotate weekends in hosting.—*Bill Peters*

Iowa: Since we began asking for district reports, there has been more activity among the groups. We have divided some districts because there were too many groups to a district; others, because of distances that G.S.R.'s would have to travel. Two intergroups with central offices have been established in the past two years. Some groups are struggling with phenomenal growth, a huge influx of young people, or nonalcoholic drug addicts (the pamphlet "Problems Other Than Alcohol" has been distributed to those groups).—*Doris Beacom*

Louisiana: Hosting the 1980 International Convention brought Louisiana a unity it had never known before. Every service element in the area responded. We loved having you with us. In 1980, 37 new groups asked to be listed at G.S.O., bringing the total to about 240 groups, with nearly 4,000 members. People are flooding to A.A. through hospitals, treatment centers, etc. Most encouraging is the number of young alcoholics coming in. Much work is being done with institutions; an inmate representing a prison group has been allowed to attend the last three assembly workshops.—*Jack Elbert*

Massachusetts (Eastern): This area includes about 1,000 groups, with some 775 listed at G.S.O. About 200 meetings were added to our *Boston Central Service Directory* in 1980. Our current long-range goals are to revive inactive districts and encourage active districts to enroll "one G.S.R. per month." We are dedicated to strengthening our districts so they can take over functions currently performed by the area committee. Service seminars at the district level have generated interest. Treatment facilities work seems to be ideal for attracting members to service.—*Bill Downey*

Michigan (Central): We have approximately 220 groups; about 85 are represented at our monthly meeting. Our area will host the Sixth Annual Five-State East Central Regional Conference, with all of the region's 14 areas participating in panels and the alkathon. Intergroups have been established to distribute literature to hospitals, treatment centers, jails, schools, and churches, and to coordinate C.P.C., P.I., and other committee service work. Our three delegate areas in Michigan meet quarterly in Lansing to consider statewide interests.—*Jack Whitehouse*

Michigan (Southeastern): Our area is rather small but heavily populated. It has 23 districts consisting of 237 listed groups, with a membership of approximately 5,000. We hold assembly meetings bimonthly, with area committee meetings in the alternate months. Each year in March, we hold a rally and invite a speaker from G.S.O.; the proceeds cover the delegate's expenses. We have 11 standing committees: public information, C.P.C., correctional, treatment, literature, group coordinator, districts, Grapevine, films, Traditions play, and general service panel.—*Clyde Swaim*

Minnesota (Southern): In this area, we are now guided by a steering committee made up of D.C.M.'s, area officers, and past delegates, and we are becoming more service-workshop-orient-

ed at all levels of our structure. We plan on having a trustee or past trustee speak at each of our four assembly meetings this year, starting with our spring roundup. Our monthly newsletter is becoming a valuable communications tool. One part of the newsletter is called "The Delegate's Corner," and I am allowed to contribute each month.—*Stan Mann*

Missouri (Eastern): We have 18 districts and 16 D.C.M.'s, 12 of whom hold monthly G.S.R. meetings. For a trial period of one year, our four assemblies were held at a central location; but we returned to our former method of rotation, as experience has shown us that when a district hosts an assembly, it seems to gain strength. Our archives are beginning to grow. We have five area committee chairpersons, on C.P.C., P.I., institutions, Grapevine, and convention, and we hope they will form effective committees throughout the 18 districts.—*Carlene Reel*

Missouri (Western): Our Institutions Committee now has a structure set up in all districts. We have printed directories (listing a contact name and phone number for each meeting) to be given to institutional people, so that anyone with a drinking problem will have someone to write to and then to contact when released from treatment or prison. By the end of 1982, we plan to have an active P.I. committee working in all districts. The chairperson of our Archives Committee is collecting and displaying the history of A.A. in our area. Our alternate delegate chairs the new C.P.C. Committee and is working to set up a structure area-wide.—*LaVerne Brandon*

Nevada: In two-thirds of the districts, most of our groups are located 500 miles apart. So we started expanding the number of districts, with fewer groups per district. Through nine problem-solving workshops at the group and district level and a panel on public information, cooperation with the professional community, and treatment centers, we were able to outline the future for Nevada A.A. in the 1980's. Last year, we held workshops on the first six Concepts and heard a talk on general service by our Pacific Region trustee.—*Gregory MacNeil*

New Jersey (Northern): Our state convention has grown from a one-day affair to a three-day weekend. G.S.R. attendance has increased so rapidly that we have twice moved to larger facilities. A projector has been purchased, and filmstrips are shown over the entire area by G.S.R.'s, who answer questions after each presentation. This has succeeded in familiarizing groups with general service work. All in all, the outlook is encouraging, with older members returning to service work and new ones entering the scene. The enthusiasm now starting to show is something that was lacking in our part of the state.—*Stan Brys*

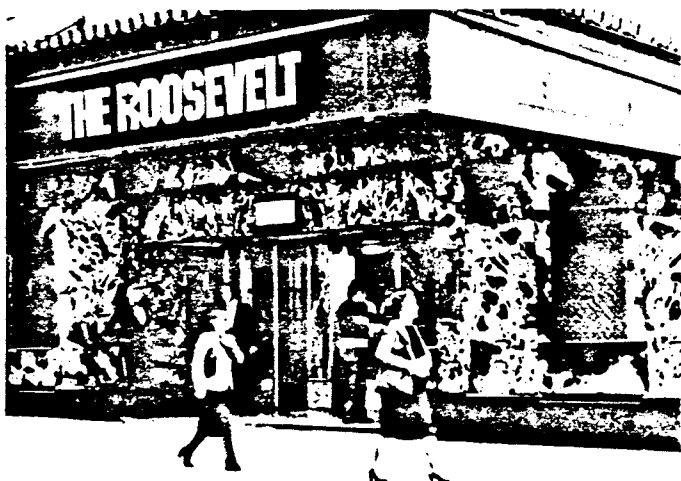
New York (Central): At our last area meeting, we had a spiritual session on dual addiction. With the help of the pamphlet "Problems Other Than Alcohol," we were able to provide guidance on handling this situation. For the last three months, we have been holding G.S.R. workshops in both Rochester and Syracuse, hoping that we will have better attendance at our area meeting. A good program of panels and A.A. meetings is planned for the state convention, along with sports, games, banquets, and dancing.—*Maurice Welch*

New York (Southeastern): We added 109 groups in 1980, bringing the total to over 900. I wish I could say we had 900 G.S.R.'s at our assemblies, but as you know, that's only a dream. We have five assemblies and 11 committee meetings each year. We have changed the assemblies from two-hour

nighttime sessions to four-hour afternoon sessions, and have also changed the format to include workshops on current area problems, A.A. structure, and group problems and experiences. That change has created more interest. Two answering services became intergroups this year.—*Alex Macaulay*

North Carolina: We have divided our previous ten districts into 23 districts, because the number of groups and the total membership had increased to the point that the D.C.M.'s could not function effectively. Further, the area committee is now placing heavy emphasis on involving the alternate D.C.M.'s. Special invitations to all area committee meetings are issued to alternates. The committee also encourages alternate G.S.R.'s to attend assemblies and participate in workshops and sharing sessions.—*Gertrude Brown*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: We have redistricted six times in six years, going from ten to 16 districts (with about 180 groups and 2,000 members). A three-day roundup in each province in the spring prepares us for our combined three-day assembly in the fall. Most districts have an institutions committee, and we also have some active P.I. committees throughout the area. Each district's G.S.R.'s meet once a month, at which time a topic pertaining to "The A.A. Service Manual," Twelve Concepts, P.I., or institutions work is discussed.—*Eddie MacMullin*



Delegates from the 91 areas converge on this hotel in midtown Manhattan, where they live and work all through Conference week.

Ohio (Central and Southeastern): Our goal is improving communication throughout our service structure. Within the area committee: by keeping all area officers informed and proposing monthly D.C.M. meetings to study "The A.A. Service Manual." Within the area: by holding monthly meetings of area officers and D.C.M.'s or concerned G.S.R.'s. Within the state: by sharing minutes of our meetings with other areas and holding quarterly planning meetings with all areas for the state conference. Within the region: by communicating with all delegates regarding problems that may affect us all.—*James Barton*

Ohio (Northeastern): Our area consists of 523 groups, in 38 districts. Several districts hold monthly meetings and study the Traditions, the Concepts, and "The A.A. Service Manual." Our greatest concern is the lack of interest and knowledge about

general service throughout the area, and also the lack of unity. Our hope is to inform, unify, cooperate, and get more participation area-wide. At assemblies, we encourage D.C.M. and committee reports and have included Ask-It Basket sessions and workshops.—*Joan Anderson*

Oklahoma: There seems to be a growing concern with service in our area. Attendance at district meetings and area service meetings is really terrific. Workshops are usually directed toward service subjects, and Big Book study classes are very popular. We are getting into more correctional institutions, and in turn, inmates seem to be interested in what we have to say. Our P.I. program shows progress; we have literature in nearly every public library in our area, and we speak in most public schools.—*LaVern Walker*

Ontario (Eastern): Our area was probably the last in Canada and the U.S. to form an area committee. Many districts were far too large, so there was redistricting to be done. The central committee for Ontario's four areas functioned well; but after our area committee got off the ground, problems began to arise, mostly concerned with duplication of services. A sub-committee, formed to investigate the pros and cons of operating with and without the central committee, suggested changes in both committees to help them be of more benefit to all A.A.'s in Ontario. (Our area is not all in Canada; some groups in upper New York State choose to belong to it.) Communication in all of Ontario is much better than it has ever been.—*Gordon Dracup*

Ontario (Northeastern): Eight districts, one intergroup and four answering services cover the 12,000 square miles of our area. A.A. is growing well here, but there are problems caused by lack of knowledge of A.A. structure, also by not following the Guidelines. It would probably help if D.C.M.'s put on a workshop for G.S.R.'s, and the area, in turn, put on a workshop for D.C.M.'s before the assembly. I am concerned about how literature gets to Ontario. Too many hands seem to be involved in getting a simple kit to a P.I. or institutions chairperson of a district.—*Skip Murphy*

Ontario (Northwestern): Our large area has 70 groups, in seven districts, with new groups starting regularly. Some groups far north are accessible only by plane. Most districts have had service workshops in the past year; some have had two. My alternate lives 304 miles from me and will be a great help in that part of the area. We have a very active P.I. coordinator, with a good working committee that uses the Guidelines and other P.I. material available from G.S.O.—*Arthur Caldwell*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): We have 21 districts and D.C.M.'s and 16 alternate D.C.M.'s, with all districts holding monthly meetings. In the past two years, we've had an increase of about 60 groups, and in 1980, we added four new districts. We have an area Grapevine Committee, chaired by our alternate delegate. Continuing toward a goal of a Grapevine representative for each group, we have asked alternate D.C.M.'s to encourage this in their districts. We continue to use past delegates on discussion panels, and they are responsible for our annual general service convention.—*Lee Brooks*

Pennsylvania (Western): There are 290 groups in the area, and more are being started almost daily. But a number of groups drop out, so it seems the total is fairly constant. To attract more people to service, we hold two mini-forums a year. We

do a lot of C.P.C. and P.I. work. Nursing and medical schools are devoting much more time to alcoholism and are requiring their students to attend A.A. meetings to observe recovery firsthand. Many more requests are coming in to send speakers to high schools.—*Bud Turner*

Quebec (Northeastern): We plan to hold a school for G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s and to publish a regional bulletin covering the need to join a group, A.A. literature, service work, etc. We will use *La Vigne* (French equivalent of the Grapevine) to reach alcoholics at home, at work, during leisure time, and in clinics or hospitals—dealing with them either directly or through friends or relatives. Our area covers a lot of territory, but the hand of A.A. should always be there, regardless of distances.—*Marcel Labrie*

Quebec (Southeastern): Our area began in 1974. Since then, we have enjoyed gradual growth; my predecessors, guided by "The A.A. Service Manual," erected a structure in which I feel comfortable. In 13 districts, we have 172 groups, over a wide area. Some G.S.R.'s live in remote parts, and we are searching for a way to enable them to vote at our assembly meeting—either by allowing them to vote by proxy or by helping to pay their traveling expenses. We hold four regional committee meetings per year, rotated from district to district, and one area assembly meeting. For the first time, we have a *La Vigne* coordinator.—*Roger Côté*

Texas (Northeastern): We put a lot of emphasis on monthly meetings of G.S.R.'s at the district level, not changing the time or date under any circumstances—Mother's Day or even the Dallas Cowboys. We feel these two or three hours a month are a small price to pay for what we receive. We now have from 30 to 50 people at these meetings—and we started with three or four! Service work has tripled in the last few years; newcomers are filled with enthusiasm. Recovery is contagious, and so is service work, when A.A. becomes the most important thing in one's life.—*Joe French*

Texas (Southeastern): The area assembly has quarterly business meetings and monthly sharing sessions, with a large attendance at both. But attendance is low at the bimonthly area committee meetings. Therefore, we must take all major (and often minor) issues to the full assembly for discussion and voting, with no prior committee recommendation. Some routine business matters have to be tabled for a quarter; with a committee recommendation on the issue, it might be handled immediately. Our annual convention varies in attendance from 500 to 1,500.—*Martha Watson*

Utah: Prior to 1973, Utah was part of the Southwest Region, and long distances placed regional participation out of reach. In the early 1970's, new service activities were developing in the Pacific Region. Because many of its areas were near Utah, communication was easier. Through correspondence among the Conference secretary, delegates from both regions, and members of our area committee, our delegate succeeded in his appeal to move Utah into the Pacific Region. Since then, service-minded members have shown more enthusiasm and a renewed sense of unity, and the number of active groups has almost doubled. Participation at the regional level provides support for area committees.—*Jesse Bowen*

Virginia: Energetic, service-minded G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s and alternate D.C.M.'s all pull together with area officers and com-

mittee chairpersons. We've had four heavily attended area assemblies and meetings, with excellent workshops stressing service. We publish a quarterly newsletter with a lot of service sharing between districts and the area committee. Virginia now has almost 500 groups in 26 districts (68 new groups in 1980); so the area committee is considering subdividing present districts into "local districts," rather than continue setting up new districts, to the point of unwieldiness.—*Dottie Rapp*

The importance of the alternate

How does it feel to be an alternate delegate one day, and on your way to the Conference the next? Tom LeTourneau, from Northern Minnesota, found out. He got a call Thursday night from his area delegate, who had to go into the hospital and couldn't attend the Conference. Happily, the delegate had "done it by the book" ("The A.A. Service Manual"), and Tom had done his homework. A fast phone call to G.S.O., where he was assured that arrangements would be made and help forthcoming from the New York end; a rapid visit to the hospitalized delegate; a meeting at his group; and he was off. Tom says: "Thanks to all of the mailings to alternates, attendance at all assembly functions, and the cooperation and friendship of all the people here, it was possible to come to the Conference on very short notice and function effectively." . . . Frank Gay, from Eastern Massachusetts, had more notice—two weeks. Again, delegate and alternate alike had done the spadework, and Frank was prepared to take advantage of "this unexpected opportunity in service." . . . Betty Stevens from South Carolina replaced her husband as delegate, but she had nearly a year to prepare—and occasionally, to worry a bit. "I wondered what in the world I was doing in such a position. But on arriving at the Conference, all my apprehension began to fade away, replaced by love and warmth."

Washington: Our P.I. Committee is improving our media coverage. The Correctional Facilities Committee budget was increased to buy more literature for inmates. The Hospital and Treatment Facilities Committee has produced an area hospital and treatment directory. The Grapevine and literature chairpersons try to attend all workshops with their display boards and also with good supplies for those who wish to purchase items not available at their home groups. Our archivist is busy taping the recollections of oldtimers and sorting out loads of information.—*Dick Pittard*

West Virginia: The area is composed of 12 districts, 11 active, with an average of ten groups each. We have two area committee meetings, two weekend assemblies, and a convention each year. We now rotate area assemblies from district to district, and members who have never been interested in service are starting to participate. We voted to pay some expenses of attendance for more area officers and committee chairpersons. Most districts pay such expenses for D.C.M.'s; groups, for G.S.R.'s. No longer do our "trusted servant" jobs have to be limited to those who can afford them.—*Bill Bailey*

Wisconsin (Southern): Our area has many workshops, district meetings, and assembly meetings. We also have two conferences a year. Classes for G.S.R.'s cover their responsibilities, and "The A.A. Service Manual" is studied. A monthly newsletter published by our central office includes articles about what is happening in the area and also provides space for news that groups send in about their meetings.—*John Bremer*

Reports From G.S.O., the General Service Board, and Trustees' Committees

G.S.O. and
G.S.B. reports

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary (such as the exception noted on p. 40), acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

General Service Board

Regional and world meetings advance A.A. unity

Trustees' report: At the end of June and beginning of July, 1980, two important meetings took place back to back. At the first of these, the Sixth World Service Meeting (W.S.M.), June 27-30 at the Harrison Conference Center, in Glen Cove, N.Y., 34 delegates representing 24 countries and zones shared information, ideas, and opinions on A.A. worldwide. Although I have known A.A. in North America for many years, this was my first opportunity to attend a W.S.M. My main reaction was delight that the A.A. program—spirit, Steps, and Traditions—transplants extremely well regardless of culture or language. It makes me optimistic about A.A.'s future. Between the biennial Meetings, two regional service meetings are now held, one in Europe and one in South America, at which A.A. countries still lacking a service structure can be helped through sharing from neighboring countries where the Fellowship is more developed.

W.S.M. delegates were the guests of your board at the second important meeting, the 45th Anniversary A.A. International Convention, in New Orleans, July 3-6. I was moved at the enormous number of people, the variety and complexity of the four-day program, and the truly international character of the event.

Trustees, directors, and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members continue to be involved in Regional Forums. During 1980, I attended three Forums: Eastern Canadian, Moncton, N.B.; Pacific, Phoenix, Ariz.; and Southeastern, Atlanta, Ga. I have attended Forums in all eight regions, and I continue to feel that they are extremely valuable communications activity. They have materially improved understanding and trust among all levels of A.A. service.

Almost 3,400 new groups in the U.S. and Canada listed themselves with G.S.O. in 1980. Although this evidence of continued growth is gratifying, we are increasingly concerned at the large number of groups *not* listed at G.S.O. and, hence, not appearing in the U.S. and Canadian directories and not receiving many G.S.O. services. All listed groups also become a part of a communications system involving over 26,000 groups in the U.S. and Canada. I hope that, through delegates' efforts, many unlisted groups will make their existence known to G.S.O. and thus become a real part of the Fellowship as a whole.

The distribution of A.A. literature again broke all records in 1980; the Big Book alone averaged over 1,000 copies a day! To handle this magnitude of demand, A.A. World Services has instituted new methods. We now use warehouses in Chicago, Toronto, Los Angeles, and Atlanta, in addition to warehousing by New Jersey, Pennsylvania, and Connecticut printers of A.A. books and pamphlets. By Datagram, central offices and inter-

groups can now phone in their literature orders, which are immediately processed and teletyped to the nearest warehouse. The order is usually shipped within 24 hours.

Though a surge in December contributions to support G.S.O. services produced a 5.6% increase for the year, this lags behind the inflation rate for the period and is also less than the rate of A.A. group growth. (A 15% increase would have kept pace with inflation plus A.A. growth.) Also, the percentage of A.A. groups contributing at all declined—a matter of concern to us all.

As a faithful reader of the Grapevine for many years, I believe that the quality of the magazine's content has been outstanding this past year.

G.S.O. and the Grapevine are constructing and refurbishing expanded quarters at 468 and 470 Park Avenue South, which will give them approximately 25% more space.



New Class A trustee William Flynn, M.D., joined the board at its July 1980 meeting in New Orleans. With the cooperation of Washington, D.C., A.A. members, Dr. Flynn developed a program at the Georgetown University Medical School in which first-year medical students are "sponsored" by A.A. members on a one-to-one basis and given exposure to A.A. meetings. This program has been so successful that it has been copied by a number of other medical schools. I am sure Dr. Bill Flynn's contributions to the board and to the A.A. Fellowship will be significant.

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., chairperson

A.A. World Services, Inc.

Print, picture, and voice carry the message

Directors' report: Here are some of the actions taken during 1980:

Office expansion and refurbishing—We agreed to engage the planning firm of Sherburne/Hurst to handle the expansion and refurbishing of the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices as per 1980

Conference recommendation. Because of expenses involved and decisions that will affect the office for at least ten years, an *ad hoc* Planning Committee was formed to oversee this project. We approved a preliminary budget, to begin the project and determine the fee of the planning firm, and forwarded the budget to the Finance Committee.

Hay Associates study report—We engaged Hay Associates, compensation consultants, to survey A.A.W.S. salary policies and practices and to compare them with those of other organizations in the nonprofit and general-business area. This study was used as an aid in establishing nonexempt salary ranges for 1981 and for recommendations for individual salaries in the exempt category.

Long-term disabilities—Approved a detailed policy to deal equitably with employees' long-term disabilities.

The Big Book—We authorized payment for checking the new Dutch translation. Since there has been a lack of unity between Dutch-speaking members in Belgium and in Holland with regard to this translation, it is important that it be examined professionally. We granted a request from Rome Inter-group, in Italy, to help finance the printing of 5,000 copies of the Big Book in Italian, at a total cost to A.A.W.S. of \$20,000-\$25,000, with the inventory remaining the property of A.A.W.S. until this total sum is paid.

Pricing of materials—We approved prices for new literature items, audiovisual materials, and discount packages.

Production expense of TV spots—We recommended to the Finance Committee that the A.A.W.S. expense budget be increased by \$45,000 to cover the production of these public service announcements.

Mailing of archives filmstrip—We accepted the proposal that "Markings on the Journey" be sent to all delegates and trustees. (Cost involved: \$952.)

Publishing—Sales for 1980 totaled \$3,826,000 (after the 6% discount allowed A.A. groups), an increase of \$563,200 over 1979. In order to help defray costs of other services that contributions could not meet, A.A.W.S. transferred about \$703,500 to the General Fund. In 1980, the distribution of books, pamphlets, and miscellaneous items reached 7,425,500 units. Free literature sent to service groups and to inform the general public about A.A. amounted to 871,000 pieces; inventory value—\$50,900.

It's a small world, as one of the staff members discovered when she ran into a delegate who had lived within two blocks of her during her drinking years.

Cash flow position—We recognized that a careful eye had to be kept on our cash flow for several months late in the year, because the rate of increase in both literature sales and group contributions had somewhat fallen off, and also because of the large, nonrecurring expenditures for the International Convention, the World Service Meeting, and extraordinary inventory additions.

1980 budget—We reviewed and recommended to the Finance

Committee the budget for 1980, with a proviso that the \$15,000 allocation for World Service Meeting delegates to be guests of the board at the International Convention be authorized. (This budget included provisions for special projects and other nonrecurring expenses.)

Transfer of surplus funds—We authorized transfer of sufficient monies to the board to cover 1980 operating deficits. (Actual transfer was \$264,238.) Surplus cash in excess of basic operating requirements, amounting to \$350,000, was transferred to the Reserve Fund.

Toronto warehouse—After we were informed that the warehouse in Toronto, Ont., was in operation, a letter was sent to Canadian central/intergroup offices and "literature libraries" informing them of this service and encouraging them to order larger supplies of literature. The Holiday issue of *Box 4-5-9* carried the notice to Canadian groups.

Combined text—Asked to explore the feasibility of combining "The A.A. Service Manual" and "Twelve Concepts for World Service" in one volume, we approved a report to the board incorporating historical background, cost, and comments by the G.S.O. staff, based on their day-to-day contact with the Fellowship. The directors added their concurrence with the staff that this subject be referred to the 1981 Conference for decision.

Past permissions to tape the Big Book—We accepted legal counsel not to withdraw or rescind taping permissions already given—in view of efforts and inventory on the part of the requesting parties, made in good faith. But we should deny future permissions if we wish. Where a time limit has been specified, we may let an existing permission expire, informing the party that it will not be renewed.

Reprint requests—We granted 64 requests to reprint and three to tape our literature. Three requests to reprint and one to tape were denied.

George Dorsey, chairperson

Archives

G.S.O. helps local centers preserve history

Trustees' committee: During 1980, the committee saw through completion of the filmstrip "Markings on the Journey." Approved by the Conference for distribution within the Fellowship, it was premiered at the International Convention, shown continuously at two locations. The response was decidedly favorable. Since then, over 400 copies have been distributed.

In development over the past year has been an archival newsletter (still to be named), as an informal vehicle for communication within A.A. among interested members. The idea emerged at the archives workshop held during the Convention. Although the workshop was scheduled for 8:30 a.m., the meeting hall became filled with A.A.'s hungry for information on our past. Many of those present wanted the "exchange to continue"—thus was born the newsletter. Mailed to about 300 members, the first issue carried news from the 60 areas in the

U.S. and Canada and the six overseas countries that have archival centers. Along with excerpts from their letters and minutes of their meetings, the issue contained material on G.S.O. archival activity.

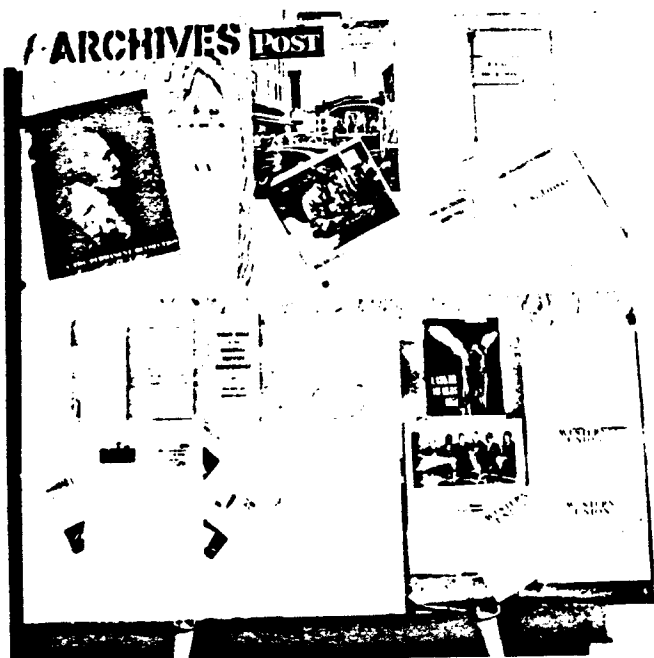
The Archives Department conducted extensive research for the author of the forthcoming biography of Bill W., companion book to "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers."

Plans are to move the archives to larger and improved quarters during this year. We are also happy to report the addition of a new researcher to the staff of the Archives Department, Veronica Stone.

Fernand Ippersiel, chairperson

Staff report: The past year was especially busy, with several large, ongoing projects occupying attention:

- Research and participation in the production of "Markings on the Journey."
- Preparation for and participation in the archives workshop at the International Convention.
- Preparation and circulation of a 36-page handbook for local areas establishing archival centers.
- Frequent mail and telephone contact with A.A. archival centers, U.S./Canada and overseas.
- Restoration and rehabilitation projects: (1) four large scrapbooks, bringing the total so treated to 13; about four more are anticipated; (2) three bound volumes of A.A. directories (1973-1979); (3) one bound volume *Box 4-5-9* (1973-1979); one bound volume *Final Conference Reports* (1974-1980).
- Progress in cataloging, indexing, and creation of a reference library.



- Continuation of oral-history project.
- Start of a major photo-duplication project.

Nell Wing, archivist

Conference

Checkup on procedures set for 1981

Trustees' committee: The committee reviewed suggested 1981 Conference themes and recommended to the Conference Agenda Committee three from which to make a choice.

The evaluations of the results of the Conference questionnaire and the post-Conference sharing session at G.S.O. were also reviewed by the committee:

- Concern had been expressed over the growing number of Advisory Actions each year; this matter was referred to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.
- The committee recommended that trustee committee reports not be read to the full Conference body; that, instead, each chairperson make brief comments highlighting committee activities over the year.
- No changes in Ask-It Basket sessions were suggested; but it was recommended that a Conference member whose question was not answered in the Ask-It Basket sessions bring it up during the "What's On Your Mind?" session. It was also brought out that printing Ask-It Basket questions and answers was creating confusion, since some A.A.'s looked upon Ask-It Basket answers as gospel. The committee recommended referring this matter to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee, asking it to consider discontinuing the printing of those questions and answers.
- In response to a suggestion that one workshop be separated for urban and rural sharing, a letter was sent to the delegates asking their opinion. Most who responded preferred to retain the cross section of sharing.

Topics submitted for Conference consideration were reviewed, discussed, and referred to the appropriate Conference committee, presentation/discussion, workshop, or Ask-It Basket session. A list of Conference members to participate in presentations, discussion topics, reports, and Ask-It Basket sessions was drawn up and approved.

At the 1980 General Service Conference, the filmstrip "Markings on the Journey" was approved without specifying restrictions on showing it; the committee recommended placing this item on the 1981 agenda for clarification.

George Dorsey, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator serves as the focal point for all Conference members and all those serving on area general service committees. We now have on our mailing list: 781 past delegates; 2,171 district committee members; area committee officers—88 chairpersons, 89 secretaries, 81 treasurers; plus others involved in service. Most area assemblies and



Conference Manual material is typed on the "mag card" machine (demonstrated by Elizabeth Garcia, department supervisor); corrected cards are

committee meetings send us minutes, which are circulated among the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs. This communication is very helpful to us all, as it is the best way to keep up with U.S./Canada A.A. activities.

All A.A.'s are encouraged to send in suggestions for the Conference agenda, usually through the delegates. Suggestions are presented to the trustees' Conference Committee and the Conference Agenda Committee for approval, then shared with everyone via the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary Conference agenda mailed to the delegates in January.

The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- 1 Collecting items for the Conference theme and agenda.
- 2 Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Conference Committee.
- 3 Handling correspondence with delegates in preparation for the Conference.
- 4 Working with the general manager, the office manager, and the staff in planning and coordination of the Conference.
- 5 Scheduling and routing all reports and other material for Conference Manuals, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, and the *Final Conference Report*.
- 6 Reviewing minutes, reports, and all communications received from area committees and D.C.M.'s.

Sarah Price

Cooperation With the Professional Community

A.A. efforts keep pace with a fast-changing field

Trustees' committee: A summary of the purpose and functions of this committee was developed.

Under the committee's guidance, A.A. presented workshops at

inserted; the machine runs off final copy fast. Gwen Jones (left, center) and Rosa Blanco are among employees who assemble the pages.

the 1980 and 1981 Annual Forums of the National Council on Alcoholism (N.C.A.). The topics were "A.A. and Treatment Centers—Bridging the Gap" and "A.A. as a Resource for Professionals."

C.P.C.-related workshops at the 1980 A.A. International Convention were: "How A.A. Cooperates With Medical and Nursing Schools," "A.A.'s Employed in the Field of Alcoholism," "How A.A. Cooperates With Professionals," and "How Professionals Cooperate With A.A."

Guidelines on Forming Local Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community were revised to include additional information, and minor changes were made in Guidelines for A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field.

The committee recommended that:

- Funds be expended to prepare a C.P.C. Workbook for area and local committees.
- The draft of a leaflet on A.A. and occupational alcoholism programs, addressed to labor and management, be presented to the Conference C.P.C. Committee for consideration.
- The Conference committee consider putting the leaflet "A.A. in Your Community" back into distribution.

The committee is working on a new pamphlet for physicians, to reflect current information about A.A., as recommended by the 1980 Conference C.P.C. Committee.

Martin Le Boutillier, chairperson

Staff report: In addition to the N.C.A. forums, staff or members of the trustees' C.P.C. Committee have participated in:

- Meetings and Advisory Council, National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism
- University of Utah School on Alcoholism and Other Drug Dependencies
- Summer School of Alcohol Studies, Rutgers University

- Mid-South Summer School of Alcohol and Drug Problems, University of Arkansas
- Rutgers Alumni Institute
- National Association of Alcoholism Counselors Conference
- National Alcohol and Drug Coalition Conference
- Cape Cod Alcoholism Intervention and Rehabilitation Unit Project for the Deaf
- Scripps Memorial Hospital Conference on Alcoholism and Chemical Dependency Treatment
- Greenwich House Counseling Agency Seminar
- Postgraduate Seminar for Mental Health (Manhattan)
- Johnson Institute Training School on Alcohol and Drug Abuse

Our Professional Exhibit was shown at 24 meetings of national organizations in 1980, resulting in almost 2,000 requests for additional information. Largely because of orders at these displays, the mailing list for *About A.A.*, our triannual newsletter for professionals, has increased by about 1,000 per issue.

As recommended by the 1980 Conference, the pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate" was revised to include information on the functions of area and local C.P.C. committees.

The film "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View" has been leased on a long-term basis by 120 treatment facilities or alcoholism agencies.

Lois Fisher

Correctional Facilities

Services to A.A.'s 'inside' aimed more precisely

Trustees' committee: To communicate with and interest more A.A. members in institutions work, it was suggested that:

- The *Institutions Bulletin* have a different color and type style.
- News items about institution work be periodically printed in Box 4-5-9.
- More participation by A.A. members in the Institutions Correspondence Service be encouraged at the local level.
- Local institutions committees be encouraged to divide into separate correctional and treatment facilities committees (if there is a need).

After a discussion, the consensus was to postpone adding the pamphlet "Time to Start Living" to the Institutions Discount Package, because young inmates predominate in correctional facilities. The committee recommended discontinuing the pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic."

The committee unanimously agreed that it is time for separate Guidelines for Correctional Facilities and for Treatment Facilities. A joint meeting with the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee was held, and a draft was prepared. This draft does not make the separation but could be used as a transitional alternative. The committees agreed that there also should be two separate bulletins to replace the *Institutions Bulletin*.

W. J. Estelle Jr., chairperson

Staff report: As of January 1, there were more than 1,000 A.A. groups in correctional facilities, and 150 institutions committees serving them.

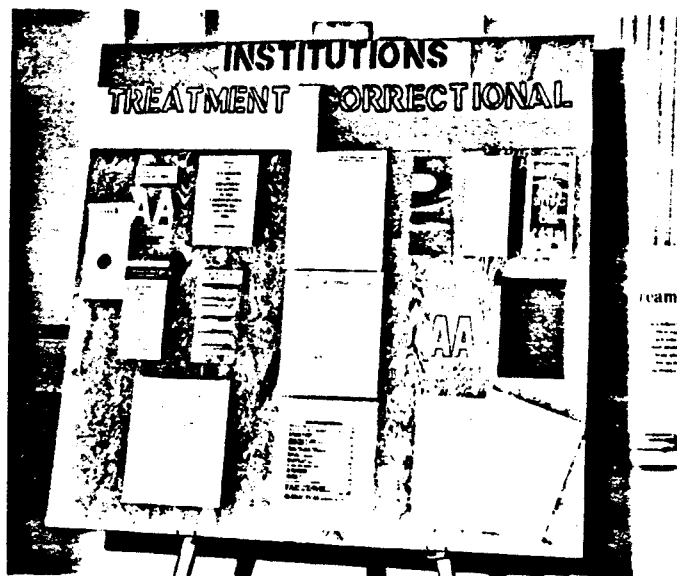
To carry the message to the confined alcoholic, G.S.O. offers correspondence with the staff member on this assignment and with other A.A.'s through our Institutions Correspondence Service. We list correctional facilities groups in our records and send each a Group Handbook, the Big Book, and other complementary literature. They also get our *Directory of A.A. Groups in Correctional Facilities*, Box 4-5-9 bimonthly, and the *Institutions Bulletin* three times yearly.

Discount packages of A.A. literature (English and Spanish) are available to "inside" groups and institutions committees. The Grapevine gives us back issues, which we pass along to these groups. Our three films and two of the filmstrips are available on loan without charge to groups in correctional facilities.

Our mail from local institutions committees and inside groups indicates a need for more literature, more A.A. sponsors, more "outside" speakers, and more outside A.A.'s to participate in the Institutions Correspondence Service.

Services from G.S.O. only open the door to A.A. recovery. Real recovery for the confined alcoholic depends on local institutions committees and sponsors who reach out the hand of A.A. in love and service.

Curtis Monahan



Groups respond to alert in countering inflation

Trustees' committee: At the end of 1980, publishing sales income (even after a 6% discount to A.A. groups most of the year) was up 17% over 1979. Contributions through the end of November showed almost no gain. However, when informed, the groups swamped us with contributions in December, bringing us closer to budget.

Exclusive of the net cost of the International Convention, most variations in expenses were in line with budget and were caused chiefly by A.A. growth and by inflation.

The A.A. Grapevine reported that expenses were higher than anticipated in the budget and income was lower, resulting in a 1980 operating loss. Interest on the investment of deferred subscription income was transferred from the Reserve Fund to partially offset that loss.

After a review in depth, 1981 budgets were approved. For G.S.O., sales have been budgeted to show an increase of 15%; contributions, 8%. The total expense of operations before extraordinary items (net Convention expense, World Service Meeting delegates' expense to the Convention, production cost of public service announcements, and office construction and refurbishing) is budgeted to be 12% higher than 1980.

For the Grapevine budget, income is expected to be 14% higher than 1980; expenses, 4.5%. An operating deficit is anticipated.

The preliminary budget for office construction and renovation, based on construction estimates and space allocations presented by Sherburne/Hurst, Inc., designers and planning consultants, was reviewed and approved.

Frank Smeal, chairperson, board treasurer

See pp. 49-55 for detailed financial information.



The pre-Conference period means a crowded schedule for nonalcoholic employees at G.S.O., as well as A.A.'s. Ed Gordon, assistant controller, is involved in preparing complete financial statements needed.

Discussions center on application of Traditions

Trustees' report: To better reflect the composition and hoped-for function of this session—in which trustees, A.A.W.S. and GV directors, staff, and nontrustee/director committee members all share as peers on matters of general concern to A.A.—it will henceforth be called the General (instead of General Service) Sharing Session.

In November, "Our Twelve Traditions and A.A.'s Future" was the subject of discussion. There was agreement that our Traditions are the "lessons of incredible experience" and were formulated as principles to guide us as individuals and as a fellowship and to insure our continuance. As individuals, we alcoholics always seem to be pulling toward two extremes—a rebellious need for freedom on one hand and a compelling desire for authority on the other. Our Traditions protect us from these extremes.

Most A.A. members accept and protect the Traditions. When we share with newcomers and, in a sense, "translate" the Traditions for them, we are more convincing if we relate the Traditions to our own experience, as we do with the Twelve Steps.

It was pointed out that G.S.O. has no official opinion on interpretation of the Traditions—we simply share experience received. We can be more helpful if we encourage A.A. members and groups to assume responsibility for interpreting the Traditions according to their own group conscience and in their own particular circumstances. No member can be asked to "enforce" the Traditions.

A seeming trend toward rigidity in some areas—a concern for the "letter" instead of the "spirit"—may come from fear and insecurity brought on by changing conditions in the world and in A.A.: younger newcomers, a greater percentage of women, more court referrals, widespread use of other drugs, and the proliferation of alcoholism treatment facilities.

As one of our presenters said: "Our Twelve Traditions permit us to look forward with confidence that our Fellowship will endure."

In February, our topic was "Attraction, Promotion, Information?" It provoked a lively discussion, with more participation by all present than at previous sessions.

All agreed that if we don't *reach* the suffering alcoholic, we can't fulfill our primary purpose. From the beginning of A.A., it was recognized that our person-to-person way of carrying the message is not enough. We have an obligation to inform the general public about who and what and where we are and what we offer.

There is frequently a difference of opinion about what is "attraction" and what is "promotion"; some people thought the Big Book was promotional when it was first published. Attraction may be described as the ability to carry the message anonymously, with grace, at the level of press, radio, and films. We can't be attractive if we are invisible. We need our many public information activities to correct false stereotypes and misinformation about A.A.

It was pointed out that the Eleventh Tradition is an expression of confidence in the A.A. program. If we provide proper, correct, clear information about A.A., we won't need to be promotional.

Virginia Hallman, chairperson

Lois Wilson, widow of co-founder Bill, graced the opening dinner, as she has for many years, and was greeted with a standing ovation. Another ovation was for Sylvia Smith, widow of Bernard Smith, who, as an early chairperson of A.A.'s board of trustees, had a profound influence on the development of the Conference structure. . . . LaVelle Clifford, regional trustee, Southwest U.S., was not able to attend the Conference; she was in the hospital for a major operation. A card signed by everyone there was only a token of the love and good wishes that were with LaVelle all week.

Group services coordinator

New aids for groups speaking Spanish or French

Staff report: The group services coordinator provides communication services to the Fellowship as a whole, supervising production of all service material, updating of Guidelines and listings, Group Handbooks, literature displays, G.S.R. Kits, and other material, and working closely with the staff coordinator and other staff members on the literature and Conference assignments.

There are three New Group Handbooks: (1) New Group Handbook; (2) New Correctional Facilities Group Handbook; (3) New Treatment Facilities Group Handbook.

New groups in the U.S. and Canada receive a handbook, a G.S.R. Kit, a complimentary supply of literature, *Box 4-5-9*, and the appropriate regional directory.

It is our intention to provide identical services to all A.A. groups within our structure. We list more than 1,000 French-speaking and 300 Spanish-speaking groups, and our handbook and *Box 4-5-9* are available in those languages. The G.S.R. Kit is available in French, and we look forward to developing a similar kit in Spanish, pending the Spanish translation of "The A.A. Service Manual."

There are now 13 Guidelines. As the need arises, they are updated to keep up with current trends.

Other service material includes the following lists: A.A.'s interested in exchanging tapes; Loners; Internationalists; armed services groups; overseas G.S.O.'s; central offices in the U.S. and Canada; books and pamphlets in languages other than English (Foreign Literature Order Form, Spanish Order Form). We also have suggestions for discussion-meeting topics, for conducting workshops and sharing sessions, and for carrying the message to hearing-impaired alcoholics.

Three 16 mm films are available: "Bill's Own Story," "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," and "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View." The first two are restricted to regular A.A. and Al-Anon groups (1974 Conference action); the third is avail-

able outside A.A. as well. The films rent for \$35 per week and are distributed free to A.A. groups in institutions.

Two filmstrips, "P.O. Box 459" and "Circles of Love and Service," may be purchased at \$6.50 each for group meetings, assemblies, and conventions. The filmstrip "Markings on the Journey" costs \$8.50 and may be viewed within A.A.; a Spanish translation of the audio portion is available.

Vincina McCarthy

International

Stronger global linkage for A.A. service entities

Trustees' committee: At the October 1978 General Service Board meeting, it was agreed to form a committee to deal with matters overseas and to utilize traveling A.A. members. The committee, which met first in January 1979, is composed of nine members, two of whom are trustees currently serving as delegates to the World Service Meeting (W.S.M.). It explores ways in which the board and/or G.S.O. may assist in the growth of A.A. worldwide, with particular attention to countries having no A.A. structure.

At one meeting, it was suggested that all W.S.M. countries be included in membership surveys. After discussion, it was agreed that G.S.O.'s overseas be contacted to find out whether they would like to participate. The committee reviewed highlights of the Sixth W.S.M. For the Seventh, it recommended simultaneous translation in Spanish and extension of the Meeting from four to five days.

The committee recommended that in 1985 a booth be set up at the International Convention to supply information on A.A. in overseas countries.

A subcommittee was appointed to research background on an appropriate new name for the International Committee, to eliminate confusion with the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee.

Stan Cameron, chairperson

International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums

Spotlight turns to 1985; new topics at Forums

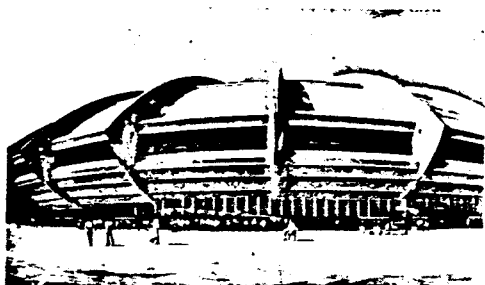
Trustees' committee:

International Convention—A selection of comments and suggestions on the 45th Anniversary Convention in New Orleans follows:

"The Superdome was perfect for an audience of our size, aurally and visually. Simultaneous translations were a big success; eido-phores (giant TV screens) were a great investment; programming was very well received. Special-interest meetings appeared to fill a genuine need; the Marathon meeting was extremely popular; the Saturday-night show was a smash. It has been suggested that the future scheduling of state and provincial alkathons and wel-

coming remarks by a local city official be reconsidered. Convention signs (instructional, directional, etc.) should be printed in the four major languages. The total net paid registration was about 22,500."

In September 1980, invitations to bid on the 50th Anniversary International Convention (1985) were sent to all delegates in the U.S. and Canada. Ten areas indicated interest, but only Chicago, Minneapolis, Montreal, New York, and San Diego returned completed bid questionnaires. The committee reviewed the bids. All cities met, or said they would meet, Convention requirements. The committee also recommended that the delegate site presentations at the 1981 Conference be 15 minutes each, with time allowed for committee members' questions after each.



The stadium in Montreal's Olympic Park, with ample space for 1985 Big Meetings, was a factor in Conference members' preference of that city for the 50th Anniversary A.A. International Convention. (See Floor Action 2, p. 46.)

Regional Forums—Since the Regional Forum concept was introduced in 1975, 18 Forums have been held. Four regions have hosted Forums within the past year. Our committee discussed each of those Forums, which continue to be well received by service workers and to improve communication within our Fellowship.

The Regional Forum coordinator works closely with the regional trustee and delegates in planning Forum agenda. Formats have altered slightly to include presentations and discussions on such topics as cooperation with the professional community, public information, and finance. In response to local interest in A.A.'s publishing functions and to desire for background information on "what *really* goes on at G.S.O.," recent Forums have included presentations on those subjects.

The committee discussed the purpose, format, and locations of Forums. It recommended that the 1981 Conference consider the subject "Regional Forums—How Well Are They Working?"

Box 4-5-9 keeps the Fellowship informed of Regional Forums. Here is a schedule of future Forums:

1981		
September 25-27	East Central U.S.	Akron, Ohio
December 4-6	Southwest	Kansas City, Mo.
1982		
March 5-7	Eastern Canada	Montreal, Que.
June 11-13	Pacific	Las Vegas, Nev.
September 24-26	Western Canada	Winnipeg, Man.
December	Southeast (?)	

Jerry Danzig, chairperson

Staff report:

A.A. Regional Forums—All regions have hosted Forums; plans

for the third round are under way; Montana hosts a mini-forum in June. Forums are held on the invitation of the region, and plans are made with the regional trustee, delegates from areas in the region, and the G.S.O. staff. Board personnel who have attended include: trustees, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors. The board pays hotel, mail, and travel expenses of all its personnel in attendance, and expenses for the region's service people are the responsibility of either the individuals or area committees.

The Regional Forum coordinator plans Forums with the regional trustee and delegates and the general manager of G.S.O.; makes arrangements with the host-city contact (the local liaison), hotel, and host city; arranges travel and hotels for board personnel; handles mailings to the region's delegates (asking for agenda suggestions), G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, area committee officers, past/present delegates, past/present trustees, and central offices; and is responsible for display boards of sample literature and service material. Reports on Regional Forums are sent to all Forum participants, all trustees, and all current delegates.

Any member wishing to attend may request a registration/reservation form.

Vincina McCarthy

Internationalists, Loners, LIMs

Big Book goes to sea; Loners meet 'pen in hand'

Staff report: The seagoing A.A.'s known as Internationalists continued to grow in membership in the past year. They start groups in many ports they frequent, and also have started 26 groups aboard ships.

Big Books are placed in ships' libraries. Recently, a new Internationalist shared his experience: "I've been reading your A.A. book I found in the ship's library and would like to take up your way of life." A month later, the same man wrote: "Since receiving your information and letters, I've run into another man who goes to A.A. meetings over here, and hopefully he will be my sponsor."

Loners also have continued to increase. A familiar saying among them is: "If you need a meeting, go to one with pen in hand." As the name Loners implies, they are members unable to attend meetings because there are no A.A. groups nearby. Till they can start a group, they remain on the Loner mailing list at G.S.O., and they stay sober through A.A. literature and correspondence, often using tapes.

LIMs are members who are housebound or physically handicapped. That includes those who are hearing-impaired, and this membership has increased during the past year.

Each new Internationalist, Loner, or LIM receives a package of A.A. literature, lists of Internationalists and Loners, the alternating bimonthly bulletins *Loners-Internationalists Meeting* and *Box 4-5-9*, and a Grapevine order form. A Loner or a LIM receives the appropriate A.A. directory; an Internationalist, all four directories.

When Internationalists no longer go to sea, they sometimes wish

to be added to the G.S.O. mailing list as Port Contacts. They offer A.A. friendship to Internationalists on visiting ships, and many have started groups in various ports.

Loner Sponsors are members who correspond and share experience, strength, hope, and group activities with Loners. They also receive a Loners list and the two bulletins.

Lyla Bonney

Literature

Committees standing by for Bill W. biography

Trustees' committee: This committee, in cooperation with the Conference Literature Committee, has worked on the following:

Completed literature projects

- "A Newcomer Asks . . ."—completed August 1980. There has been a favorable response to this leaflet; by January, 140,000 copies had been distributed. Sterling Area Services of Great Britain, where this piece originated, requested that the copyright be held by A.A.W.S. This change will appear on the first reprint, with a credit line stating the leaflet's origin.
- "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers"—completed June 1980; copies distributed—45,170.

Current literature projects

- The National Association of the Deaf, after reviewing some of our basic recovery pamphlets, informed us that "A Brief Guide to A.A." was the best to rewrite for the deaf alcoholic seeking help. The committee is reviewing this rewrite.
- The biography of our co-founder Bill W. is moving right along but is not yet ready to go through the committee-approval process.

Audiovisual projects

- The tape of the book "Alcoholics Anonymous" continues to be a popular item, with 1,242 copies distributed to date.
- There continue to be many requests for our film "Alcoholics

Anonymous—An Inside View," with over 200 prints leased long-term within and outside the Fellowship. Some foreign G.S.O.'s that have leased the film are England, Finland, South Africa, Australia, Iceland, and New Zealand.

Results of discussion of other topics

- The committee considered a suggestion to rewrite the book "Alcoholics Anonymous" to address men and women in a more equitable manner, and recommended that no action be taken, because of the feeling most A.A.'s have about the Big Book, historically and spiritually.
- The committee considered a suggestion to publish an illustrated pamphlet on the Twelve Concepts, similar to "Twelve Traditions Illustrated." It was felt that we did not need such a pamphlet at this time.

Samuel Smith, chairperson

Staff report: This assignment involves preparation, production, editorial supervision, and distribution of publications and audiovisual materials, in coordination with other staff members. The literature coordinator works closely with the group services coordinator on all service material.

G.S.O. bulletins

We distribute *Box 4-5-9* in English and Spanish and five other periodical bulletins, with a combined circulation of 83,336, as follows:

	Mailing list	Issues per year
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (English)	45,223	6
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (French) ¹	2,147	6
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (Spanish)	11,691	6
<i>Loners-Internationalists Meeting</i>	3,576	6
<i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>	3,455	3
<i>Institutions Bulletin</i>	5,698	3
<i>Quarterly Report</i>	4,000	3 ²
<i>About A.A.</i>	7,546	3
Total	83,336	36

1 Translated and printed by the French Literature Service in Montreal, Que., in cooperation with this office.

2 The *Final Conference Report* takes the place of the fourth issue.



Steps in the process of producing a G.S.O. bulletin—at the RCH plant in the Woodside section of New York City—include setting type on a word

processor, preparing negatives of complete pages (type and photos), and folding pages after printing and cutting. RCH also mails the bulletins.

The literature coordinator works closely with editors on updating and revising old pamphlets and with writers, artists, editors, and printers in the preparation of new pamphlets, displays, leaflets, and other service materials, including audiovisual. One project this year was the redesign and color change of several pamphlet covers, to make our pamphlets more uniform and attractive.

It is anticipated that the second draft of the biography of our co-founder Bill W. will be submitted for committee review by the fall of 1981.

There is frequent correspondence with A.A. groups and individuals requesting specific information about A.A. literature, and a letter is sent semiannually to all central offices, intergroups, and literature distribution centers to keep them informed of new developments in A.A. literature, periodicals, and audiovisual materials.

Helen Turnquest

The language of the what?

It wasn't the quietest Conference ever; at times, some of the first-term Conference members had trouble figuring out what was happening—for example, a couple of French-speaking delegates from Canada. During the coffee break after a particularly spirited general session, one Canadian asked another how he liked the Conference so far. The answer was a shrug—he wasn't too sure. Maybe he just didn't understand Americans, he mused. Everybody was talking the same language, and yet—he said with an eloquent Gallic flourish—they didn't seem to understand each other. Another Canadian stepped in with a solution: Even though they all spoke English, they did it with a lot of different accents!

Nominating

Methods of choosing candidates examined

Trustees' committee: Milton Maxwell spoke to the committee in October to clarify last year's statement on his willingness to continue to serve as chairperson of the General Service Board. Dr. Maxwell stated that he is willing to serve the four remaining years he is eligible. If at any time he feels he cannot continue, he will notify this committee at its October meeting prior to his resignation.

Two recommendations from Canadian delegates regarding the method of electing the trustee-at-large/Canada were reviewed. The second was rejected. The first was recommended, subject to the approval of the Conference Committee on Trustees. The suggested new procedure called for delegates from Western Canada to caucus and present two nominees, and for those from Ontario, from Quebec, and from the Maritimes to caucus separately and present one nominee each, for a total of three. [This recommendation was not accepted; see Advisory Action 47, p. 48.]

The committee reviewed the résumés and approved the nomina-

tion of John Bragg and Jacquelyn Solomon as general service trustees from the A.A.W.S. board of directors, to be elected by the General Service Board following the Conference.

The committee reviewed and approved as eligible for election candidates for regional trustees of the East Central, Southeast, and Western Canada Regions.

The committee reviewed the résumés and approved as eligible for election all candidates for trustee-at-large/U.S., making some requests for additional information.

While the résumé form states that résumés should be completed by someone other than the candidate, there is on the form, under "Occupational Background," a question that begins "Are you a salaried employee . . . ?" It was suggested that an appropriate change be made on the form.

It was suggested that regional trustees should remind delegates at the regional caucuses that the election of a trustee-at-large is not a regional competition, and that they should carefully review the résumés of *all* candidates before casting their votes; and that all delegates and trustees eligible to vote in the election devise a method of evaluating the résumés of *all* candidates.

We recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in May, following presentation to the 1981 Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Michael Alexander	Gordon M. Patrick
W. J. (Jim) Estelle Jr.	Frank P. Smeal
William E. Flynn, M.D.	Kenneth H. Williams, M.D.
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph. D.	

Class B

John K. Bragg	Richard J. Driscoll
Stan N. Cameron	M. T. (Bud) Grondahl
LaVelle Clifford	Fernand Ippersiel
Donald Daly	John Ryall
George Dorsey	Jacquelyn Solomon

One regional trustee—Western Canada
 One regional trustee—Southeast U.S.
 One regional trustee—East Central U.S.
 One trustee-at-large/U.S.

The committee approved the following slate of officers of the board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	Gordon M. Patrick
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	Michael Alexander
<i>Secretary</i>	Fernand Ippersiel
<i>Treasurer</i>	Frank P. Smeal
<i>Assistant treasurer</i>	Dennis Manders
<i>Assistant secretary</i>	¹ Phyllis Masback

We recommended that this slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., be presented to the 1981 Conference:

² Michael Alexander	¹ Phyllis Masback
John Bragg	Robert G. Pearson
LaVelle Clifford	Jacquelyn Solomon
Louis Kraus	Virginia Turner

We recommended to the Conference as Grapevine directors:

Stan N. Cameron	Mary Phelps
Donald Daly	Ralph Rosenberg
Retha Gresham	John Ryall
M. T. (Bud) Grondahl	James Shannon
Tom Neary	

The committee will review résumés and make its recommendations via mail and telephone poll regarding the candidate to replace Jeanne Conway on the Grapevine board.

We discussed committee responsibilities in nominating candidates for A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors and in selection of nondirector and nontrustee members of trustees' committees. It was pointed out that this committee and the General Service Board should have some part in selecting directors, because directors may later be nominated as candidates for general service trustee.

Regarding committee responsibilities in connection with Class A trustee candidates, our chairperson pointed out that we should make sure there is always someone among those trustees who is available and willing to serve as chairperson of the board.

LaVelle Clifford, chairperson

- 1 To be replaced at rotation time (September 1, 1981) by Sarah Price
- 2 The board recommended that the term of Michael Alexander be two years, so that openings on the board may be better staggered.

Overseas, World Service Meeting

More countries develop A.A. service structures

Staff report:

Overseas—The staff member on this assignment corresponds with 27 G.S.O.'s and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada, in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (French-speaking), Belgium (Flemish-speaking), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, El Salvador, Great Britain, Finland, France, Guatemala, Honduras, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, and West Germany.

When letters are received from groups and individuals in those countries, they are encouraged to correspond with their G.S.O.'s. If an overseas G.S.O. then needs a more detailed sharing of experience, it contacts G.S.O. U.S./Canada.

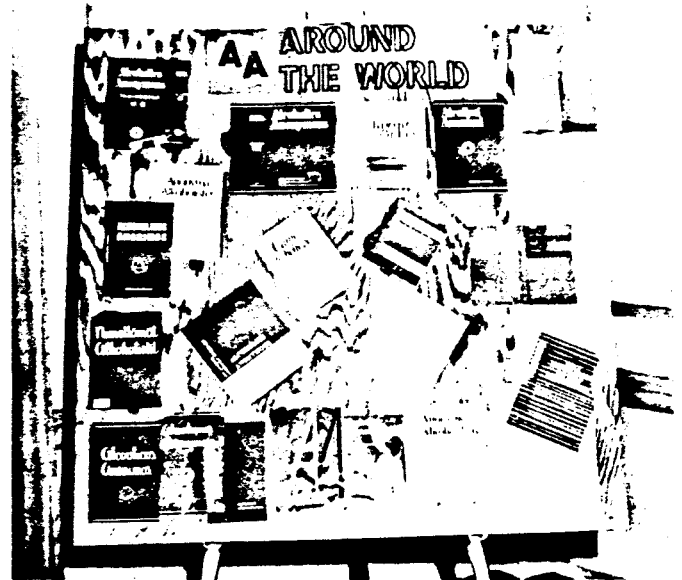
For countries having their own G.S.O.'s, we list only English-speaking groups and contacts, intergroups/central offices, and Loners. Travelers are encouraged to contact those offices for up-to-date meeting information.

Correspondence from groups and individual A.A.'s in countries where there is no such center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment.

We work closely with countries overseas to help them establish distribution centers, general service boards, and general service

offices. Guidelines for setting up those entities are available from G.S.O.

Correspondence that comes to G.S.O. in a foreign language is translated, and a response is sent in the same language.



To protect A.A.'s copyright, careful consideration is given to granting reprint permissions within the Fellowship. Translations from overseas countries are checked by bilingual A.A.'s in the U.S. and Canada. No permission is needed simply to *translate* Conference-approved literature. But before the project of *printing* a translation begins, G.S.O. first explores the way the material will be financed and distributed. It is then presented to A.A.W.S. for permission to reprint.

Here are some brief highlights about A.A. overseas: The Big Book is now available in Italian, and there is a G.S.O. in Rome, Italy; we are checking a Dutch translation of the Big Book and a retranslation in Norwegian (done to improve on the first effort); A.A.'s in West Germany conducted their First Conference Meeting—a success.

We have been asked and have agreed to send a G.S.O. staff member to the Second Spanish American Service Meeting, in Buenos Aires, Argentina, August 13-17, 1981.

World Service Meeting—The World Service Meeting (W.S.M.) meets biennially, at locations alternating between the U.S. and overseas. The Seventh W.S.M. will be held October 14-18, 1982, in Mexico, in accordance with a recommendation of the Sixth.

W.S.M. delegates should be legal residents and preferably citizens of the countries they serve. It is recommended that a country be represented either by two A.A.'s or by one A.A. and one non-A.A., with one delegate being a member of the country's general service board or national service committee, the other a salaried or volunteer staff member. It is required that delegates have a working knowledge of English, as the Meeting is conducted in that language. However, the Sixth W.S.M. recommended simultaneous translation in Spanish and English at the Seventh.

When a country develops a national A.A. structure, it is qualified to attend a W.S.M. Italy, the most recent to form such a structure, will be represented in 1982.

A final report on the Sixth W.S.M. is available.

Beth Kuhlmann

Public Information

A.A. message broadcast in three languages

Trustees' committee: The following projects have been completed:

- Six TV public service announcements (including one in French, one in Spanish, one with subtitles for the hearing-impaired) were produced, and a brochure was developed describing each spot. A.A.W.S. priced the spots at cost, \$12.50 each (available in 1" or 3/4" videotape). A mailing went out to 900 TV stations in the U.S. and 200 in Canada, and over 325 expressed interest. Two more spots will be released in 1982.
- "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View" appeared on local TV in over 20 areas. A flyer was developed describing the film for TV use (available in 3/4" U-matic videotape cassette or 16 mm film). As a result of this P.I. effort, new members are coming to A.A., delegates report.



- Ten radio public service announcements (six in English, two in Spanish, two in French) were completed in February 1981. Service material on how to place those spots on the air was developed. A letter went to P.I. committees and contacts announcing availability of the radio spots at \$5 each, on record, 1/4" tape, or cassette. A mailing went to 6,000 radio stations in the U.S. and Canada, with return postcards. Cards received were forwarded to local P.I. committees; spots will be ordered and taken care of by individual areas.

- The flyer "A Message to Teenagers," a useful P.I. tool for speaking in schools, is available free.

- Eight new feature stories were distributed, and many P.I. committees are trying to place these press releases in local newspapers.

- A press release on "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers" was sent to editors and book-review editors.

- The annual anonymity letter to the press was mailed in December 1980 to major newspaper editors, news and photo editors, and radio and television news directors.

- The pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" now includes short answers to the questions on pages 9 and 10.

The following projects are now in progress:

- In February, the filled-out questionnaires from the 1980 membership survey were mailed to our consultant for analysis. After the results have been received and discussed by this committee, a press release will go out; a new pamphlet (updating "The A.A. Member") and a new tabletop display will be developed. Reports on the survey will appear in the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin* and *About A.A.*
- Reaching minority groups will become a major 1981 project. A subcommittee has presented a report on the subject to the Conference P.I. Committee.
- "Understanding Anonymity" is being rewritten and will be submitted to the Conference P.I. Committee for approval or disapproval.

Ruth Hartshorn, chairperson

Staff report: We now have 517 active P.I. committees, 527 P.I. contacts, and 424 others on the P.I. list. Many committees keep in close touch with G.S.O.; their news of their meetings and local P.I. activities supplies most of the material for the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*. Every new P.I. committee is listed, and its chairperson receives a P.I. Workbook. (A P.I. committee may order additional workbooks for \$7 each.)

If an A.A. group writes the P.I. desk to say it has elected a P.I. chairperson, a letter is sent encouraging that chairperson to get in touch with a local P.I. committee through the intergroup or central office or the area or district committee. Often, a P.I. committee is formed by several A.A. groups' getting together.

It takes three persons, including the staff member, to cover P.I. activities at G.S.O. One nonalcoholic answers daily phone or mail requests for information about A.A. from students, teachers, nurses, doctors, members of the clergy, family members, and writers. She also sends material for health fairs upon request. Another nonalcoholic types letters—more than 30 a day. The three handled over 10,000 requests from the public last year. We get the most calls on teenagers and women, from writers, reporters, and students. We use our membership survey to answer the questions.

We receive, read, and categorize about 500 clippings a month from our clipping service and from A.A.'s. We write about 40 gratitude letters a month to newspapers that publish good coverage of A.A., and ten to 15 regarding anonymity breaks.

A general request for sharing on better methods of reaching

minority-group alcoholics has gone to local P.I. committees and contacts, and the results will be published in a future *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*.

Susan Daly

Staff coordinator

Communication thrives via mail and visits

Staff report: Services provided by G.S.O. to A.A. groups and members are divided at present into 11 staff assignments. In addition to assuming a functional responsibility such as public information, Regional Forums, or literature, most staff members correspond with groups and members in a specific region of the U.S. or Canada, or with A.A.'s in overseas countries where there is no national G.S.O. Staff members rotate assignments every two years. Currently, the work is apportioned as follows:

Conference	Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; Early Bird Box 4-5-9; <i>Final Conference Report</i> ; co-secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums
Cooperation with the professional community	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; <i>About A.A.</i> ; <i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>
Correctional facilities	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; assistant, cooperation with the professional community and public information; <i>Institutions Bulletin</i> ; <i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>
Group correspondence	Secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees; editor, Box 4-5-9
Group correspondence	Two regions

Group services coordinator,
A.A. Regional Forums

Literature coordinator

Overseas, World Service Meeting,
Spanish correspondence

Public information

Staff coordinator

Treatment facilities, Loners,
Internationalists, LIMs

Co-secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee
Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees
Secretary, trustees' International Committee; secretary, World Service Meeting; Spanish Box 4-5-9
Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*
Assistant secretary, General Service Board; secretary, trustees' General Sharing Session; secretary, Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions; director, A.A.W.S.; *Quarterly Report*
Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; *Loners-Internationalists Meeting*; *Institutions Bulletin*

During 1980, over 20,000 letters were answered. The staff coordinator makes sure mail is answered during vacations, sickness, absences, or a staff member's involvement with a special project.

An exciting aspect of staff service is invitations to A.A. conventions, assembly meetings, and get-togethers. They provide the staff opportunities to become acquainted with A.A.'s all over the U.S. and Canada, to inform them about G.S.O. services, and most important, to gain information on local activities that can be shared with other groups.

In 1980, almost 1,200 visitors from all over the world came to G.S.O. Each visitor has the opportunity to tour the various G.S.O. and Grapevine departments. The visits give us a wonderful chance to explain G.S.O.'s work and to learn about A.A. activities in each visitor's hometown or country. An A.A. member now serves as tour guide.

At the weekly staff meetings, the staff coordinator takes minutes that are circulated to all concerned, including the general manager and all department heads. From time to time, a meeting is conducted by the group services coordinator. The purpose of the meetings is to seek more and better ways of providing the most useful services to A.A. groups and members.

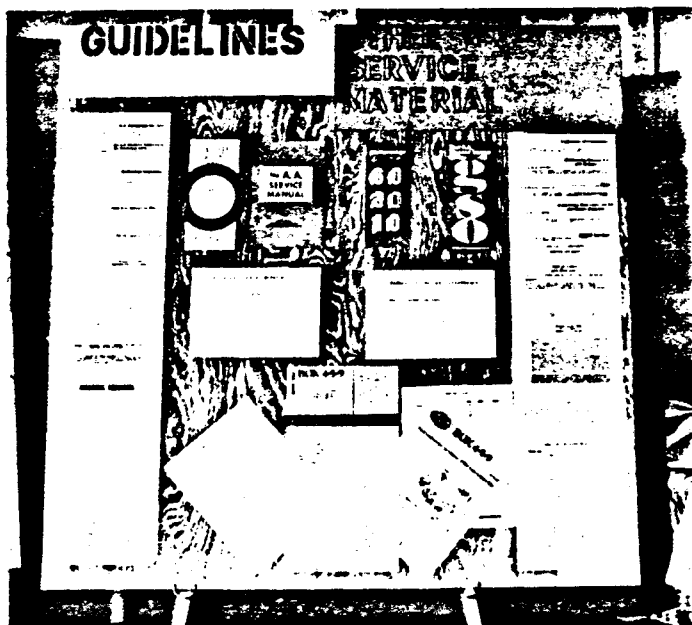
The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff vacations and scheduled trips, in order to assure that the office is covered at all times, and serves as a liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments.

Phyllis Masback

Treatment Facilities

Status of groups and meetings in centers studied

Trustees' committee: After a subcommittee explored the question of how to carry the message into senior citizen homes and retirement places, we decided that our concern should be primarily with the older alcoholic in treatment facilities and that carrying the message to senior citizens elsewhere was a responsibility of the Public Information Committee. It was recommend-



ed that an article in a future issue of the new *Treatment Facilities Bulletin* alert the Fellowship to the need for A.A.'s to sponsor the older alcoholic. It was further recommended that our efforts be coordinated with the efforts of related committees.

It was recommended that a subcommittee draft changes in the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers," chiefly to make a clear distinction between the two types of meetings held in those centers: regular group meetings and treatment center meetings. It was recommended that the six-point definition of an A.A. group be included in the pamphlet and that, in the future, what is now known as a treatment center group be called a treatment center meeting.

This committee met with the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities, and the two committees recommended replacing the present *Institutions Bulletin* with a *Correctional Facilities Bulletin* and a *Treatment Facilities Bulletin*. The bulletins need not have the same frequency of distribution; this decision should be left to the discretion of the staff.

Gordon Patrick, chairperson

Staff report: Treatment center groups—for patients only—continue to multiply. The message is carried to these newcomers by institution committee members, treatment facilities

committee members, and other local A.A.'s. Many regular A.A. groups use meeting space in treatment centers, but their meetings are open to A.A.'s in the community.

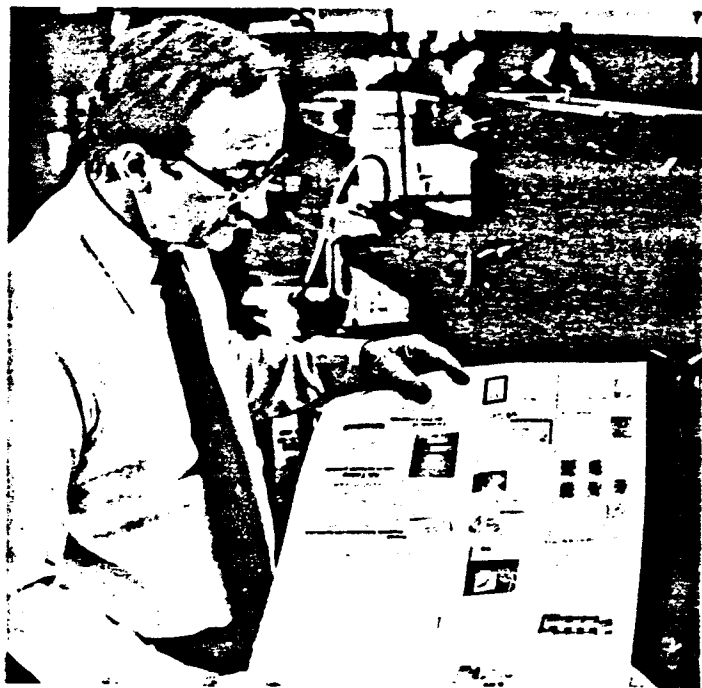
Correspondence from both kinds of groups continues to fill our "in" box, where often-repeated questions are found. How does the small A.A. group cope with an ever-increasing influx of newcomers referred to A.A. from treatment facilities? How do A.A. groups stay within Traditions when meeting in a treatment facility if the facility provides coffee and free meeting space? How does an A.A. group coordinate its efforts with those of local and state treatment facilities committees?

Phone calls, as well as letters, often indicated concern over the possibility of implied affiliation with the treatment center. In most cases, members were not aware that there were two types of meetings in treatment facilities.

G.S.O. services to those in treatment centers include: correspondence with the staff member on this assignment; for new groups, a Group Handbook and complimentary literature; Box 4-5-9 bimonthly and the *Institutions Bulletin* three times yearly; a discount package of A.A. literature (ordered through the committee or the group); Guidelines for Correctional and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Lyla Bonney

Reports From the A.A. Grapevine



Grapevine order forms get a final check from Serge Mironovitch, president of the RCH printing plant (which also handles this report).

GvR success points up need to expand program

Directors' report: Circulation with the December 1980 issue was 128,100, an increase of 6.3% over 1979, resulting in magazine income of \$613,897. Miscellaneous-item sales were up 18%, adding \$144,263, resulting in a total income of \$758,160.

Though a price increase went into effect in July 1980, the full effect of that increase has not been realized yet, because many subscriptions still have to be honored at the old rate.

The anticipated 10% increase in circulation was not realized during 1980. The two previous years showed increases of 11.3% and 10.9%. This may indicate that the peak of GvR activity was reached in 1978-79 and has leveled off. Yearly circulation increases averaged 5% prior to the GvR program.

Wall calendar sales were down about \$4,000 from 1979, and the pocket planners (a new item) brought \$23,679 in income. Again, these sales were not as projected in the budget, but they made a cash contribution of \$19,395 to operations. Sales of other items, such as "The Best of Bill" and "A.A. Today," were good in 1980, with an overall increase of 7%.

The GvR program continues to be effective in areas where groups have designated Grapevine representatives. However, only about 20% of the groups have GvRs. While this is a good network of communication, there is still the 80% that the

Grapevine office cannot reach. We hope that more groups will designate GvRs during 1981.

The magazine, our readers tell us, gets better and better. Manuscripts continue to arrive daily, and there's lots of good material in the bin. Tom Neary, associate editor, started designing the covers in January 1980, and we continue to receive compliments from the Fellowship, not only on magazine content, but also on cover design.

All of us involved in production of your magazine are sensitive to the responsibility you have placed in our hands. When the member who first thought of this magazine went to Bill in 1944 and sketched out the possibilities for what was to be simply a metropolitan newsletter, Bill said, "Go to it." Let me assure you that we are still going to it.

Don Daly, chairperson

Staff report: As if foreseeing the 1981 Conference theme, we have done a good bit of our own inventory-taking over the last couple of years, department by department, as the need became apparent.

The circulation increase during the past three years was about 27%—a direct result of GvR committees' effectiveness in some areas. Not only has this activity brought in more business, in both subscriptions and miscellaneous-item sales, it has also brought in more material editorially, along with a tremendous increase of correspondence to all departments. As the circulation has grown, the regular routine of the Circulation Department has expanded accordingly; there are more changes of address and more problems with subscriptions, mailing, and computer error. Thanks to changes made in procedures in 1980 for both the Bookkeeping and the Circulation Departments, work is flowing much more smoothly, although it is still very heavy.

In the overall operation of the Grapevine, our greatest concern is coping with inflation. Significant changes have been made to reduce costs where possible, and ideas for further reductions are currently being explored. As we continue our inventory-taking, we at the Grapevine will keep two major goals in mind: (1) providing the best service possible, while (2) offering the very best product possible—our beloved magazine.

Retha Gresham, managing editor



Out of Earnest Debate, a Well-Informed Consensus Among Conference Members

The group conscience of the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory (to the Board) Actions, which the General Service Board approved in its legally required annual meeting just after the Conference. In addition to the actions introduced on the floor before the whole Conference, others were based upon the reports of the Conference committees, as indicated in the headings. (Members and officers of the 1981 committees are listed on page 56).

Floor Actions

It was recommended that:

- 1 Clubs not receive the literature discount available to A.A. groups.
- 2 The report of the 1985 International Convention Site Selection Committee be accepted; first, second, and third choices as follows—(a) Montreal, (b) San Diego, (c) Minneapolis.
- 3 The filmstrip "Markings on the Journey" be shown within the Fellowship only.
- 4 Complete financial reports of the International Conventions be published in the *Final Conference Reports*, including the 1980 International Convention. [See page 49.]
- 5 All areas to be notified before announcements on the availability of television or radio spots are sent to radio and television stations, so that local autonomy can be exercised.

Presentations related to Floor Action 1: pp. 14, 16-17

Presentation touching on topic related to Floor Action 4: pp. 12-13

Workshop touching on topic related to Floor Action 5: pp. 14-15

Agenda

It was recommended that:

- 6 Suggestions for a possible theme for the 1982 General Service Conference be built around one of the following: (a) "Equal Voice—Equal Responsibility"; (b) "Equal Authority—Equal Responsibility"; (c) "The Traditions—The Way to Unity"; (d) "A.A.—Its Structure."
- 7 The following presentation/discussion subjects be considered for the 1982 Conference: (a) "Equal Authority—Equal Responsibility" (on the opening morning if feasible); (b) "How We Carry the Message to Alcoholics Coming to Us From Outside Agencies."
- 8 At next year's Conference, we have two structured workshops: (a) "How We Carry the Message to Alcoholics Coming to Us From Outside Agencies"; (b) "Why A.A. Works—The Traditions."
- 9 The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1982 Conference consist of five speakers—one trustee, two delegates, and two staff members (one G.S.O. and one GV)—and one delegate chairing. It was further recommended that the format of the meeting should be reviewed each year by the Conference Agenda Committee.

Cooperation With the Professional Community

It was recommended that:

- 10 A.A. publish a leaflet addressed to labor and management.
- 11 The leaflet "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community" be reinstated as General Service Conference-approved literature and put back into distribution as soon as possible.

Correctional Facilities

It was recommended that:

- 12 The pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic" be continued, but that the recommendation be reviewed again by the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities next year.

Finance

It was recommended that:

- 13 All future events such as the International Convention not be planned to operate on a deficit basis, and it was also recommended that all future events of this type be self-supporting.
 - 14 The word "Suggested" be added to the title of the 60-30-10 Plan folder and that the words "where applicable and practicable" be added to the copy of Panel 3 of the folder.
 - 15 The graphics of the 60-30-10 Plan folder should indicate that the 60-30-10 formula is flexible and subject to local autonomy, and that the copy give illustrations reflecting the flexibility to meet local needs (for example, the needs of a D.C.M. for travel expenses). It should also give special emphasis to the Regular Contribution Plan.
 - 16 Because the committee felt that the increasing trend of A.A. financial dependence on publishing income was diminishing the Fellowship's traditional support by group contributions, the Conference Finance Committee recommended that in delegates' reports to their areas, they place emphasis on the basic spiritual need for self-support by communicating to their areas, districts, and groups the need to broaden the base of group support.
- Recognizing the effect of inflation on group expenses and the cost of maintaining group services, the committee felt deep concern that the contributions are no longer sufficient to meet A.A.'s needs.
- 17 Contribution statements to groups in Quebec continue to be sent along with a letter written in both French and English thanking those groups that had contributed directly to their district or area, which in turn sent its surplus to G.S.O. The letter is to be generated by lists of contributing groups supplied by the delegates from each of the four Quebec areas. The letter will acknowledge the actual amount received by G.S.O. during a designated period.
 - 18 Item 3 of the *ad hoc* committee recommendations of Febru-

ary 3, 1978, which reads as follows, be deleted: "Income on that portion of the Reserve Fund attributable to the deferred subscription income will be retained by the General Service Board Reserve Fund as long as the Grapevine has income from operation. In the event of an operating deficit, such income would be credited automatically to the Grapevine to the extent of its deficiency or the limit of such income."

The following paragraph be substituted: "All income earned on that portion of the Reserve Fund attributable to the deferred subscriptions be credited to the Grapevine and reflected on the Grapevine financial statement. The contra amount of the increase in income will be added to the asset account of the General Service Board Reserve Fund."

The reporting and crediting of interest earned on Grapevine unexpired subscription income as originally recommended by the *ad hoc* committee report of February 3, 1978, be maintained.

Presentation touching on topic related to Advisory Actions 13, 16: pp. 12-13

Presentation touching on topic related to Advisory Action 16: pp. 16-17

Grapevine

It was recommended that:

19 The Grapevine provide a discount package of Grapevine miscellaneous items for sale to groups and central offices/inter-groups with a reasonable discount.

20 Delegates, in their continuing effort to achieve GvRs in their groups, work toward establishing district GvRs.

21 The Grapevine Corporate Board consider increasing the cover price of the Grapevine.

22 The yearly Grapevine income statement reflect the money held in escrow for unfulfilled subscriptions, and the interest accrued by this amount be shown. The Conference did not accept this recommendation, but requested that it be tabled and referred to a joint meeting of the 1982 Conference Finance and Grapevine Committees.

Presentations on the Grapevine: pp. 17-21

Literature

It was recommended that:

23 The suggestion to publish a pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic be tabled until the 1982 Conference to allow time for all delegates to get the group conscience from the groups in their areas.

The suggestion to publish a pamphlet for the homosexual alcoholic be placed on the 1982 Conference Literature Committee agenda.

24 The suggestion to include information about meeting new-



comers from treatment centers "where they are" be added to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet when it is next reprinted. The suggested information to read as follows: "Welcoming newcomers from treatment centers, keeping in mind that they usually have already gotten sober and have been given some introduction to the A.A. program."

25 The suggestion to put a two-year moratorium on any new literature not be accepted.

A subcommittee be formed, consisting of a member from each trustee committee involved in the preparation of literature, to review already existing pamphlets with an eye to which pamphlets could be combined or dropped; and their report be given to the 1982 Conference.

26 A footnote be added to Tradition Eight in the book "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," page 169, to update the job description of present-day G.S.O. staff members. The suggested footnote to read: "The work of present-day staff members has no counterpart among the job categories of commercial organizations. These A.A.'s bring a wide range of business and professional experience to their service at G.S.O."

27 The suggestion to include the Twelve Traditions in all recovery pamphlets when feasible be accepted.

Presentation on A.A. literature: p. 13

Presentations touching on topics related to Advisory Action 27: pp. 10-11, 23-24

Policy/Admissions

It was recommended that:

28 There be no changes in the 1982 Conference questionnaire.

29 The request for an additional delegate from Area 81 (New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island, Canada) be denied.

30 The printing of the Ask-It Basket questions and answers in their present form be discontinued.

31 The section on Ask-It Basket questions and answers in the *Final Conference Report* be continued.

32 Some criteria should be set by the Conference on what constitutes an Advisory Action, and that members of the Policy/Admissions Committee study the matter and present some sort of guidelines for consideration by members of the 1982 General Service Conference.

Presentation touching on topics related to Advisory Actions 30-32: p. 11
Workshop touching on topic related to Advisory Action 32: p. 22

Sleepy servants and such

An early arrival at the Conference was Denver Colvin, Panel 30 delegate, who flew in on the red-eye from California and got to the Roosevelt around 5:00 a.m. An inexperienced desk clerk asked him for a credit card, to demonstrate financial responsibility, and Denver didn't have one with him. A disagreement ensued. Finally, Denver did the logical thing—he woke his regional trustee, George Dorsey (that's what trustees are for, isn't it?), and a bleary-eyed George came down with a credit card and vouched for him. . . . Panel 31 delegate Bob French also arrived on Saturday; his luggage didn't. By Saturday night, it still wasn't there, and offers of a change of clothes from his Panel 30 "buddy" didn't help, because the buddy was taller and wider. The lost suitcase finally appeared on Sunday afternoon, just in time for Bob to change for the opening dinner. His comment: "I remembered my drinking days, when sometimes I went for days without a bath or a change of clothing; and the missing suitcase didn't bother me a bit."

Public Information

It was recommended that:

33 The 1980 membership survey be accepted as reported and that the trustees' P.I. Committee and A.A.W.S. develop a pamphlet, a tabletop display, and a wall poster of the survey results, if feasible.

34 The rewrite of the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" now go into production.

35 The comments from the February 1, 1981, General Sharing Session on "Attraction, Promotion, Information?" be added to the P.I. Workbook, in the section "How to Do P.I.," and to the P.I. Guidelines.

Report and Charter

It was recommended that:

36 "The A.A. Service Manual" and "Twelve Concepts for World Service" be combined into one volume.

37 There be a note added to page 26 of "The A.A. Service Manual," immediately following the Charter and prior to the Resolution, that the principles on which the Charter operates are outlined in "Twelve Concepts" and they should be read.

38 The eligibility requirements in item 7 (a), "A Typical Elec-

tion Assembly Agenda," page 50 of "The A.A. Service Manual," be clarified by changing the last sentence from "Those eligible may be incoming or outgoing committee members, or both" to "Those eligible may be present or past committee members."

39 Reference to alternate G.S.R.'s as runners-up be eliminated by rewording the description of the alternate G.S.R. on page 36 of "The A.A. Service Manual" to "... elected at the same time, by the same procedure."

40 That election procedures for alternate D.C.M.'s be provided by rewording paragraph 2 under "The Alternate Committee Member," pages 38 and 39 of "The A.A. Service Manual," to read, "Usually, the alternate is elected at the same time as the regular district committee member, by the same election procedure."

41 The section referring to alternate delegates as runners-up be eliminated by rewording this section on page 51 of "The A.A. Service Manual" to read, "The alternate delegate is elected next, by the same election procedure."

42 In the interest of language clarification regarding "odd" and "even" panels on pages 28 and 29 of "The A.A. Service Manual," reference to "elected in" be changed to "elected for."

43 As the text of Article 5 of the Conference Charter may affect admissions requests, this article be reviewed by both the Policy/Admissions and Report and Charter Committees, with a view toward reporting their findings at a joint meeting at the 1982 Conference.

44 The *Directory of A.A. Groups in Treatment Facilities* be discontinued.

45 The 1977 action regarding listing states and provinces alphabetically in the directories be reaffirmed.

Treatment Facilities

It was recommended that:

46 The additions and changes in the "A.A. in Treatment Centers" pamphlet by the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities be accepted.

These changes basically involve the clarification of the two types of meetings held in treatment facilities: regular group meetings and treatment facilities meetings. It was specifically recommended that the six-point definition of an A.A. group be included in a "boxed in" form in the pamphlet. These changes will result in new terminology; what has previously been known as a "treatment center group" will now be known as a "treatment center meeting."

Trustees

It was recommended that:

47 The report of the trustees' Nominating Committee be accepted as presented, with an additional recommendation that the method of reducing the number of trustee candidates to be

presented to the Conference floor for election of trustee-at-large/Canada remain as it presently appears in "The A.A. Service Manual," and that this method be reviewed again at the 1982 General Service Conference.

48 Jacqueline Solomon and John Bragg be elected as Class B general service trustees (New York) at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board.

49 The following persons be elected as trustees of the General Service Board for the period beginning May 1981 through April 1982 [see page 40; Conference and board approved the slate

presented by the trustees' Nominating Committee; among the regional trustee candidates, the Conference recommended the election of O. S. ("Buck") Bruner for East Central U.S., Albert J. Hergott for Western Canada, and Joe F. Kraus for Southeast U.S.; among the trustee-at-large/U.S. candidates, David Aronofsky]; and that the following be elected as officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting: [see page 40; slate of officers also approved].

50 The question "Are you a salaried employee in the field of alcoholism?" be removed from the regional trustee and trustee-at-large-U.S./Canada résumé sheets.

Financial statements

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF A.A., INC. Income and Expense of 45th Anniversary Convention

NEW ORLEANS, LOUISIANA, JULY 3-6, 1980

INCOME

Registrations (22,449 @ \$15)		\$336,740
Proceeds from sale of meal tickets	\$105,690	
Less: cost of meals	<u>104,100</u>	1,590
Interest earned		<u>7,290</u>
<u>Total Income From Convention</u>		345,620
Less: A1-Anon share		<u>98,120</u>
<u>Total Income - A.A. G.S.B. Share</u>		247,500

EXPENSES

Rentals (Superdome, equipment, booths, etc.)		77,960
Convention consultants' fees		48,230
Busing costs		48,370
Entertainment		58,010
Promotion (meetings and artwork)		73,250
Printing, signs, supplies		33,350
Public relations, legal, and accounting fees		11,130
Transportation, subsistence, hotels		
Personnel	40,200	
Guest speakers	12,710	
Trustees	<u>6,640</u>	59,550
Police and fire protection		3,090
Pre-Convention travel and salaries		32,000
Convention Host Committee expense		1,600
Stationery, programs, kits, freight, etc.		53,140
Computer leasing and programming expense		36,180
Simultaneous-translation expense		<u>12,250</u>
<u>Total Convention Expense</u>		548,110
Less: A1-Anon share		<u>97,660</u>
<u>Total Expense - A.A. G.S.B. Share</u>		450,450

EXCESS OF EXPENSE

(202,950)

NOTE - The above statement is published in this report in accordance with Advisory Action 4 (see p. 46).

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1980

	1980	1979
INCOME		
Sale of literature	\$3,981,170	\$3,262,844
Less: Discount to A.A. groups	(155,123)	—
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>3,826,047</u>	<u>3,262,844</u>
Less: Cost of printing	(1,306,058)	(967,589)
Royalties	(451,200)	(383,850)
<u>Gross Profit From Literature</u>	<u>2,068,789</u>	<u>1,911,405</u>
Contributions — A.A. groups and members	1,308,601	1,239,557
Interest income	26,225	23,460
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>3,403,615</u>	<u>3,174,422</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	1,293,494	1,107,755
Pension expense	146,928	118,462
Rent	106,165	108,736
Box 4-5-9	74,723	58,497
A.A. directories	53,095	49,134
Other service printing	96,211	78,257
Shipping and mailing	400,383	308,070
Other office expenses	314,798	231,704
Insurance and payroll taxes	157,454	137,853
Professional services	38,491	26,802
Board, committee, and staff meetings	59,349	51,007
1980 World Service Meeting	34,704	3,373
Writers' fees	33,078	39,088
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	98,547	44,893
General Service Conference	107,240	93,512
E.D.P. system development, equipment, and maintenance	41,892	46,671
Regional Forums and other expenses	31,353	32,349
Filmstrips/film project	14,617	52,755
45th Anniversary Convention	202,950	—
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>3,305,472</u>	<u>2,588,918</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u><u>98,143</u></u>	<u><u>585,504</u></u>

NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION

Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc.	\$ 801,647	\$ 849,742
General Fund — General Service Board	(703,504)	(264,238)

CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND

Balance, January 1	\$2,692,527	\$2,179,126
Transfer from A.A. World Services, Inc.	—	350,000
Investment income	266,808	163,401
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>2,959,335</u>	<u>2,692,527</u>

() denotes red figures

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.—Notes to Financial Statements, December 31, 1980

Note A — Purposes and Restrictions of Different Funds

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which, during 1977, was redefined as one year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the board of trustees, and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., are amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

Financial statements

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1980

	1980	1979
INCOME – from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$758,160</u>	<u>\$689,171</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$ 99,448	\$ 86,998
Printing	200,775	172,586
Mailing – service	63,541	52,089
– postage	60,097	47,497
Other printing costs	17,719	15,126
Calendar costs	50,284	23,804
Occupancy costs	9,663	9,923
Telephone	1,522	1,294
Office supplies and expenses	7,399	5,778
Other editorial expenses	<u>4,362</u>	<u>3,774</u>
<u>Total</u>	514,810	418,869
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	143,643	126,590
Data processing costs	40,000	36,311
Stationery and supplies	8,853	8,407
Occupancy costs	9,663	9,923
Telephone	1,960	1,294
Office expense	13,846	10,807
Selling expense – regular	32,476	25,681
– GvR program	6,583	4,783
Postage	<u>28,059</u>	<u>26,442</u>
<u>Total</u>	285,083	250,238
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	5,496	5,971
Insurance	10,656	8,392
Legal and accounting	13,475	16,700
Payroll taxes	17,464	15,519
Meetings and conferences	3,915	1,627
Furniture and equipment	2,760	1,923
Contribution to Retirement Plan	12,202	3,500
Canadian exchange	<u>5,144</u>	<u>5,471</u>
<u>Total</u>	<u>71,112</u>	<u>59,103</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>871,005</u>	<u>728,210</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS	(112,845)	(39,039)
Interest earned	<u>48,574</u>	<u>39,039</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>(64,271)</u>	<u>-0-</u>

() denotes red figures.

(continued)

The GENERAL FUND comprises those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

(continued)

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1980

Financial statements

	December 31, 1980		December 31, 1979	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
ASSETS				
Cash - checking accounts	\$ 220,768	\$ 31,672	\$ 215,891	\$ 96,608
Savings accounts and certificates	68,428	1,574	794,454	-
Investment (Note C)	-	480,718	-	462,502
Accounts receivable	71,352	52,104	54,755	3,027
Due from Grapevine	5,354	-	3,498	-
Inventories	1,053,800	23,373	631,649	10,559
Prepaid expenses	111,844	18,374	61,195	23,901
Total Assets	1,531,546	607,815	1,761,442	596,597
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	370,558	23,064	289,653	15,052
Due Reserve Funds	-	-	350,000	-
Deferred income	-	552,130	58,944	483,333
Reserve for Retirement Plan payments	-	-	-	1,320
Total Liabilities	370,558	575,194	698,597	499,705
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	1,062,845	96,892	827,341	96,892
Net income (loss) (Exhibits A and B)	98,143	(64,271)	585,504	-
Transfer from (to) Reserve Fund	-	-	(350,000)	-
Total Net Worth	1,160,988	32,621	1,062,845	96,892
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing - A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$1,103,975		\$1,005,832	
General Fund - G.S.B. (Note B)	57,013		57,013	
Total Operating Funds - as above	1,160,988		1,062,845	
Reserve Fund	2,959,335		2,692,527	
Total Net Worth	4,120,323		3,755,372	
RESERVE FUND				
Cash	\$ 29,625		\$ 500	
Savings accounts and certificates	136,612		93,120	
Due from A.A.W.S.	-		350,000	
Due from (to) A.A. Grapevine	(48,057)		18,210	
U.S. Treasury obligations	2,471,055		2,227,617	
Government agency bonds	786,743		415,972	
Accrued interest	64,075		67,826	
Less: Liability for Grapevine subscribers	(480,718)		(480,718)	
Balance, December 31, 1980	2,959,335		2,692,527	

() denotes red figures.

(continued)

Note B - After transfers of \$703,504 in 1980 and \$264,238 in 1979 from Publishing to General Fund.

Note C - Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund - \$480,718, representing the deferred subscription income of the Grapevine at December 31, 1979; no further subscription funds were transferred in 1980.

These financial statements and the foregoing notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountant.

1981 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.—PUBLISHING

Income: Sales income has been budgeted at \$4,421,500. Allowing for continued A.A. growth and an increase in sales reflecting the new book "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers," income from sales is expected to show a net increase of 15% over 1980. During 1981, it is anticipated that A.A.W.S., Inc., will distribute 406,000 copies of "Alcoholics Anonymous," 202,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" — regular edition, 47,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" — pocket edition, 22,000 "A.A. Comes of Age," 47,000 "As Bill Sees It," 42,000 "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers," 160,000 booklets, and more than 7,000,000 pamphlets and miscellaneous items. After deducting \$2,122,300, the cost of printing and producing the items sold and the royalties paid on book sales, the gross profit from sales is estimated to be \$2,299,200. After adding interest earned on daily cash flow, the total income from the publishing activity is expected to be \$2,303,200.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$1,535,100. The increase of 19.5% over 1980 takes into consideration increasing publishing activity, inflationary pressures, and an increase in rental rates based on a new lease effective Jan. 1, 1981. Net publishing income, after operating expenses, is expected to be \$768,100.

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: Contributions from A.A. groups and members have been budgeted at \$1,415,400, an increase of 8% over 1980 actual.

Expenses: Total expenses, representing the cost of group services that are paid out of contributions, are expected to be \$1,776,900. Included in this portion of the General Service Office budget is the cost of the General Service Conference, which totals \$131,100. Total service expenses are budgeted to be \$361,500 greater than contribution income. This deficit will be funded from the net income of the publishing operation.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$931,100 less the interest earned on a day-of-deposit-to-day-of-withdrawal account. The largest portion of this expense, \$761,800, is allocated for construction and refurbishing costs under a new and expanded lease. The balance of the expense represents the cost of quarterly trustee meetings, the expenses of the Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community and the Public Information Committee, the cost of A.A. Regional Forums, legal and auditing expenses, and the expenses of the archives. These expenses will be partially offset by net income from the publishing operation. The balance will be funded by a transfer from the General Service Board Reserve Fund.

1981 Grapevine Budget

Total income: Estimated income, from magazine and other sales, is budgeted at \$862,000. This represents an increase of \$103,800, or 14%, over 1980.

Total expenses: Editorial and printing costs are budgeted \$18,800 higher than 1980; circulation and business expenses, \$15,300 higher; and general administration expenses, \$1,300 higher. An operating deficit of \$47,000 is anticipated.

1981 G.S.O. Budget Financial statements

The budget for 1981 operations of G.S.O. activities is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$4,421,500*
Less: Cost of products and royalties	2,122,300
Gross profit from sales	2,299,200
Interest income	4,000
Total income	2,303,200

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	768,100
----------------------------	---------

*Based on the sale of:

406,000 books	— "Alcoholics Anonymous"
202,000 books	— "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (reg.)
47,000 books	— "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (pocket)
22,000 books	— "A.A. Comes of Age"
47,000 books	— "As Bill Sees It"
42,000 books	— "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers"
	and
	Pamphlets, booklets, and miscellaneous items

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$1,415,400
---------------	-------------

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	(361,500)
----------------------------	-----------

****Includes cost of General Service Conference—\$131,100**

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

INCOME

Interest	\$ 1,000
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TOTAL EXPENSE

Excess of income (expense)	(930,100)
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*****Office construction and refurbishing, board meetings, P.I.C. expense, C.P.C. expense, legal and auditing fees, Regional Forums, etc.**

The publishing activity will contribute \$768,100 toward the budgeted deficits.

1981 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales	\$ 862,000
Total costs and expenses	909,000
Net loss from operations	(47,000)

Contributions

1980 Contributions From Groups—by Delegate Area

General Service Area Conference Area	Total # of Gps.	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Total Group Contrib.	No. of Members	Contrib. per Capita
1. Ala./N.W. Fla.	195	119	61.0%	\$ 8,585.85	2,475	\$3.47
2. Alsk.	85	47	55.3	3,634.53	952	3.82
3. Ariz.	396	172	43.4	13,129.68	5,735	2.29
4. Ark. Calif.	127	75	59.1	3,791.76	1,803	2.10
5. S. N. Coastal	784	382	48.7	34,595.34	23,494	1.47
6. N. Int.	860	588	68.4	55,539.47	19,636	2.83
7. San Diego	334	171	51.2	13,783.56	6,393	2.16
8. Mid-S.	280	169	60.4	11,823.25	6,812	1.74
9. Colo.	645	367	56.9	33,178.17	17,174	1.93
10. Conn.	318	182	57.2	16,369.49	5,363	3.05
11. Del.	618	328	53.1	23,563.66	12,130	1.94
12. D.C. Fla.	82	59	72.0	4,702.71	1,187	3.96
13. N.	235	165	70.2	18,239.61	6,570	2.78
14. S.	234	141	60.3	10,782.13	3,196	3.37
15. Ga.	620	361	58.2	36,720.83	9,743	3.77
16. Haw.	358	239	66.8	19,216.57	6,161	3.12
17. Idaho	95	54	56.8	3,264.43	1,585	2.06
18. Ill.	97	61	62.9	3,235.97	1,100	2.94
19. Chicago	488	219	44.9	17,950.07	10,202	1.76
20. N.	529	253	47.8	17,588.63	9,071	1.94
21. S. Ind.	215	108	50.2	7,411.03	3,175	2.33
22. N.	278	140	50.4	11,295.61	3,616	3.12
23. S.	182	113	62.1	9,994.89	3,159	3.16
24. Iowa	348	167	48.0	11,543.07	6,016	1.92
25. Kans.	219	130	59.4	9,046.38	4,165	2.17
26. Ky.	259	140	54.1	16,443.54	3,592	4.58
27. La.	228	132	57.9	10,549.55	3,306	3.19
28. Me.	166	97	58.4	5,871.12	2,000	2.94
29. Md. Mass.	383	214	55.9	16,055.95	4,668	3.44
30. E.	636	292	45.9	28,558.72	16,617	1.72
31. W. Mich.	101	53	52.5	3,915.63	2,064	1.90
32. Cent.	237	141	59.5	19,525.56	4,704	4.15
33. S.E.	256	168	65.6	14,956.30	5,967	2.51
34. W. Minn.	182	114	62.6	11,368.78	3,485	3.26
35. N.	341	161	47.2	9,433.87	5,368	1.76
36. S.	606	309	51.0	30,635.88	19,765	1.55
37. Miss. Mo.	112	75	67.0	3,771.44	1,412	2.67
38. E.	263	155	58.9	9,999.69	3,292	3.04
39. W.	122	73	59.8	6,201.45	2,249	2.76
40. Mont.	161	65	40.4	4,102.77	1,742	2.36
41. Nebr.	337	179	53.1	14,415.10	5,547	2.60
42. Nev.	113	58	51.3	3,324.32	1,254	2.65
43. N.H. N.J.	172	84	48.8	5,050.35	2,721	1.86
44. N.	549	307	55.9	24,451.43	10,987	2.23
45. S.	174	108	62.1	11,477.43	2,442	4.70
46. N.M. N.Y.	119	70	58.8	4,531.60	1,575	2.88
47. Cent.	275	145	52.7	11,466.51	3,638	3.15
48. H./M./B.	235	85	36.2	5,434.87	2,883	1.89
49. S.E.	902	457	50.7	47,980.75	21,681	2.21
50. W.	145	72	49.7	4,701.56	1,958	2.40
51. N.C.	398	248	62.3	17,939.11	5,768	3.11
52. N.Dak. Ohio	125	38	30.4	1,417.17	1,905	.74
53. Cent. & S.E.	205	98	47.8	6,854.16	2,736	2.51
54. N.E.	471	154	32.7	10,775.25	11,712	.92
55. N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	132	75	56.8	5,051.76	1,776	2.84
56. S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.	196	92	46.9	6,423.68	3,102	2.07
57. Okla.	218	175	80.3	14,883.17	2,644	5.63
58. Oreg. Pa.	258	147	57.0	10,666.89	3,354	3.18
59. E.	479	299	62.4	29,026.17	9,708	2.99
60. W.	335	169	50.4	15,603.39	4,873	3.20
61. R.I.	108	62	57.4	5,481.04	1,664	3.29
62. S.C.	134	84	62.7	6,749.47	1,725	3.91

General Service Area Conference Area	Total # of Gps.	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Total Group Contrib.	No. of Members	Contrib. per Capita
63. S.Dak.	120	57	47.5%	\$ 4,613.82	2,034	\$2.27
64. Tenn. Tex.	241	126	52.3	7,544.74	3,374	2.24
65. N.E.	193	103	53.4	12,821.51	5,477	2.34
66. N.W.	145	67	46.2	5,025.20	3,165	1.59
67. S.E.	196	96	49.0	10,783.98	5,782	1.87
68. S.W.	245	121	49.4	9,534.92	4,596	2.07
69. Utah	105	73	69.5	5,137.26	1,434	3.58
70. Vt.	77	36	46.8	2,644.87	1,110	2.38
71. Va.	491	343	69.9	27,013.26	8,042	3.36
72. Wash.	594	294	49.5	24,362.74	8,966	2.72
73. W.Va. Wis.	116	80	69.0	5,116.05	1,125	4.55
74. N.Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.	333	172	51.7	13,139.63	4,768	2.76
75. S.	357	194	54.3	13,234.96	4,566	2.90
76. Wyo.	70	33	47.1	1,826.87	884	2.07
77. P.R.	91	64	70.3	2,972.88	1,231	2.42
78. Alta./N.W.T.	339	146	43.1	11,603.63	4,167	2.78
79. B.C./Yukon	517	245	47.4	22,258.79	6,854	3.25
80. Man.	144	54	37.5	5,411.74	2,981	1.82
81. N.B./P.E.I.	166	97	58.4	5,951.48	2,328	2.56
82. N.S./Nfld./Lab. Ont.	186	99	53.2	5,677.48	1,975	2.87
83. E.	422	159	37.7	15,615.44	11,004	1.42
84. N.E.	139	45	32.4	4,023.59	1,620	2.48
85. N.W.	68	22	32.4	2,722.53	1,066	2.55
86. W. Que.	357	142	39.8	19,174.66	4,991	3.84
87. S.W.	432	400	92.6	11,510.75	11,572	.99
88. S.E.	169	169	100.0	5,011.24	2,466	2.03
89. N.E.	246	246	100.0	11,049.44	4,789	2.31
90. N.W.	188	188	100.0	9,259.84	3,171	2.92
91. Sask.	283	161	56.9	9,960.97	3,415	2.92
Total U.S./Canada	25,785	14,237 ^①	55.2% ^①	\$1,139,086.39	475,750	\$2.39 ^②
Bahamas	4	0	0	0	120	0
V.I. of U.S.	4	3	75.0	350.00	95	3.68
	25,793	14,240 ^①	55.2% ^①	\$1,139,436.39 ^②	475,965	\$2.39 ^②
Individual, anniversary, & in-memoriam				37,946.30		
Specials				115,515.85		
Total for U.S. & Canada				\$1,292,898.54		

FOREIGN AND OTHER						
Foreign				8,712.67		
Birds of a Feather				360.00		
Correctional facility groups				249.90		
International Doctors in A.A.				250.00		
International Young People				298.00		
Internationalists				606.30		
Internationalists groups				152.24		
Treatment facility groups				5,068.43		
World Hello				5.00		
Grand Total				\$1,308,601.08		

COMPARISON - 1980-1979						
	# Gps. re-reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Membership	Contrib. per Capita
U.S. & Canada 1980	25,793	14,240 ^①	55.2% ^①	\$1,139,436.39	475,965	\$2.39 ^②
U.S. & Canada 1979	23,708	14,034 ^③	59.2 ^③	1,085,767.81	444,547	2.44 ^③
Increase (Decrease)	2,085	206	(4.0%)	\$ 53,668.58 ^①	31,418	(\$.05)

1 Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas). Since lists were not received from Conference Areas 88, 89, and 90, it is assumed that 100% of the groups in those areas contributed to G.S.O.

2 Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and anniversary.

3 Reflects 1979 contributions from Conference Areas 87, 88, and 90 at 100%.

	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
CANADA						
Alberta	316	141	44.6%	\$ 13,349.68	3,950	\$3.38
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	118	76	64.4	4,686.52	1,456	3.21
Nfld. & Lab.	61	31	50.8	1,334.42	584	2.28
Nova Scotia	126	71	56.3	4,757.03	1,420	3.35
Prince Edward Island	52	25	48.0	1,666.68	907	1.83
British Columbia	527	248	47.0	25,069.11	6,977	3.59
Manitoba	143	54	37.7	5,562.62	2,981	1.86
N.W. Territories	14	5	35.7	176.49	150	1.17
Ontario	954	352	36.8	46,296.45	18,164	2.54
Quebec	1,022	994	97.2	48,209.53	21,390	2.25
Saskatchewan	283	162	57.2	10,817.96	3,427	3.15
Yukon Territory	8	-0-	-0-	-0-	125	-0-
TOTAL for CANADA	3,624	2,159^①	59.5%^①	\$ 161,926.49	61,531	\$2.63^①
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	25,793	14,240^①	55.2%^①	\$1,292,898.54	475,965	\$2.71^①
FOREIGN AND OTHER						
Foreign				8,712.67		
Birds of a Feather				360.00		
Correctional facility groups				249.90		
International Doctors in A.A.				250.00		
International Young People				298.00		
Internationalists				606.30		
Internationalists groups				152.24		
Treatment facility groups				5,068.43		
World Hello				5.00		
GRAND TOTAL				\$1,308,601.08		

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 1980-1979

	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
U.S. 1980	22,169	12,081	54.5%	\$1,130,972.05	414,434	\$2.72
U.S. 1979	20,359	12,006	58.9	1,071,174.28	387,875	2.76
Increase (Decrease)	<u>1,810</u>	<u>75</u>	<u>(4.4%)</u>	<u>\$ 59,797.77</u>	<u>26,559</u>	<u>(\$.04)</u>
Canada 1980	3,624	2,159 ^①	59.5% ^①	\$ 161,926.49	61,531	\$2.63 ^①
Canada 1979	3,349	2,028 ^②	60.5 ^②	152,907.24	56,672	2.69 ^②
Increase (Decrease)	<u>275</u>	<u>131</u>	<u>(1.0%)</u>	<u>\$ 9,019.25</u>	<u>4,859</u>	<u>(\$.06)</u>
U.S. and Canada 1980	25,793	14,240 ^①	55.2% ^①	\$1,292,898.54	475,965	\$2.71 ^①
U.S. and Canada 1979	23,708	14,034 ^②	59.2 ^②	1,224,081.52	444,547	2.73 ^②
Increase (Decrease)	<u>2,085</u>	<u>206</u>	<u>(4.0%)</u>	<u>\$ 68,817.02</u>	<u>31,418</u>	<u>(\$.02)</u>

U.S.	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
Alabama	154	91	59.0%	\$ 6,286.94	2,038	\$3.08
Alaska	85	49	57.6	4,113.61	952	4.32
Arizona	393	171	43.5	15,410.55	5,718	2.70
Arkansas	127	75	59.0	3,938.64	1,803	2.18
California	2,931	1,670	56.9	166,778.57	74,447	2.24
Colorado	317	183	57.7	20,759.66	5,363	3.87
Connecticut	624	334	53.5	27,702.90	12,261	2.25
Delaware	82	59	71.9	4,732.02	1,195	3.96
District of Columbia	99	62	62.6	7,084.68	2,963	2.39
Florida	895	528	58.9	63,592.02	13,371	4.75
Georgia	358	239	66.7	19,499.57	6,161	3.16
Hawaii	95	56	58.9	6,453.31	1,585	4.07
Idaho	122	69	56.5	3,985.99	1,381	2.88
Illinois	1,226	574	46.8	45,576.61	22,362	2.03
Indiana	480	265	55.2	29,503.25	7,027	4.19
Iowa	347	167	48.1	12,317.37	6,020	2.04
Kansas	218	132	60.5	11,417.00	4,157	2.74
Kentucky	259	134	51.7	17,644.19	3,589	4.91
Louisiana	228	133	58.3	11,225.03	3,310	3.39
Maine	161	98	60.8	7,090.31	1,954	3.62
Maryland	514	315	61.2	28,032.32	8,136	3.44
Massachusetts	743	343	46.1	34,030.97	18,864	1.80
Michigan	790	471	59.6	53,560.34	15,555	3.44
Minnesota	944	466	49.3	47,293.15	25,044	1.88
Mississippi	113	76	67.2	3,904.84	1,424	2.74
Missouri	385	229	59.4	16,786.22	5,532	3.03
Montana	161	67	41.6	4,982.74	1,742	2.86
Nebraska	336	179	53.2	19,029.04	5,537	3.43
Nevada	102	57	55.8	4,268.47	1,144	3.73
New Hampshire	169	85	50.2	5,248.08	2,675	1.96
New Jersey	720	410	56.9	39,045.04	13,370	2.92
New Mexico	120	72	60.0	4,574.50	1,585	2.88
New York	1,567	755	48.1	82,964.90	30,117	2.75
North Carolina	398	247	62.0	18,713.86	5,782	3.23
North Dakota	126	39	30.9	4,113.19	1,907	2.15
Ohio	981	411	41.8	30,925.14	19,100	1.61
Oklahoma	218	173	79.3	15,792.90	2,644	5.97
Oregon	261	150	57.4	11,980.80	3,387	3.53
Pennsylvania	828	473	57.1	47,923.68	14,854	3.22
Rhode Island	106	64	60.3	5,818.05	1,610	3.61
South Carolina	134	86	64.1	7,863.18	1,725	4.55
South Dakota	120	60	50.0	6,231.02	2,034	3.06
Tennessee	240	129	53.7	8,180.22	3,362	2.43
Texas	781	387	49.5	42,583.27	18,806	2.26
Utah	107	75	70.0	5,137.25	1,468	3.49
Vermont	77	39	50.6	3,455.26	1,110	3.11
Virginia	497	346	69.6	28,000.05	8,185	3.42
Washington	551	285	51.7	29,673.15	8,424	3.52
West Virginia	114	81	71.0	6,286.02	1,113	5.64
Wisconsin	594	320	53.8	23,945.62	8,185	2.92
Wyoming	72	33	45.8	1,822.31	910	2.00
Commonwealth of P.R.	91	66	72.5	3,344.25	1,231	2.71
Bahama Islands	4	-0-	-0-	-0-	120	-0-
Virgin Islands of U.S.	4	3	75.0	350.00	95	3.68
TOTAL for U.S.	22,169	12,081	54.5%	\$1,130,972.05	414,434	\$2.72

1 Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas). Since lists were not received from Conference Areas 88, 89, and 90, it is assumed that 100% of the groups in those areas contributed to G.S.O.

2 Reflects 1979 contributions from Conference Areas 87, 88, and 90 at 100%.

1981 Conference Committees

Agenda

- ¹Jack Braybrook, Alta.
²Jack Denby, Oreg.
 Jackie Jones, Ky.
 Jim Nutting, N.H.

Doris Beacom, Iowa
 Dolores Colford, Chicago
 Jack Elbert, La.
 Greg MacNeil, Nev.

Secretary: Sarah Price

Cooperation With the Professional Community

- Douglas Beck, S.Dak.
²Denis Longtin, S.W. Que.
¹Irv Poissant, Ariz.
 John Salesses, R.I.

Joan Anderson, N.E. Ohio
 Bill Bailey, W.Va.
 Stash Brys, N. N.J.
 Dick Pittard, Wash.

Secretary: Lois Fisher

Correctional Facilities

- ²Bob Adams, Hudson/Mohawk/
 Berkshire
 Carl Budd, Wyo.
¹Bob Campbell, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.
 Denver Colvin, Mid-S. Calif.

Jack Atwell, D.C.
 John Bremer, S. Wis.
 Art Ludwig, Alabama/N.W. Fla.
 Martha Watson, S.E. Tex.

Secretary: Curtis Monahan

Finance

- Joanne McCartin, W. N.Y.
¹Joe Phelan, Ga.
²Ralph Richards, S. Ind.
 Larry Trager, Kans.
- Gordon Dracup, E. Ont.
 Sam Eddy, N. Coastal Calif.
 Marcel Labrie, N.E. Que.
 Tom Lepinskie, N. Fla.

Secretary: Dennis Manders

Conference Policy/Admissions

- Marjorie Farber, Alsk.
¹Dick Hahn, N.Wis./Upper
 Pen. Mich.
³Tom LeTourneau, N. Minn.
²Perry Rodreick, Mont.
- Eddie MacMullin, N.S./Nfld./
 Lab.
 Skip Murphy, N.E. Ont.
 Lenore Tate, S. Fla.
 Maurice Welch, Cent. N.Y.

Secretary: Phyllis Masback

Grapevine

- ¹Pat Enright, Idaho
²Bruce Irwin, N.M.
 Nancy McComas, S. N.J.
 Murph Outhwaite, W. Ont.
- June Boranian, Haw.
³Frank Gay, E. Mass.
 Bob French, S. Ill.
 Carlene Reel, E. Mo.
 LaVern Walker, Okla.

Secretary: Retha Gresham

Literature

- Frank Anderson, Me.
 Bill Carroll, Miss.
 Ern Manzano, W. Mich.
²Gerry McAvoy, N.W. Ohio/
 S.E. Mich.
¹Pat Walters, Man.
- Art Caldwell, N.W. Ont.
 Roger Côté, S.E. Que.
 Bill Peters, N. Ind.
 Dottie Rapp, Va.

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Public Information

- ¹Deborah Harrington, Del.
 Les Leuthaeuser, Nebr.
²Gerard Page, W. Mass.
 Lorin Pigg, N.W. Tex.
- Jim Barton, Cent. & S.E. Ohio
 Gertrude Brown, N.C.
 Jim Ockerman, S. Calif.
 Clyde Swaim, S.E. Mich.

Secretary: Susan Daly

Conference Report and Charter

- Raymond Coutellier, N.W. Que.
¹Raul Marin, S.W. Tex.
²Sunny Nisewaner, Md.
³Betty Stevens, S.C.

Stan Mann, S. Minn.
 Charlie Parmley, Ark.
 Bud Turner, W. Pa.
 Jack Whitehouse, Cent. Mich.

Secretary: Vinnie McCarthy

Treatment Facilities

- ²Naydene Barnes, N. Int. Calif.
 Charles Ealy, Tenn.
¹Fred Marchand, N.Dak.
 Felix Martinez, P.R.

Lee Brooks, E. Pa.
 Cynthia Fifield, Conn.
 Joe French, N.E. Tex.
 Webb Johnson, B.C./Yukon

Secretary: Lyla Bonney

Committee on Trustees

- ²Betty Daniels, Vt.
¹Ken Fraser, N.B./P.E.I.
 Tom McDonald, Sask.
 Pete Peters, N. Ill.
 Gary Ulrici, San Diego

Jesse Bowen, Utah
 Blackie Brandon, W. Mo.
 Alex Macaulay, S.E. N.Y.
 Don Pritts, Colo.

Secretary: Betty Liddle



New chairpersons and alternate chairpersons

Committee

Conference Agenda
 Cooperation With the Professional
 Community
 Correctional Facilities
 Finance
 Grapevine
 Literature
 Conference Policy/Admissions
 Public Information
 Conference Report and Charter
 Treatment Facilities
 Committee on Trustees

Chairperson

Greg MacNeil, Nev.
 Bill Bailey, W. Va.
 Martha Watson, S.E. Tex.
 Sam Eddy, N. Coastal Calif.
 June Boranian, Haw.
 Bill Peters, N. Ind.
 Skip Murphy, N.E. Ont.
 James Barton, Cent. & S.E. Ohio
 Charlie Parmley, Ark.
 Lee Brooks, E. Pa.
 LaVerne Brandon, W. Mo.

Alternate

Doris Beacom, Iowa
 Dick Pittard, Wash.
 John Bremer, S. Wis.
 Tom Lepinskie, N. Fla.
 LaVern Walker, Okla.
 Dottie Rapp, Va.
 Lenore Tate, S. Fla.
 Gertrude Brown, N.C.
 Jack Whitehouse, Cent. Mich.
 Webb Johnson, B.C./Yukon
 Don Pitts, Colo.

1985 International Convention Site Committee

Carl Budd, Wyo
 Bruce Irwin, N.M.
 Tom McDonald, Sask.
 Irv Poissant, Ariz.

Lee Brooks, E. Pa.
 Skip Murphy, N.E. Ont.
 Dottie Rapp, Va.
 Jack Whitehouse, Cent. Mich.

Secretary: Sarah Price
Assistant secretary: Vinnie
 McCarthy

- ¹Chairperson
²Alternate chairperson
³Alternate delegate

1981 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Fernand Ippersiel, *chairperson*
LaVelle Clifford
M. T. (Bud) Grondahl
Virginia Hallman
Mary Phelps
Virginia Turner
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
Nell Wing, *archivist*
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

George Dorsey, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
John Bragg
LaVelle Clifford
Jerry Danzig
Richard Driscoll
Samuel Smith
Virginia Turner
Sarah Price, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Martin Le Boutillier, *chairperson*
John Bragg
Stan Cameron
Jeanne Conway
William Flynn, M.D.
Jack Hennessy
Gordon Patrick
Kenneth Williams, M.D.
Mary Anne O'Dea, *consultant*
Robert Reinhart, *consultant*
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

W. J. Estelle Jr., *chairperson*
Jack Anderson
Daniel Fitzgibbon
Robert Gregush
Virginia Hallman
Sonny Johnson
Louis Kraus
William McDuffie
Curtis Monahan, *secretary*

Employee Retirement

Frank Smeal, *chairperson*
John Bragg
Donald Daly
Jerry Danzig
George Dorsey
Martin Le Boutillier
Virginia Turner
Michael Alexander, *consultant*
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A.
Robert Pearson, *secretary*
Dennis Manders, *assistant secretary*

Finance

Frank Smeal, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
Stan Cameron
Donald Daly
George Dorsey
W. J. Estelle Jr.
Martin Le Boutillier
John Ryall
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Dennis Manders, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Membership includes all trustees
(see following pages)
Virginia Hallman, *chairperson*
John Norris, M.D.
Phyllis Masback, *secretary*

International

Stan Cameron, *chairperson*
Jeanne Conway
Donald Daly
William Flynn, M.D.
Virginia Hallman
Louis Kraus
Ann Macfarlane
Hal Marley
John Norris, M.D.
Beth Kuhlmann, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Jerry Danzig, *chairperson*
Donald Daly
M. T. (Bud) Grondahl
Ruth Hartshorn
Louis Kraus
John Ryall
Samuel Smith
Vincina McCarthy, *co-secretary*
Sarah Price, *co-secretary*

Literature

Samuel Smith, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
M. T. (Bud) Grondahl
Fernand Ippersiel
Jack Morley
Gordon Patrick
Mary Phelps
Kenneth Williams, M.D.
Janet Graves, *consultant*
Barry Leach, *consultant*
Mary Anne O'Dea, *consultant*
Helen Turnquest, *secretary*

Nominating

LaVelle Clifford, *chairperson*
George Dorsey
Richard Driscoll
W. J. Estelle Jr.
Martin Le Boutillier
John Ryall
Samuel Smith
Jacquelyn Solomon
Betty Liddle, *secretary*

Public Information

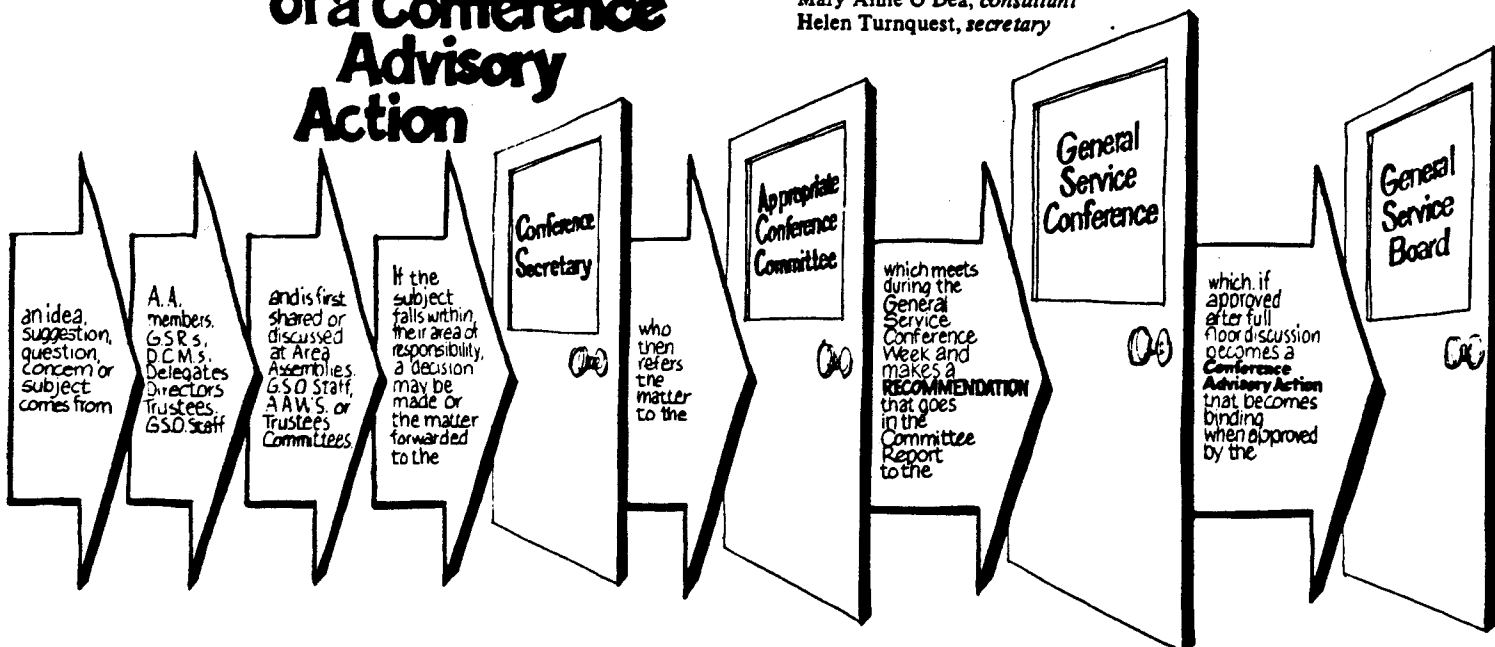
Ruth Hartshorn, *chairperson*
John Bragg
William Croke
Jerry Danzig
Denison Demac
William Dowling
Richard Driscoll
Robert Gulian
Frank Mauser
Mary Phelps
Phil Parker
Charles Hanson, *consultant*
Mary Anne O'Dea, *consultant*
Edward Small, *consultant*
Susan Daly, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

Gordon Patrick, *chairperson*
James Barry
Jeanne Conway
William Flynn, M.D.
Ruth Hartshorn
Frank Herzlin, M.D.
Fernand Ippersiel
Bill Jason
Thomas Jasper
Earl Mullen
Robert Stuckey, M.D.
Kenneth Williams, M.D.
Lyla Bonney, *secretary*

Milton Maxwell, Ph.D., and Robert Pearson are ex officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



"Were it not for Committees, it is doubtful that any Conference could get over a fraction of the ground it now covers. As the Conference has grown in size and influence the Committees' importance has grown even more."

... from the A.A. Service Manual, p.72.

1981 Conference Members

Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D. (25 Bacchus Ct., 3300 Carpenter Rd. S.E., Olympia, WA 98503), was elected to the board in April 1971 and became its chairperson in 1978. Before his retirement in 1975, he was professor of sociology in the Center of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J. From 1965 through 1973, he was also executive director of the Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies. For 18 years prior to that, he was on the faculty of Washington State University, Pullman. He has published many research papers dealing with alcohol, alcoholics, and A.A.

Michael Alexander (150 E. 69th St., New York, NY 10021) was elected a trustee in 1976 after 20 years as legal adviser to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, P.C., he was an associate of the late Bernard Smith—so significant in A.A. history. Mike is a director of the British American Chamber of Commerce, a trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society, and a director of the Ireland-U.S. Council for Commerce and Industry. He is a member of the Conference, Finance, and Literature Committees and nonvoting consultant on the Employee Retirement Committee.

W. J. Estelle Jr. (director, Texas Department of Corrections, Box 99, Huntsville, TX 77340) was named a trustee in April 1977. He was born in Indiana and educated in California, where he began his career in corrections in 1952. He then spent two years as warden of Montana State Prison. Jim has taught courses in corrections in two California colleges and is a member of seven professional societies concerned with criminal justice, corrections, and services to children and youth. He is chairperson of the Committee on Correctional Facilities and also serves on the Finance and Nominating Committees.

William E. Flynn, M.D. (1164 Old Gate Ct., McLean, VA 22101), joined the board in April 1980. A graduate of the Georgetown University School of Medicine, he was certified in psychiatry by the American Board of Psychiatry and Neurology. Currently assistant professor of psychiatry at Georgetown and director of studies in alcohol and drug abuse, he also serves as a consultant to the National Center for Alcohol Education and to the alcohol treatment unit at Arlington Hospital, in Virginia. Bill is a member of the Cooperation With the Professional Community, International, and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Gordon M. Patrick (Box 100, Lyndhurst, Ont. K0E 1N0, Canada), elected to the board in 1975, is a senior consultant with the management consulting firm of Beech & Partners, Ltd., Toronto, and a consultant to the Donwood Institute. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario, he is a member of the Association of Labor-Management Administrators and Consultants on Alcoholism. Gordon is chairperson of the Treatment Facilities Committee and also serves on the Committees on Literature and Cooperation With the Professional Community.

Frank Smeal (Goldman Sachs & Co., 55 Broad St., New York, NY 10004) began service as treasurer of the General Service Board in April 1979. He is partner and member of the management committee of an investment banking firm, after 30 years with Morgan Guaranty Trust Company, New York. He has degrees from Pennsylvania State University, the Harvard Graduate School of Business Administration, and New York University

Law School. Frank is a trustee and member of the executive committee of the Citizens' Budget Commission and chairperson of the Government and Federal Agencies Securities Committee of the Public Securities Association. He chairs the Employee Retirement and Finance Committees.

Kenneth H. Williams, M.D. (559 Overhill Rd., Birmingham, MI 48202), joined our board in 1979. Now medical director of the Department of Substance Abuse, Henry Ford Hospital, Detroit, he has been on the faculties of the Yale and University of Pittsburgh Schools of Medicine and a consultant physician to the Governor's Council on Drug and Alcohol Abuse (Pennsylvania) and to a residential detoxification program for alcoholics. Ken is a member of the Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community, Literature, and Treatment Facilities.

Alcoholic (Class B) trustees

¹**David H. Aronofsky** (2503 W. Jefferson, Dallas, TX 75211) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in May 1981. Dave has been chairperson of Dallas Metroplex Intergroup and of the Conference Finance Committee, as a Panel 27 delegate. He has remained active in area service. A doctor of dental surgery, Dave belongs to five professional organizations.

¹**John K. Bragg** (2295 Pinehaven Dr., Schenectady, NY 12309), elected general service trustee in May 1981, has served as A.A.W.S. director and member of the Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Public Information Committees. John has his own management consultant firm in the technology and research fields.

¹**O. S. (Buck) Bruner** (5161 Windridge Dr., Indianapolis, IN 46226) joined the board as East Central U.S. regional trustee in May 1981. With a background of intergroup, area, and state service, Buck was a Panel 28 Conference delegate. He is owner of one trucking company, part owner of another, and head of his own agency.

Stan N. Cameron (P.O. Box 1201, Saskatoon, Sask. S7M 2X4, Canada) became Canadian trustee-at-large in 1979. He was a Panel 26 delegate after service as a G.S.R., intergroup representative, and roundup and public information chairperson. Stan helped set up two A.A. central offices. He is chairperson of a halfway house and member of an occupational alcoholism association. He has had governmental and union experience, and is now president of an industrial-relations consulting firm. He serves on the Grapevine Corporate Board, on the Cooperation With the Professional Community and Finance Committees, and as a U.S./Canada delegate to the World Service Meeting (1980-82).

LaVelle Clifford (228 Maricopa, El Paso, TX 79912) was a Panel 22 delegate, and was elected to the board in 1979 as Southwest U.S. regional trustee. Locally, she had served as group secretary, treasurer, program chairperson, intergroup secretary, and G.S.R. She helped organize the El Paso Central Office. She has served on two non-A.A. alcoholism bodies in her community, and retired from business life in 1972. LaVelle is an A.A.W.S. director, chairperson of the Nominating Committee, and a member of the Archives and Conference Committees.

Donald F. Daly (1361 Madison Ave., New York, NY 10028) was elected as a general service trustee in April 1980, to join the board in August. Don has served groups in Northport (Long Island), N.Y., and in Manhattan in most capacities. On the Grapevine Corporate Board since 1976, he is now its chairperson. Don is an investment counselor, secretary of the Investment Counsel Association of America. He is a member of the Finance, Employee Retirement, International, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

Jerry A. Danzig (993 Park Ave., New York, NY 10028) became a general service trustee in April 1977. Since 1972, he has been a director of A.A.W.S. He is chairperson of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee and a member of the Conference, Employee Retirement, and Public Information Committees. Jerry has been officer of a broadcast network and special assistant to two New York governors. He is a partner in a management consultant firm.

George Dorsey (4761 Paradise Dr., Tiburon, CA 94920) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1978. He was a Panel 25 delegate and chairperson of the 1976 Conference Finance Committee. George had previously served as a G.S.R., D.C.M., and alternate delegate. Prior to general service activities, he served for several years in various capacities for the San Francisco Bay Area Intercounty Fellowship. George is vice-president and director of an insurance corporation. He serves as chairperson of the A.A.W.S. board and of the Conference Committee, and member of the Employee Retirement, Finance, and Nominating Committees.

Richard J. Driscoll (129 Rhinebeck Ave., Springfield, MA 01129) was named Northeast U.S. regional trustee in 1979 after serving as G.S.R., on P.I., C.P.C., institutions, and area committees, at an intergroup, and as a Panel 22 delegate. Besides belonging to various health and civic societies, Dick does volunteer work for two local non-A.A. alcoholism agencies. A licensed public accountant, he is now an officer in a bank and trust company. He is a member of the Committees on the Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Nominating.

M. T. (Bud) Grondahl (65 16th Ave. N., Fargo, ND 58102) became West Central U.S. regional trustee in 1980. Long active in A.A. service work—at group, district, and area levels—Bud was a Panel 26 delegate, chairperson of the Conference Grapevine Committee. Bud has been editor of the *Silver Dollar*, monthly A.A. newsletter, for more than 13 years. On the job, he is a claims representative with a Federal agency. He serves on the Archives, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Literature Committees.

Virginia C. Hallman (4304 N. Alpine Ave., P.O. Box 11507, Shorewood, WI 53211) was elected East Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1977. She has been secretary of the Milwaukee Central Office, a delegate (Panel 23), and outside sponsor for a women's prison (for 20 years). She is office manager of a manufacturing concern. A World Service Meeting delegate and chairperson of the International Committee, Virginia also serves on the Archives and Correctional Facilities Committees.

Ruth K. Hartshorn (190-18 89th Ave., Hollis, NY 11423) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in 1977. She became a G.S.R. in 1961, has worked on all state and local conventions since 1963, was a Panel 23 delegate, and helps local intergroups. She

operates an antiques and collectibles store, and is treasurer of a realty company. Ruth is chairperson of the Public Information Committee and a member of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Albert J. Hergott (Box 1030, Humboldt, Sask. S0K 2A0, Canada) became Western Canada regional trustee in May 1981, to serve three years (filling out the term of his late predecessor, elected in 1980). On Panel 28, Al chaired the Conference Literature Committee. Formerly in the merchandising field, he is now consultant to an investment company and chief executive officer of a correctional institution.

Fernand Ippersiel (1025 Sherbrook E., #1504, Montreal, Que. H2L 1L5, Canada) was chosen Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1978. He was a Panel 18 Conference delegate and became editor of *La Vigne A.A.* in 1969. He was one of the translators of the Big Book and the Twelve Concepts into French. Fernand is a TV director, chairperson of the Archives Committee, and a member of the Literature and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Joe F. Kraus (P.O. Drawer G, Lawrenceburg, TN 38464) joined the board as Southeast U.S. regional trustee in May 1981. After a term as a delegate (Panel 26), Joe returned to area activities. He has been in insurance, real estate, and finance, has his own company specializing in the last two fields, and has also taken part in many aspects of community service.

Martin Le Boutillier (340 E. 93rd St., New York, NY 10028) started his general service trusteeship in April 1977. He is a former president of New York Intergroup. He has been a director of A.A.W.S. since 1974, is chairperson of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee and a member of the Employee Retirement, Finance, and Nominating Committees. Martin conducts his own consulting firm.

John Ryall (32 Garden Ave., Carle Place, NY 11514) was elected general service trustee in 1979, after three years as a Grapevine director. John has been a delegate (Panel 21) and was instrumental in founding the Northeast Region's Delegates Association. A marketing specialist for a major communications network, he serves on the Finance, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Nominating Committees and the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Samuel E. Smith (820 N.W. 87 Ave., Apt. 203, Miami, FL 33126) was elected from the Southeast Region in April 1977. Sam served as a delegate on Panel 25. He has been active in local P.I. and has been an attorney 27 years. Sam is chairperson of the Literature Committee and a member of the Conference, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Nominating Committees.

Jacquelyn (Jackie) Solomon (303 E. 37th St., New York, NY 10016) became a general service trustee in May 1981, having been an A.A.W.S. director since 1976. Jackie has also been involved in group, intergroup, and area service. Her background is in the fashion sales field; she once owned a boutique and is now a distributor/supervisor.

1 New trustee, becoming a Conference member immediately after election by the General Service Board, May 2, 1981

2 Retiring at close of 1981 Conference meeting

1981 Conference Members

A.A. World Services directors

George Dorsey, <i>chairperson</i>	Martin Le Boutillier
John Bragg	Phyllis Masback
LaVelle Clifford	Robert Pearson
Jerry Danzig	Virginia Turner
Louis Kraus	

A.A. Grapevine directors

Donald Daly, <i>chairperson, president</i>	Stan Cameron
Retha Gresham, <i>secretary, vice-president</i>	Virginia Hallman
John Ryall, <i>treasurer</i>	Tom Neary
	Mary Phelps

General Service Office staff

Robert Pearson, <i>general manager</i>	Betty Liddle
Frank Mauser, <i>administrative assistant</i>	Phyllis Masback
Lyla Bonney	Vincina McCarthy
Susan Daly	Curtis Monahan
Lois Fisher	Sarah Price
Beth Kuhlmann	June Russell
	Helen Turnquest

Grapevine staff

Retha Gresham, <i>managing editor</i>	Tom Neary, <i>associate editor</i>
---------------------------------------	------------------------------------

Others attending Conference (not as voting members)

Norman Bradley, *supervisor, Data Control*
 Charles Columbia, *assistant controller/internal auditor*
 Louis D'Amelio, *supervisor, Mail Department*
 Owen Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
 Elizabeth Garcia, *supervisor, Steno/Clerical Department*
 Edward Gordon, *assistant controller/manager supporting departments*
 Shirley Grant, *personnel manager/interdepartmental coordinator*
 Janet Graves, *editor, Conference Report*
 Robert Hughie, *supervisor, Shipping Department*
 Wilma Joseph, *supervisor, File Department*
 John Kirwin Jr., *supervisor, Accounting Department*
 Lena Machado, *supervisor, Records Department*
 Dennis Manders, *controller/business administrator*
 Dorothy McGinity, *coordinator, Conference Manual*
 John Norris, M.D., *chairperson emeritus, General Service Board*
 Mary Anne O'Dea, *editorial consultant, photographer*
 Tony Osnato, *office manager*
 Naomi Strassberg, *executive secretary, Grapevine*
 Ann Warner, *writer, Conference Report, Box 4-5-9*
 Madeline Whitlock, *secretary, A.A. World Services*
 Adeline Wilnot, *assistant to the Conference secretary*
 Nell Wing, *archivist*

Observers (nonvoting) from each of the following may also attend:

Trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities
 Trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community
 Trustees' Finance Committee
 Trustees' Literature Committee
 Trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities
 Trustees' Public Information Committee
 Grapevine Editorial Board

Area delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 31st Conference includes Panel 30 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 31 (new delegates).

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	31	Art Ludwig Sr., 1511 Cahaba River Estates, Bessemer, AL 35023
Alaska	2	30	Marjorie C. Farber, 3958 Reka Dr., Anchorage, AK 99504
Arizona	3	30	Irving (Irv) Poissant, P.O. Box 1662, Glendale, AZ 85311
Arkansas	4	31	Charles (Charlie) Parmley, Rte. 1, Maysville, AR 72747
California	5	31	Southern – Jim Ockerman, 10831 Roycroft St. #82, Sun Valley, CA 91352
	6	31	Northern Coastal – Samuel (Sam) Eddy Jr., 1255 N. Walnut C-57, Napa, CA 94558
	7	30	Northern Interior – Naydene Barnes, 1117 El Terino, Modesto, CA 95350
	8	30	San Diego – Gerald (Gary) Ulrici, 7987 North Ave., Lemon Grove, CA 92045
	9	30	Mid-Southern – Denver Colvin, 4276 Agnes, Lynwood, CA 90262
Colorado	10	31	Don I. Pritts, 1009 S. Lewiston Way, Aurora, CO 80012
Connecticut	11	31	Cynthia Fifield, 46 Wilshire Rd., Madison, CT 06443
Delaware	12	30	Deborah (Debbie) C. Harrington, 202 Welwyn Rd., Woodbrook, Wilmington, DE 19803
District of Columbia	13	31	John W. (Jack) Atwell, 1131 University Blvd. #1518, Silver Spring, MD 20902
Florida	14	31	Northern – Thomas J. (Tom) Lepinskie, 1176 Park Dr., Casselberry, FL 32707
	15	31	Southern – Lenore Tate, 2418 Hayes St. #8, Hollywood, FL 33020
Georgia	16	30	Joe Phelan, 272 The South Chace, Atlanta, GA 30328

Rosters

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel	
Hawaii	17	31	June M. Boranian, 116 Opihikao Way, Honolulu, HI 96825	Minnesota	36	31	Southern – Stan Mann, R.R. 1, Box 158, Birch Echo Rd., Minnesota City, MN 55959.
Idaho	18	30	Patrick W. (Pat) Enright, 3409 Williamsburg Way, Boise, ID 83706	Mississippi	37	30	William H. (Bill) Carroll, P.O. Box 5397, Greenville, MS 38701
Illinois	19	31	Chicago – Dolores Colford, 1052 E. 100 Pl., Chicago, IL 60628	Missouri	38	31	Eastern – Carlene Reel, 10338 Yarwood Ct., St. Louis, MO 63136
	20	30	Northern – La Verne (Pete) Peters, 1260 S. Walnut, Freeport, IL 61032		39	31	Western – LaVerne (Blackie) Brandon, 306 Wall St., Joplin, MO 64801
	21	31	Southern – Robert J. (Bob) French, R.R. 2, Box 37-B, Astoria, IL 61501	Montana	40	30	Perry Rodreick, P.O. Box 424, Laurel, MT 59044
Indiana	22	31	Northern – J. W. (Bill) Peters, 1634 Victoria Dr., Elkhart, IN 46514	Nebraska	41	30	Leslie (Les) Leuthaeuser, 1912 Ave. B, Scottsbluff, NE 69361
	23	30	Southern – Ralph Richards, 13033 Shelborne Rd., Carmel, IN 46032	Nevada	42	31	Gregory B. (Greg) MacNeil, 3940 Rice Rd., Fallon, NV 89406
Iowa	24	31	Doris Beacom, 1808 Jackson St., Sioux City, IA 51105	New Hampshire	43	30	James Nutting, 28 Linlew Dr., Apt. 24, Derry, NH 03038
Kansas	25	30	Larry Trager, 2537 S. 12th Ter., Kansas City, KS 66103	New Jersey	44	31	Northern – Stan (Stash) Brys, 29 Rose St., South River, NJ 08882
Kentucky	26	30	Jacquelyn Jones, 4317 Brookhaven Ave., Louisville, KY 40220		45	30	Southern – Nancy McComas, 32 Paul Rd., Maple Shade, NJ 08052
Louisiana	27	31	Jack Elbert, 3885 Greenway Pl., Shreveport, LA 71105	New Mexico	46	30	Bruce Irwin, 1719 Avenida Cristobal Colon, Santa Fe, NM 87501
Maine	28	30	Frank Anderson, 370 Main Ave., Hollowell, ME 04347	New York	47	31	Central – Maurice M. Welch, 263 Homcroft Rd., Syracuse, NY 13206
Maryland	29	30	Sunny Nisewaner, 3719 Carroll Dr., Turkey Point, Edgewater, MD 21037		48	30	Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire – Robert L. Adams Jr., 33 Amsterdam Ave., Kingston, NY 12401
Massachusetts	30	31	*Eastern – Frank Gay, 279 Chandler St., Tewksbury, MA 01876		49	31	Southeastern – Alex Macaulay, 34-57 – 82 St., Jackson Heights, NY 11372
	31	30	Western – Gerard Page, 42 West Shore Dr., Enfield, CT 06082		50	30	Western – Joanne McCartin, 304 Charlesgate Cir., East Amherst, NJ 14051
Michigan	32	31	Central – John R. (Jack) Whitehouse, 19225 Woodbine, Apt. 37, Detroit, MI 48219	North Carolina	51	31	Gertrude Brown, 2714 Gordon St., Raleigh, NC 27608
	33	31	Southeastern – Clyde Swaim, 18002 Prosper, East Detroit, MI 48021	North Dakota	52	30	Fred Marchand, P.O. Box 961, Watford City, ND 58854
	34	30	Western – Ernest W. (Ern) Manzano, 410 McAllister Rd., Battle Creek, MI 49017	Ohio	53	31	Central & Southeastern – James Barton, 251 Barcelona Ave., Westerville, OH 43081
Minnesota	35	30	*Northern – Thomas F. LeTourneau, Rte. 1, Box 104, Aurora, MN 55705		54	31	Northeastern – Joan H. Anderson, 1326 Orlando Ave., Akron, OH 44320

Rosters

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel	
Ohio	55	30	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan – Gerry McAvoy, 1711 Navarre Ave., Toledo, OH 43605	Wisconsin	75	31	Southern – John C. Bremer, 3212 S. Burrell St., Milwaukee, WI 53207
	56	30	S.W. Ohio/N. Kentucky – Robert D. Campbell, 115 Gregory La., Hamilton, OH 45013	Wyoming	76	30	Carl Budd, 1405 Collins, Rock Springs, WY 82901
Oklahoma	57	31	LaVern Walker, 533 N. Smith St., Vinita, OK 74301	Puerto Rico	77	30	Felix J. Martinez, Box 82, Aibonito, PR 00609
Oregon	58	30	Jack Denby, 1285 Monroe Way, Grants Pass, OR 97526	Canada			
Pennsylvania	59	31	Eastern – Lee Brooks, 875 W. Miner St., West Chester, PA 19380	Province	Area no.	Panel	
	60	31	Western – B. (Bud) Turner, 1657 Skyline Dr., Pittsburgh, PA 15227	Alberta/Northwest Territories	78	30	Jack Braybrook, 92 Big Hill Cir., Airdrie, Alta., Canada T0M 0B0
Rhode Island	61	30	John R. Salesses, 1250 Greenwich Ave., Apt. S, Warwick, RI 02886	British Columbia/Yukon	79	31	W. F. (Webb) Johnson, 2250 Hoskins Rd., North Vancouver, B.C., Canada V7J 3A3
South Carolina	62	30	*Betty Stevens, 1420 Nunamaker Dr., Columbia SC 29210	Manitoba	80	30	E. Patrick (Pat) Walters, 18 Brereton Rd., Winnipeg, Man., Canada R2J 2T8
South Dakota	63	30	Douglas Beck, 4932 W. Chicago, Rapid City, SD 57701	New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island	81	30	Kenneth M. (Ken) Fraser, 255 Dominion St., Moncton, N.B., Canada E1C 6H4
Tennessee	64	30	Charles Ealy Sr., 317 Waters St., Lewisburg, TN 37091	Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador	82	31	Eddie MacMullin, 4 Division La., Glace Bay, N.S., Canada B1A 5H1
Texas	65	31	Northeastern – Joe French, 1136 S. Brighton, Dallas, TX 75208	Ontario	83	31	Eastern – Gordon Dracup, 91 Park St. S., Peterborough, Ont., Canada K9J 3R6
	66	30	Northwestern – Lorin Pigg, P.O. Box 311, Sanford, TX 79078		84	31	Northeastern – Bernard (Skip) Murphy, 272 Laurier Ave., Sault Ste. Marie, Ont., Canada P6C 5J2
	67	31	Southeastern – Martha L. Watson, 6231 Westward, #37, Houston, TX 77081		85	31	Northwestern – Arthur Caldwell, R.R. #3, Thunder Bay, Ont., Canada P7C 4V2
	68	30	Southwestern – Raul A. Marin, P.O. Box 13115, San Antonio, TX 78213		86	30	Western – B. M. (Murph) Outhwaite, Box 811, Shelburne, Ont., Canada L0N 1S0
Utah	69	31	Jesse G. Bowen, 953 South 100 East, Orem, UT 84057	Quebec	87	30	Southwestern – Denis Longtin, 57 Tisseur St., Greenfield Park, Que., Canada J4V 3K6
Vermont	70	30	Betty Daniels, Dairy Hill Rd., South Royalton, VT 05068		88	31	Southeastern – Roger Côté, C.P. 565, Bromptonville, Que., Canada J0B 1H0
Virginia	71	31	Dorothy (Dottie) Rapp, 210 E. Fairfax St., Apt. 318, Falls Church, VA 22046		89	31	Northeastern – Marcel Labrie, 54 Boucher, Loretteville, Que., Canada G2B 3C8
Washington	72	31	Richard W. (Dick) Pittard, 1002 S. 144th St., Tacoma, WA 98444		90	30	Northwestern – Raymond Coutellier, 56 – 18th St., Laval, Que., Canada H7N 1G8
West Virginia	73	31	Bill Bailey, 2 Dry Ridge Pl., St. Albans, WV 25177	Saskatchewan	91	30	T. C. (Tom) McDonald, Box 1958, Meadow Lake, Sask., Canada S0M 1V0
Wisconsin	74	30	N. Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan – Richard (Dick) Hahn, 308 Taylor St., Little Chute, WI 54140				

*Alternate

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	369,980
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions – reg. edition	187,500
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions – gift edition	42,940
A.A. Comes of Age	20,200
As Bill Sees It	43,350
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers (new)	45,170
Alcoholics Anonymous – Spanish edition	5,790
As Bill Sees It – Spanish edition	1,840
A.A. Comes of Age – Spanish edition	1,360
Total	718,130

Living Sober	98,840
Came to Believe	45,740
Living Sober – Spanish edition	3,980
Total	148,560

A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee (discontinued)	25,000
A.A. and the Armed Services	19,900
A.A. and the Medical Profession	49,800
A.A. for the Woman	194,400
The A.A. Group	93,800
A.A. in Prisons	34,700
A.A. in Treatment Centers	77,000
A.A. in Your Community (discontinued)	51,900
The A.A. Member	121,900
The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse	176,200
The A.A. Service Manual	22,200
A.A. Tradition – How It Developed	59,300
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	21,700
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	289,600
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	45,600
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	47,100
Do You Think You're Different?	219,800
44 Questions	396,100
G.S.R.	55,200
How A.A. Members Cooperate	30,800

How It Works	160,500
If You Are a Professional . . .	86,900
Inside A.A.	87,200
Is A.A. for You?	470,300
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	160,800
It Happened to Alice	68,800
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	58,900
The Jack Alexander Article	69,300
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	41,400
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	139,900
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	125,200
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	44,900
A Newcomer Asks . . . (new)	102,500
Problems Other Than Alcohol	124,400
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	192,100
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	33,900
This Is A.A.	415,400
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	45,000
Time to Start Living	96,100
Time to Start Living (large print)	13,600
Too Young?	158,400
Twelve Concepts for World Service	5,100
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	63,200
Understanding Anonymity	112,300
What Happened to Joe	94,800
Young People and A.A.	230,000
Foreign translations	244,500
Total	5,477,400

Wallet cards – two-fold	771,200
Wallet cards – I Am Responsible	131,500
Wallet cards – Anonymity	91,100
Parchment – scrolls	4,400
Placards	700
A.A. Guidelines	65,600
Group Handbook	4,400
Wire Racks	1,500
Cassettes	2,500
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette – new)	1,100
A.A. Public Information Workbook	800
Hanging displays	1,500
Fact Files	4,100
Total	1,080,400

**Circulation 4/1/81 - 124,300; 4/1/80 - 121,000;
increase for period - 3,300 (3%)**

U.S.						U.S.						U.S.					
No. GvRs		Circulation		% In-crease		No. GvRs		Circulation		% In-crease		No. GvRs		Circulation		% In-crease	
4/80	4/81	4/1/80	4/1/81			4/80	4/81	4/1/80	4/1/81			4/80	4/81	4/1/80	4/1/81		
Ala.	32	31	1,009	1,152	14	Mont.	43	69	667	751	13	P.R.	3	4	148	129	-
Alsk.	7	13	315	383	22	Nebr.	63	102	1,450	1,732	19	U.S. Poss.	-	-	3	9	-
Ariz.	85	73	1,226	1,294	5	Nev.	9	6	404	441	9		3,994	4,292	102,257	105,989	3½
Ark.	102	87	763	635	-	N.H.	17	33	671	812	21						
Calif.	316	326	10,664	10,741	1	N.J.	54	61	3,135	3,246	4						
Colo.	57	65	1,433	1,488	3	N.M.	28	26	655	643	-						
Conn.	28	48	1,873	2,119	13	N.Y.	201	204	7,863	7,825	-	Canada					
Del.	22	29	332	313	-	N.C.	71	62	2,432	2,478	2						
D.C.	67	70	725	556	-	N.Dak.	106	103	831	878	6	Alta.	51	58	2,171	2,023	-
Fla.	149	151	4,232	4,546	7	Ohio	256	244	3,947	3,845	-	B.C./Yukon	32	44	2,565	2,662	4
Ga.	87	165	1,979	2,206	12	Okla.	52	66	1,620	1,648	2	Man.	27	22	1,213	1,143	-
Haw.	59	41	296	306	3	Oreg.	40	42	1,020	1,053	3	N.B./P.E.I.	15	11	685	676	-
Idaho	30	30	593	590	-	Pa.	179	203	3,405	3,638	7	N.S./Nfld./					
Ill.	85	88	4,525	4,868	8	R.I.	35	36	621	628	1	Lab.	36	38	1,224	1,347	10
Ind.	66	80	1,809	1,822	1	S.C.	102	123	1,096	1,348	23	Ont.	263	287	6,892	6,521	-
Iowa	60	51	1,602	1,777	11	S.Dak.	11	17	735	826	12	Que.	8	12	752	508	-
Kans.	34	41	1,617	1,608	-	Tenn.	136	149	1,309	1,315	-	Sask.	38	58	1,489	1,451	-
Ky.	39	38	957	993	-	Tex.	114	104	4,350	4,578	5		470	530	16,991	16,331	0
La.	38	35	1,264	1,294	2	Utah	93	76	418	386	-						
Me.	17	19	706	757	7	Vt.	12	15	408	476	17						
Md.	65	57	2,036	1,965	-	Va.	276	259	2,921	2,815	-						
Mass.	78	77	4,691	4,580	-	Wash.	44	61	2,762	2,834	3	Foreign	17	16	1,752	1,981	13
Mich.	160	127	3,646	3,654	-	W.Va.	49	42	578	619	7						
Minn.	134	198	4,986	5,262	5	Wis.	91	118	2,731	3,011	10						
Miss.	20	21	688	714	4	Wyo.	47	47	327	327	-						
Mo.	25	59	1,783	2,075	16				102,106	105,606	3	Total	4,481	4,838	121,000	124,301	3

Increase for period: 3,301